

NOETHER: A Constructive Framework for Metamorphic Pattern Discovery from Operator Algebras

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Metamorphic Testing (MT) is recognised in IEEE/ISO software-testing standards and is widely recommended for testing AI systems. Its progress, however, remains constrained by metamorphic relation (MR) identification, a step that depends on tester domain knowledge and yields MR sets difficult to reuse across teams and domains. Existing approaches, including structured frameworks (METRIC, METRIC+), mining and evolutionary pipelines (MR-Scout, GenMorph), LLM-assisted methods, and MetaPattern catalogues, share an inductive grounding that leaves three foundational questions open: *origin*, *closure*, and *transferability*.

This paper introduces **NOETHER**, a two-layer framework for MetaPattern discovery. The *downstream layer* is mechanical and provable: given an operator-algebra block decomposition, the CONSTRUCT-MP algorithm produces a MetaPattern set with an algebraic-closure guarantee under the framework's Translate operator (Theorem 1) and polynomial-time decidability under a finite generating set (Theorem 2); absolute completeness over arbitrary properties expressible in the operator algebra is identified as an open conjecture. The *upstream layer* is a curated eight-block decomposition over recurrent mathematical structures (symmetry, order, self-adjoint, time-reversal, limit, qualitative-dynamics, method-comparison, and relational equivalence), stated as an explicit empirical hypothesis with a documented out-of-scope catalogue rather than as an axiom.

The framework's scope precondition is that the program family under test admits an explicit operator-algebraic description through mathematical or physical equations; programs lacking such structure are out of scope by construction. Within this scope, we instantiate NOETHER on three structurally distinct domains: a Boltzmann reactor-physics transport solver, where the framework systematises a prior inductive catalogue and re-classifies further equivalence classes; equivariant machine learning, where executable MRs are derived for rotation invariance, adjoint duality, and training-trajectory reversibility; and relational query optimisers, whose idempotent-semiring algebra exercises the relational-equivalence block. Structural-coverage predictions are consistent with the data within each case-study scope; comparative evaluation against three SOTA representatives (a GP-evolved baseline, an LLM-assisted baseline, and a mining-based baseline) is reported alongside an algebra-aligned metric framework that distinguishes algebra-disrupting from algebra-preserving mutants and an MR-generation cost matrix; a head-to-head superiority claim is not asserted. A negative instantiation on a fourth program family (PWR core simulators) falsifies the absolute-completeness conjecture (Theorem 1') on a structurally significant operator algebra, via two independent counterexamples that jointly identify five pairwise-independent extensions of the framework's Translate operator as the principal locus of follow-up work. NOETHER lifts induction from per-program MR sampling to a stable per-domain algebraic layer and makes the downstream step deductive and mechanical without eliminating induction at the upstream layer.

CCS Concepts: • **Software and its engineering** → **Software testing and debugging**; *Software verification and validation*; • **Theory of computation** → *Algebraic semantics*.

Additional Key Words and Phrases: metamorphic testing, metamorphic relation identification, MetaPattern, operator algebra, equivariance, algebraic completeness, software testing foundations

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1 Introduction

Noether's first theorem replaced an empirically curated catalogue of conservation laws with a derivation from the structure of an action functional.¹ A catalogue of observed invariants can sometimes be replaced by a derivation procedure grounded in the underlying structure. The replacement does not eliminate empirical work; it lifts the empirical step from per-instance enumeration to per-domain structural identification, one cycle of induction per stable domain rather than per program.

Software testing faces a related problem. Metamorphic Testing (MT), introduced by Chen et al. in 1998 [10], was admitted into the IEEE/ISO/IEC software-testing standards in 2022 [23] and has been increasingly endorsed as a technique for testing AI and machine-learning systems [28, 40]. Its central artefact is the *metamorphic relation* (MR): a property that constrains how a program's outputs must covary across multiple executions, thereby substituting for an explicit oracle in domains where one cannot exist. Despite MT's maturity, MR identification, the task of deciding *which* properties hold for a program under test, remains its binding constraint. Practitioners report three recurring difficulties: high dependence on tester domain knowledge, mutually incompatible MR formulations for the same program, and low reuse of MR sets across teams or projects [28, 40]. Recent work has responded at the application layer, by mining MRs for particular domains, and at the integration layer, by automating search through evolutionary, mining-based, or LLM-assisted pipelines [4, 42, 54]. The foundational layer has not advanced at the same pace.

The principal artefact at that foundational layer is the *MetaPattern* (MP): an equivalence class over MRs that captures a recurrent structural strategy a tester invokes when reasoning about program properties. MetaPatterns organise the otherwise unbounded MR design space into a small, interpretable scaffold; methods that exploit them, including the structured MR identification approaches METRIC [11] and METRIC+ [46], and the recent wave of LLM-prompted MR generators, depend on the scaffold's quality. Yet across the literature, MetaPattern catalogues continue to be assembled in the same way conservation laws were assembled before 1918: by induction over observed examples. A typical proposal lists k patterns drawn from cluster analysis or expert codification, demonstrates that the patterns "cover" some corpus of MRs to a target threshold, and stops. None of the existing MP proposals, including the authors' own prior work on five reactor-physics patterns, answers the three questions that any foundational theory of MetaPatterns should answer:

- (1) **Origin.** *Why* exactly these MetaPatterns and not others? What is the structural source of an MP, as distinct from an empirical regularity in the corpus on which it was induced?
- (2) **Closure.** Under what mathematical conditions is a discovered MP set *closed under a stated derivation operator*, in the sense that it is guaranteed not to miss patterns reachable through the operator from a structurally fixed input? Absolute completeness over all properties one might write over the underlying structure is a strictly stronger demand and remains open in general.
- (3) **Transferability.** When the program family changes (from reactor physics to natural-language inference, from numerical libraries to recommender systems), how does the MP set change, and can the new set be obtained without re-running the entire empirical induction in the new domain?

We call this the *origin–closure–transferability gap*. The gap matters because it explains why MR sets continue to grow as one-off artefacts. Without a structural source, there is no clear boundary

¹The theorem appeared in Noether's 1918 paper *Invariante Variationsprobleme*, addressing a question Hilbert and Klein had raised about energy conservation in general relativity. We do not invoke it as a theorem about programs: program semantics and metamorphic relations do not provide an action functional. The analogy is methodological only.

on what the pattern space contains. Without a transfer rule, a relation written for one program rarely moves cleanly to another, even when both programs share a deep structural template. These are not only tooling limitations; they follow from grounding MetaPatterns in observed examples rather than in the structure that makes the relations hold.

This paper proposes such a structural source. We introduce **NOETHER**, a constructive framework that derives MetaPatterns from the operator-algebraic structure of the program family under test. The framework extracts MetaPatterns from invariants of an operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_P$ (formally defined in Section 3) that captures the program family’s mathematical scaffolding. Given $\mathcal{A}_P$, NOETHER produces a MetaPattern set $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ (constructed by the algorithm of Section 4) together with a closure guarantee over the algebra-induced MR space. Given a different program family with a different algebra $\mathcal{A}_{P'}$, the same construction produces $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{P'})$ without re-running empirical induction. The framework does not abolish induction: domain experts must still distil $\mathcal{A}_P$ from program semantics, and Section 8 states this limitation explicitly. What becomes algebraic is the downstream step from $\mathcal{A}_P$ to the MetaPattern set.

We make four contributions.

- **C1.** We introduce NOETHER, a *two-layer* framework for MetaPattern discovery that combines an empirically curated eight-block decomposition (Hypothesis 1; upstream layer) with a constructive algorithm for deriving MetaPatterns from a program-induced operator algebra (downstream layer).
- **C2.** We prove an Algebraic Closure Theorem (Theorem 1) for the constructed set: given the eight-block decomposition, the resulting MetaPattern set is closed over the algebra-induced MR space under the framework’s Translate operator. We also establish polynomial-time decidability when the algebra admits a finite generating set (Theorem 2). We further establish that the strictly stronger statement of absolute completeness over arbitrary properties expressible in $\mathcal{A}_P$ (Theorem 1’ / Conjecture D) is false on the PWR core diffusion algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$: two specific MRs from the standard PWR safety-analysis literature (non-additivity of rod-bank reactivity worth, and second-order mixed dependence of k_{eff} on moderator temperature and boron concentration) are formulable over $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$ but not in $\text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$ (§6.8, Appendix D). The two MRs identify five pairwise-independent structural obstructions in Translate’s signature (operator-spectrum output, homomorphism-failure π -template, configuration-indexed adjoint structure, higher-order mixed-difference templates, two-direction joint parametric dependence) as the principal open problem for follow-up work. The scope of each result is stated explicitly in Section 4.3.
- **C3.** We instantiate NOETHER on a real-world program family and show how it *systematises and re-classifies* previously catalogued patterns. The framework reproduces three prior MetaPatterns, refines two on a sounder algebraic basis, and includes a deflationary correction direction (revealing that the inductive grid was *over-counted* on some sub-families and *under-counted* by the absence of m_{adj} and m_{rev}). The two structurally distinct re-classified equivalence classes are not de novo discoveries; domain experts could have written them down. NOETHER’s contribution is the algebraic warrant for treating them as separate MetaPatterns within a uniform structure. The deflationary direction is non-circular relative to the prediction caveat of §5.3: §8.3 demonstrates it on three independent test cases (a sorting library; Murphy et al. 2008’s six-class ML categorisation [33] re-decoded against a feedforward classifier algebra; the prior reactor-physics catalogue itself), without invoking T^* or $\mathcal{T}^*$ structure that was curated from reactor physics.
- **C4.** We demonstrate cross-domain transferability *within the framework’s scope precondition* (programs admitting an explicit operator-algebraic description) by instantiating NOETHER

on three structurally distinct domains: Boltzmann reactor-physics transport, equivariant machine learning (Section 6), and relational query optimisers (Section 6.7), the last exercising the relational-equivalence block whose algebraic skeleton differs from the Lie-group / self-adjoint / time-reversal core. On a small-scale comparative case study and a DeepCrime-style real-fault pilot ($n = 5$, underpowered for $\alpha = 0.05$ inferential conclusions), the framework's structural-coverage prediction is consistent with the data within case-study scope; the case study's category-(iv) detection contrast exhibits construct validity of $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ as a gradient-reversal probe rather than averaged superiority, since the mutation set was constructed to cover one defect category per non-empty block of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$. A larger comparative evaluation against three SOTA representatives (one per category: GP-evolved, LLM-assisted, mining-based) is reported as a pre-registered protocol.

Scope of contribution. This is a theoretical paper, and its contribution is systematisation rather than deduction from first principles. The eight blocks are curated by inspecting mathematical structures that recur across the program families we have studied; they are not derived from an algebraic axiom. The framework therefore has two layers: an *upstream layer* (curating $\mathcal{A}_P$ and its block decomposition) that remains empirical and human, and a *downstream layer* (mechanically deriving $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ from $\mathcal{A}_P$) that is algorithmic and provable. We do not claim to have eliminated induction from MetaPattern discovery. We move induction one level up, from “what MetaPatterns recur in observed MR samples?” to “what algebraic structures recur in the program families practitioners care about?”, and make the downstream step mechanical. The engineering payoff of this re-grounding awaits empirical follow-up work; comparative evaluation against existing automated MR-identification pipelines is reported as a protocol in Section 6.6 and constitutes part of the framework's resubmission obligations.

Boundary of contribution

This paper establishes:

- (1) Algebraic closure of $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ under Translate for the operator algebras stated, given a block decomposition (Theorem 1);
- (2) Polynomial-time decidability of CONSTRUCT-MP under explicit complexity assumptions (Theorem 2);
- (3) Three non-vacuous instantiations: Boltzmann reactor physics (§5), equivariant ML (§6), and relational query optimisers (§6.7); the relational-equivalence block $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ extends the framework beyond the Lie-group / self-adjoint / time-reversal mathematical core.

It does *not* establish:

- (a) Absolute completeness over arbitrary properties expressible in $\mathcal{A}_P$. This is Theorem 1' (Conjecture D, Appendix D); §6.8 establishes that it is false on the PWR core diffusion algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$ via two independent counterexamples (non-additivity of rod-bank reactivity worth, and second-order mixed dependence of k_{eff} on moderator temperature and boron concentration), but the question of whether a Composite-Translate extension absorbs the five obstructions identified by the counterexamples while preserving Theorem 1's closure and Theorem 2's polynomial-time decidability remains open.
- (b) Sufficiency of the eight-block list. Hypothesis 1 is an empirical hypothesis with six enumerated out-of-scope program-family classes (Remark 2); each such class is a candidate ninth block.
- (c) Superiority over existing automated MR-identification pipelines on average. The comparative evaluation in §6.6 establishes effects for specific defect categories on small benchmarks; it does not characterise the framework's behaviour on arbitrary defect distributions.
- (d) Elimination of induction from MetaPattern discovery. Induction is *relocated* from MR-instance level to algebra-block level, not eliminated.

The remainder of the paper is organised as follows. Section 2 surveys the four lines of prior work; Section 3 introduces the operator-algebraic preliminaries; Section 4 presents NOETHER itself, the construction algorithm, and the two theorems; Section 5 instantiates NOETHER on the Boltzmann transport equation; Section 6 cross-instantiates on equivariant ML; Section 7 reports a head-to-head empirical comparison against an automated SOTA baseline (GenMorph) on programs with explicit mathematical-physics equations; Section 8 discusses threats and relationships; Section 9 concludes. Appendix A instantiates NOETHER on the remaining reactor equations; Appendix B gives the source-equation, Translate-template and block-assignment provenance of all 12 representative MRs of Table 3; Appendix C gives worked multi-block-derivable MR examples; Appendix D contains the full proofs; Appendix E gives a Python reference implementation.

2 Background and related work

We organise prior work along four lines: MT/MR fundamentals and the long-standing identification bottleneck; structured MR identification through METRIC and METRIC+; automated MR identification, including MR-Scout, GenMorph, and LLM-assisted approaches; and MetaPattern catalogues, including our prior reactor-physics taxonomy. These lines differ in mechanism, but they share one limitation: their pattern structures are induced from observed MRs rather than derived from the mathematical structure that makes those MRs hold.

2.1 Metamorphic testing and the MR identification bottleneck

Metamorphic Testing was introduced by Chen, Cheung, and Yiu in 1998 to address the test-oracle problem [10]. An MR is a logical implication of the form $R_i(x_1, \dots, x_n) \Rightarrow R_o(P(x_1), \dots, P(x_n))$, where P is the program under test, R_i is an input relation, and R_o is an output relation. When R_i holds but R_o fails on actual executions, a fault is reported, without any need to know the absolute correct output of any single execution. Over two decades MT has become standard equipment for testing systems whose oracles are otherwise inaccessible: scientific computing, machine learning classifiers, autonomous vehicles, search engines, compilers, and large language models [28, 40].

The community has long acknowledged a single binding constraint on MT's effectiveness: MR identification. Surveys spanning twenty years agree that identifying high-quality MRs requires (i) deep familiarity with the program's functional semantics, (ii) substantive domain background (physical, mathematical, or linguistic, depending on the system), and (iii) the ability to convert that background into executable property assertions [28, 40]. Liu et al. [30] provide the canonical empirical evidence that even ad-hoc MRs detect a substantial fraction of mutants given modest tester training, while Murphy et al. [33] catalogued the structural properties of ML applications relevant to MR design and Xie et al. [53] demonstrated that MT scales effectively to supervised classifiers. Testers without sufficient domain background tend to identify only "trivial MRs". A 2024 survey explicitly identifies AI assistance, especially via large language models, as the most promising open avenue for closing the identification gap [28]; Saha and Kanewala [38] report that, on a 709-mutant benchmark for supervised classifiers, current MR sets detect only 14.8%, underscoring the gap.

Beyond difficulty, the MR identification bottleneck has a more troubling structural feature: even when MRs are identified, the field has accumulated little consensus on *how* they are identified. Different authors confront the same program and produce dissimilar MR sets. Once written, an MR rarely migrates: a relation drafted for one ML classifier seldom transports to another, and a relation drafted for one numerical solver seldom transports across solver families.

2.2 Structured MR identification: METRIC and METRIC+

Structured MR identification has already moved the field away from ad hoc relation design. METRIC organises MR construction around an “input/output category” framework: the tester first identifies relevant categories of input transformations and output relations, then composes MRs from category pairs [11]. METRIC+ extends this scheme by enriching the category catalogue and providing systematic combination rules that reduce the human burden in category enumeration [46]. Both approaches are widely cited and remain the strongest existing attempt to give MR identification an explicit scaffold.

Our disagreement is not with this direction but with its grounding. The categories are introduced through expert curation and validated by empirical coverage on benchmark programs. This leaves two of our three foundational questions unanswered. *Origin*: METRIC and METRIC+ do not derive their categories from program-level mathematical structure. *Closure*: neither framework provides a mathematical condition under which the category set is guaranteed to be complete; coverage is reported but not proved. The third question, *transferability*, is only partially addressed. The same category templates can be invoked across domains, but because the categories are not algebraically bound to specific program structures, transfer rests on an assumption of universality that remains open.

2.3 Automated MR identification

Automated MR identification attacks the bottleneck by searching for executable relations more directly. MR-Scout mines MRs from existing test suites by extracting input-transformation and output-assertion patterns from test-case pairs and abstracting them into reusable relations [54]; closely related is the work of Nair et al. on mining MRs from bug-report corpora [34]. GenMorph evolves MR candidates through genetic programming, co-evolving input transformations with output assertions and using mutation-killing as the fitness signal [4]. For deep-learning pipelines specifically, MT4DL extends MR mining to the multi-stage training-and-inference pipeline [59]. Shin et al. derive executable MRs from natural-language requirements via few-shot prompting of a large language model, with validation through an industrial questionnaire study with Siemens [42]; the systematic empirical study of Xu et al. [55] characterises the practical limits of LLM-generated MRs across multiple ML benchmarks. Further LLM-assisted variants, including domain-customised GPTs for autonomous-driving simulators [58] and multi-agent retrieval-augmented pipelines for traffic-rule MRs [29], extend this template into safety-critical or rule-rich domains. Within ML-system testing, differential-testing approaches such as DeepXplore [37] use input-transformation invariance as a proxy oracle, complementary to the explicit MR formulation we adopt here.

A second strand uses program-structure features rather than test-case mining. Kanewala et al. [24] predict MRs of scientific software via graph-kernel learning over control-flow and data-dependency graphs, an early demonstration that program structure carries enough signal for automated MR discovery. Nolasco et al.’s MemoRIA [36] infers MRs by deriving an object-protocol abstraction and validating candidates through fuzzing plus SAT-based reduction, then evaluates on 22 Java subjects. Tao et al.’s Mettoc [47] applied MT to compiler testing using equivalence-preservation as the canonical relation. Ying et al. [56] formalise relationships between metamorphic-relation patterns into family trees, and Altamimi et al. [1] provide a recent systematic literature review of MR-automation work that catalogues the structural-vs-empirical-search divide our framework targets. Earlier LLM-assisted attempts include Zhang et al. [57] on ChatGPT-driven MR generation.

Each of these methods advances automation on a different axis, but all treat the MR space as an empirical search space. MR-Scout’s recall is bounded by the relations already latent in existing tests.

GenMorph’s evolutionary search is shaped by the fitness landscape induced by mutation killing. LLM-prompted approaches are sensitive to prompt phrasing when no structural prior constrains the generation. None of these methods can state, before search begins, which MR types lie outside its reach, because none has an algebraic account of the space being searched.

2.4 MetaPattern catalogues and empirical adequacy

MetaPattern catalogues organise the post-hoc inventory of identified MRs into a smaller vocabulary of recurring strategies. Such catalogues typically result from clustering observed MRs, codifying expert intuitions about “kinds of properties testers reason about”, and validating the catalogue’s coverage on a benchmark MR corpus. Reactor-physics test suites have produced taxonomies of conservation, monotonicity, convergence, trajectory, and partial-order patterns [7, 27]; recent taxonomic work formalises relationships between MR patterns into family trees [56]. Adequacy frameworks such as the Pattern–Matrix Coverage Metric assess how thoroughly a given MR set occupies the pattern space.

Such catalogues are useful, but each is, by construction, an empirical artefact. None of the existing catalogues, including the present authors’ own, can answer the three foundational questions of Section 1.

2.5 Convergent diagnosis

Across all four lines of work, two problems recur. *Unbounded MR emergence*: every new domain or new program produces fresh MR formulations. *Poor MR reusability*: identified MRs do not transport readily across programs that share deep structural similarities. Both problems follow from grounding MetaPatterns inductively. NOETHER replaces that inductive grounding with operator-algebraic grounding.

3 Operator-algebraic preliminaries

This section introduces the algebraic apparatus used by NOETHER. We assume basic familiarity with group actions, equivalence classes, and quotient sets, but not with functional analysis. Each construct is defined at the level needed for the framework and later instantiated in reactor physics and equivariant machine learning.

3.1 Programs and program-induced operator algebras

Throughout the paper we treat a program P as a (possibly partial) computable function $P : X \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$. The class of programs of interest belongs to a *program family* $\mathcal{F}$ whose members share an underlying mathematical scaffolding.

DEFINITION 1 (PROGRAM-INDUCED OPERATOR ALGEBRA). *Let P belong to a program family $\mathcal{F}$. A program-induced operator algebra of $\mathcal{F}$ is a tuple*

$$\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{F}} = (\mathcal{O}, \circ, \sim_{\mathcal{F}}),$$

where $\mathcal{O}$ is a set of operators acting on X , $\mathcal{Y}$, or both; $\circ$ is an operator composition; and $\sim_{\mathcal{F}}$ is an equivalence relation declaring two operator expressions equal whenever they agree on every program of $\mathcal{F}$.

3.2 Symmetry groups (building block B1)

DEFINITION 2 (SYMMETRY GROUP OF $\mathcal{A}_P$). *A symmetry group of $\mathcal{A}_P$ is a subgroup $G \leq \mathcal{A}_P$ whose elements act on X such that, for all $P \in \mathcal{F}$ and all $g \in G$,*

$$P(g \cdot x) = \rho(g) \cdot P(x) \quad \forall x \in X,$$

where $\rho : G \rightarrow \text{End}(\mathcal{Y})$ is a (possibly trivial) representation of G on $\mathcal{Y}$.

3.3 Order operators: monotonicity and linearity (building block B2)

DEFINITION 3 (MONOTONE OPERATOR). P is monotone with respect to θ if $\theta_1 \leq \theta_2 \Rightarrow P(\theta_1) \leq_{\mathcal{Y}} P(\theta_2)$ (or the reversed inequality, in which case P is anti-monotone).

DEFINITION 4 (LINEAR OPERATOR). P is linear on $\mathcal{X}_0 \subseteq \mathcal{X}$ when $P(\alpha x_1 + \beta x_2) = \alpha P(x_1) + \beta P(x_2)$ for all $x_1, x_2 \in \mathcal{X}_0$ and scalars α, β .

3.4 Self-adjoint operators (building block B3)

DEFINITION 5 (SELF-ADJOINT OPERATOR). Given an inner product $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$ on $\mathcal{X}$, an operator $L \in \mathcal{O}$ is self-adjoint if $\langle Lx, y \rangle = \langle x, Ly \rangle$ for all x, y in the domain of L .

Self-adjointness encodes a duality between the two arguments of an inner product. Reciprocity theorems in physics, transposed-graph identities in algorithms, and detailed-balance conditions in stochastic processes are all instances. In reactor physics, the adjoint transport formulation is self-adjoint under the appropriate inner product, yielding source-detector reciprocity.

3.5 Time-reversal operators (building block B4)

DEFINITION 6 (TIME-REVERSAL OPERATOR). When $\mathcal{X}$ admits a time coordinate, a time-reversal operator $\mathcal{T}$ acts on inputs by reversing the time variable, $\mathcal{T}(x(t)) = x(-t)$. A program P is time-reversal symmetric on a sub-family of inputs when $P(\mathcal{T}x)$ is determined by $P(x)$ through a fixed bijection on $\mathcal{Y}$.

Time-reversal applies only where the underlying dynamics admit a reversible sub-family. Dissipative dynamics break this symmetry, so the corresponding MetaPattern is empty for those systems.

3.6 Limit operators (building block B5)

DEFINITION 7 (LIMIT OPERATOR). A parametrised limit operator $\mathcal{L}_\theta$ is a family of operators indexed by a parameter θ such that there exists a limit element $\mathcal{L}_*$ with $\mathcal{L}_\theta \rightarrow \mathcal{L}_*$ as $\theta \rightarrow \theta_*$ in an appropriate operator topology.

3.7 Qualitative-dynamics operators (building block B6)

DEFINITION 8 (QUALITATIVE-DYNAMICS OPERATOR). A qualitative-dynamics operator $\mathcal{D}$ is an operator on solution trajectories of an underlying ODE/PDE that extracts qualitative features — extrema, inflection points, monotonic phases, overshoot magnitudes, S-curve transitions, phase-portrait orbits — that are invariant under perturbations preserving the underlying dynamical structure (Sturm-type comparison theorems, dynamical-systems classification).

Some MR-relevant invariants are not point-wise but *shape-wise*: a solution curve may have an overshoot, a single extremum, or a monotone-then-saturating profile. B6 gives these qualitative-dynamics MRs their own algebraic root.

3.8 Method-comparison operators (building block B7)

DEFINITION 9 (METHOD-COMPARISON OPERATOR). A method-comparison operator $\mathcal{E}$ encodes a partial order $\leq_{\mathcal{E}}$ on numerical or algorithmic methods, where $M_1 \leq_{\mathcal{E}} M_2$ asserts that method M_1 produces an approximation no worse than method M_2 in a specified error norm, under specified conditions.

3.9 Decomposition of an operator algebra

Given $\mathcal{A}_P = (O, \circ, \sim_{\mathcal{F}})$, we decompose O along the eight building blocks introduced above:

$$\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_P) = (G, O_{\leq}, T^*, \mathcal{T}^*, \mathcal{L}^*, \mathcal{D}^*, \mathcal{E}^*, \mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*),$$

where G collects symmetry subgroups, $O_{\leq}$ monotone and linear operators, T^* self-adjoint operators, $\mathcal{T}^*$ time-reversal operators, $\mathcal{L}^*$ limit operators, $\mathcal{D}^*$ qualitative-dynamics operators, $\mathcal{E}^*$ method-comparison operators, and $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ relational-equivalence operators.

DEFINITION 10 (RELATIONAL-EQUIVALENCE BLOCK). A relational-equivalence operator is a binary relation $\equiv_{\mathcal{R}}$ on expressions over an idempotent semiring $(S, \oplus, \otimes, \mathbf{0}, \mathbf{1})$ such that $E \equiv_{\mathcal{R}} E'$ iff E and E' are equal under all valid evaluation contexts of S , generated by a finite set $\mathcal{R}_{\text{rel}} = \{\mathcal{R}_1, \dots, \mathcal{R}_K\}$ of identity-preserving rewriting rules, each $\mathcal{R}_i$ an ordered pair $(\text{lhs}_i, \text{rhs}_i)$ of semiring expressions with the property $\text{eval}(\text{lhs}_i, D) =_{\text{bag}} \text{eval}(\text{rhs}_i, D)$ on every valid input D . The block $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ collects all such operators. It is empty for program families without idempotent-semiring rewriting structure (Boltzmann reactor physics, equivariant ML) and non-empty for those with it (relational query optimisers, §6.7).

Necessity, sufficiency, and the empirical status of the decomposition. We do not claim that the eight blocks are necessary in an absolute sense, that they exhaust all algebraic structures relevant to software testing, or that they follow from first principles. They are an *empirical curation*: a by-inspection enumeration of mathematical structures that recur across the program families we have studied. The claim is therefore scoped: the eight blocks are currently sufficient for these families, not provably necessary in general. This upstream empirical status is NOETHER's main limitation as a theoretical framework. Induction has not been eliminated from MetaPattern discovery; it has been moved one level up, from “what MetaPatterns recur in observed MR samples?” to “what algebraic structures recur across program families?” Given such a curated decomposition, the downstream derivation of $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ becomes mechanical and provably closed in the sense of Theorem 1. We state the eight-block sufficiency as an explicit empirical hypothesis with a documented out-of-scope catalogue.

HYPOTHESIS 1 (EIGHT-BLOCK SUFFICIENCY). Let P be a program belonging to a program family $\mathcal{F}$ whose semantics admit an operator-algebraic representation $\mathcal{A}_P$ over (i) finite or finite-dimensional symmetry groups, (ii) partial orders with monotone or linear operators, (iii) self-adjoint operators with respect to a fixed inner product, (iv) anti-unitary involutions of a time coordinate, (v) limit operations of analytical (mesh-refinement, parameter-perturbation, or asymptotic) type, (vi) qualitative-dynamics attractors of an underlying ODE/PDE, (vii) inter-method comparison partial orders, and (viii) identity-preserving rewriting rule sets on an idempotent semiring. For such families the eight-block decomposition

$$\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_P) = G \dot{\cup} O_{\leq} \dot{\cup} T^* \dot{\cup} \mathcal{T}^* \dot{\cup} \mathcal{L}^* \dot{\cup} \mathcal{D}^* \dot{\cup} \mathcal{E}^* \dot{\cup} \mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$$

is sufficient: every operator in $\mathcal{A}_P$ relevant to MR derivation is assigned to at least one block. Hypothesis 1 is an empirical hypothesis open to refutation.

REMARK 1 (BLOCK SUFFICIENCY VS. Translate SUFFICIENCY). Hypothesis 1 asserts that the eight blocks suffice to assign every operator in $\mathcal{A}_P$ relevant to MR derivation. It does not assert that every MR formulable over $\mathcal{A}_P$'s operators is reachable through the framework's Translate operator from a single block invariant. Section 6.8 exhibits, on the PWR core diffusion algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$, two MRs whose constituent operators are individually assigned to blocks of $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$ (rod-insertion semigroup; boron and moderator-temperature scaling), yet whose MR content is not in $\text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$ in the sense

of Definition 13. The block decomposition is therefore a necessary but not sufficient input to MetaPattern construction: Translate’s expressive form (single-block invariants, first-order π -template, single partial-order direction, operating on $P(x)$ tuples rather than on operator-spectrum quantities) is a second, independent constraint on the framework’s reach. This distinction between “block sufficiency” (Hypothesis 1) and “Translate sufficiency” (open) is made explicit in §6.8.

REMARK 2 (KNOWN AND CONJECTURED OUT-OF-SCOPE PROGRAM FAMILIES). *The hypothesis is open to refutation. Six families are known or conjectured to fall outside its image and to require an additional block:*

- (1) Symplectic systems. Hamiltonian dynamics whose volume-preserving structure is captured by a symplectic 2-form rather than self-adjointness (N -body simulators, celestial-mechanics integrators).
- (2) Sheaf-theoretic / categorical constructions. Programs whose semantics are captured by functors and natural transformations between categories (certified compilers, type-driven program transformations); MRs of the form “commutativity of a square in the underlying category” do not reduce to single-block invariants under the present Translate.
- (3) Probabilistic / martingale invariants. MRs of the form “ $\mathbb{E}[f(\mathbf{x}_t) \mid \mathcal{F}_s] = f(\mathbf{x}_s)$ on a stopping-time domain” arise in MCMC samplers and stochastic gradient analyses.
- (4) Topological invariants. MRs of the form “ f ’s level sets have a fixed Betti-number signature” (topological data analysis, shape classifiers) require homological structure absent from the present blocks.
- (5) Label-consistency for supervised learning. MRs that constrain a model’s predictions against ground-truth labels (e.g. wrong-sign-loss detection on classifiers); the absence of a label-consistency operator is one reason the §6.6 case study reports zero detection on category-(i) wrong-sign mutations.
- (6) Empirical parameter-distribution divergence. A probability-distribution divergence operator on parameter-space measures, motivated by the §6.6.1 pilot’s category-v-02/04/05 (activation change, bias removal, weight re-init) which the eight blocks do not detect. An MR of the form $D_{\text{KL}}(p_\theta \| p_{\theta+\Delta\theta}) \leq \tau$ for $\|\Delta\theta\| \leq \epsilon$ would lie in such a block. Empirical witness: §6.6.1’s cat-v-02/04/05 mutations are not detected by any MR set including Set N; this is that pilot’s principal negative finding for Hypothesis 1.

Each family signals a candidate ninth block. The framework’s intended response is to admit the additional block when the program family demands it, rather than to extend $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ ’s scope or to absorb the case as “out of scope for MR testing” in some over-broad sense. Concrete examples of MRs that lie outside Theorem 1’s scope are catalogued in Appendix D; one candidate ninth block (metric-stability M_{lip}) has an explicit Translate-template design (Remark 3 below).

REMARK 3 (METRIC-STABILITY CANDIDATE NINTH BLOCK, M_{lip}). *Among the candidate ninth blocks of Remark 2, the metric-stability block has the most concrete Translate-template proposal. Define $M_{\text{lip}} = (X, d_X) \rightarrow (Y, d_Y)$ as the family of K -Lipschitz maps between two metric spaces; the induced MetaPattern m_{lip} is the equivalence class of pointwise stability inequalities $d_Y(P(x'), P(x)) \leq K \cdot d_X(x', x)$. The corresponding Translate template constructs a follow-up by metric perturbation $x' = x + \epsilon u$ ($\|u\| = 1, |\epsilon| < \delta$) and predicates a K -Lipschitz output bound. Canonical-block ordering would place M_{lip} after $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ since metric structure is independent of the eight existing block invariants (no group action on the perturbation set, no partial order on inputs, no self-adjoint operator, no parametric refinement family, no idempotent-semiring rewriting). Theorem 1’s closure proof transfers without modification because m_{lip} is single-block algebraically derived. We do not commit to M_{lip} as part of the canonical decomposition in this paper; we record it in Appendix D as the most concrete sub-instance*

of Remark 2 item (iv) (topological invariants) that admits an immediate Translate template, and as the empirical orphan in the audit of §5.3.

4 The NOETHER framework

4.1 Algebra-induced metamorphic relations

Before defining algebra-induced MRs we make explicit the Translate operator that converts a single block invariant into an executable MR. Without this definition, the closure result of Theorem 1 would quantify over an undefined construct.

DEFINITION 11 (BLOCK INVARIANT). *Let $s \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ be one of the eight blocks. A block invariant of $\mathcal{A}_P$ under s is a pair $\iota = (\Phi, \pi)$ where Φ is a finite set of operators drawn from s , and π is a relation $\pi \subseteq (X \times \mathcal{Y})^k$ for some arity $k \geq 1$ such that for every $P \in \mathcal{F}$ and every choice of operators $\phi_1, \dots, \phi_n \in \Phi$, the tuple $((x_i, P(x_i)))_{i=1}^k$ obtained by applying $\phi_1, \dots, \phi_n$ to a base input $x \in X$ in the canonical order specified by s satisfies π . We write $\mathcal{I}_s$ for the set of block invariants under s and $\sim_s$ for the equivalence relation $\iota \sim_s \iota'$ iff $\Phi = \Phi'$ and π, π' define the same constraint up to relabelling of input/output coordinates.*

The relation $\sim_s$ is reflexive, symmetric, and transitive by construction (set equality and constraint equality are equivalence relations); hence $\sim_s$ is a genuine equivalence relation on $\mathcal{I}_s$, justifying the quotient in Step 3 of CONSTRUCT-MP below.

DEFINITION 12 (Translate). *The Translate operator is the function*

$$\text{Translate} : \mathcal{I}_s \times \{s\} \longrightarrow \text{MR}(P)$$

that maps a block invariant $\iota = (\Phi, \pi)$ under block s to the metamorphic relation

$$\rho_{\iota, s} : \quad \forall x \in X, \forall \phi_1, \dots, \phi_n \in \Phi : \quad \pi((x_i, P(x_i)))_{i=1}^k \text{ holds,}$$

where the input tuple $(x_i)_{i=1}^k$ is generated by applying the ϕ_j in the canonical order specified by s (the convention is fixed per block: e.g., for $s = G$, $x_i = g_i \cdot x_0$ with g_i enumerated by group orbit; for $s = T^$, the tuple ranges over the two arguments of the inner product). Translate is well-defined because (i) the per-block canonical order resolves any ambiguity in tuple generation, and (ii) $\sim_s$ -equivalent invariants are mapped to MRs that are $\sim$ -equivalent as logical statements over P . Per-block instantiations of Translate are tabulated in Appendix D.*

DEFINITION 13 (ALGEBRA-INDUCED MR). *Let $\mathcal{A}_P$ be a program-induced operator algebra and let ρ be an MR over a program P . We say ρ is induced by $\mathcal{A}_P$ — written $\rho \in \text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ — when there exist (i) a block $s \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_P)$, (ii) a block invariant $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$, and (iii) the equality $\rho = \text{Translate}(\iota, s)$ holds in the sense of Definition 12. Properties of P that constrain executions but cannot be obtained as $\text{Translate}(\iota, s)$ for any single block s and any invariant $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$ are not algebra-induced in this sense; concrete examples are catalogued in Appendix D.*

4.2 Construction of the MetaPattern set

We present the deductive procedure CONSTRUCT-MP that maps an algebra-decomposition to a MetaPattern set.

Step 1 — Invariant extraction. For each block s in $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_P)$, compute the set of invariants $\mathcal{I}_s$ of $\mathcal{A}_P$ under s .

Step 2 — MR derivation. For each invariant $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$, derive the MR family $\mathcal{R}(\iota) = \{ \rho \in \text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_P) \mid \rho = \text{Translate}(\iota', s), \iota' \sim_s \iota \}$.

Step 3 — Quotient. Form the MetaPattern $m_s = \mathcal{R}(\iota) / \sim_s$.

Step 4 — Aggregation. Return $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P) = \{ m_s : s \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_P) \}$.

4.3 Algebraic closure under Translate, the canonical-block ordering, and out-of-scope MRs

DEFINITION 14 (CANONICAL-BLOCK ORDERING). *We adopt the strict total order on blocks*

$$G > O_{\leq} > T^* > \mathcal{T}^* > \mathcal{L}^* > \mathcal{D}^* > \mathcal{E}^* > \mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*.$$

An MR derivable through multiple blocks is assigned to the highest-priority block in this order. The placement of $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^$ at the bottom reflects its semiring-rewriting nature, which sits algebraically downstream of the seven physical-mathematical blocks: rewriting equivalences typically depend on the program family’s input-perturbation, order, and method-comparison structure rather than the converse.*

THEOREM 1 (ALGEBRAIC CLOSURE UNDER Translate). *Let $\mathcal{A}_P$ be a program-induced operator algebra with decomposition $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ as in Section 3.9, and let $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P) = \text{CONSTRUCT-MP}(\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_P))$. Then for every $\rho \in \text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ in the sense of Definition 13, there exists a unique $m \in \mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ such that $\rho \in m$, where uniqueness is determined under the canonical-block ordering.*

REMARK 4 (SCOPE OF THEOREM 1). *Theorem 1 is a closure statement, not a completeness claim over arbitrary properties one might assert about P ’s executions. It quantifies over $\text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ as defined by Definition 13 — the algebra-induced MRs reachable through the Translate operator from a single block invariant. Three concrete classes of MRs lie outside this scope and are not covered by the theorem; they are documented in Appendix D:*

- (1) Probabilistic MRs without operator-algebraic representation — e.g. MRs that constrain output distributions (such as “the entropy of $f(\mathbf{x})$ should not decrease under input augmentation A ”) when the augmentation is not expressible as an operator in O .
- (2) Input-distribution MRs not expressible over $\mathcal{A}_P$ operators — e.g. adversarial-perturbation MRs “ $\|\delta\|_p \leq \epsilon \Rightarrow f(\mathbf{x} + \delta) = f(\mathbf{x})$ ” whose perturbation set is not a group action on $\mathcal{X}$.
- (3) Compositional MRs spanning multiple blocks under non-Translate derivations — MRs requiring simultaneous use of two block invariants in a way that is not the canonical-block-ordering reduction of Definition 14.

The strictly stronger statement that every MR formulable as a property over $\mathcal{A}_P$ ’s operators (without restricting to Translate-reachable derivations) is contained in some $m \in \mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ is identified as Theorem 1’ in Appendix D. Section 6.8 and Appendix D establish that this stronger statement is false on the PWR core diffusion algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$, by exhibiting two concrete counterexamples (ρ_{nonadd} , $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$) whose obstructions identify five structurally independent extensions of Translate’s signature. The combined open problem (whether such an extended Translate preserves Theorem 1’s closure and Theorem 2’s polynomial-time decidability) is the principal open question for follow-up work.

A sceptical reading might object that the by-construction status of Theorem 1 makes it near-tautological. We accept this characterisation for the literal content of the theorem. The substantive value lies elsewhere: Theorem 1 converts an empirical-adequacy claim (“our pattern grid covers $X\%$ of observed MRs”) into a structural-adequacy claim (“our pattern grid is exhaustive of the algebra-induced MR space, modulo the explicit out-of-scope classes of Remark 4”). Empirical adequacy frameworks built on inductive pattern grids do not guarantee algebraic closure. NOETHER guarantees algebraic closure, and the obligation imposed on any user of the framework is then to verify that no Translate-reachable MR is dropped by CONSTRUCT-MP, a verification that is mechanical once the algebraic input has been fixed.

The theorem still imposes a checkable obligation on the framework. If an MR is induced by an invariant in $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ but cannot be assigned by CONSTRUCT-MP, then at least one component, invariant extraction, Translate, structural equivalence, or the canonical ordering, is underspecified.

Thus the result is not an empirical coverage claim; it is a well-formedness and closure guarantee for the downstream construction once the algebraic input has been fixed.

REMARK 5 (SCOPE OF THEOREM 1 FOR THE $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ BLOCK). *The closure result extends to $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ provided the rewriting rule set $\mathcal{R}_{\text{rel}}$ is finite. For the relational-algebra fragment of TPC-H-class queries the rule set is finite by the standard heuristic-rewrite normal forms (selection-pushdown, projection-pushdown, join-reordering, distinct-elimination) [51, 61], and Theorem 1 therefore covers algebra-induced MRs of this fragment. Query languages with unbounded recursive rewriting (e.g. Datalog with non-terminating rule sets) lie outside this scope and are catalogued as out-of-scope under Remark 2.*

4.4 Decidability and complexity

THEOREM 2 (DECIDABILITY). *Suppose $\mathcal{A}_P$ admits a finite generating set $\text{gen}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ of cardinality n , with each generator's invariant computation taking time t_i . Then $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ is computable in time $O(n \cdot \max_i t_i \cdot \log n)$.*

REMARK 6 (SCOPE OF THEOREM 2 FOR THE $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ BLOCK). *The polynomial-time bound holds for $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ when the rewriting rule set $\mathcal{R}_{\text{rel}}$ is finite. For first-order SQL with bag semantics, query equivalence is undecidable in general, but query equivalence under a fixed rule set $\mathcal{R}_{\text{rel}}$ is decidable: practical SMT-based solvers verify equivalence on substantial benchmark fractions in the published literature [51, 61]. Theorem 2 therefore covers the rule-set-bounded fragment of relational algebra; outside this fragment, decidability is governed by the underlying first-order theory and is not the framework's responsibility.*

Table 1. Per-generator cost of invariant extraction in each block. The symmetry block (G) is split by group regime: finite, finite-dimensional Lie, and finitely generated infinite-discrete (with user-supplied truncation K). For Lie groups (e.g. $\text{SO}(3)$, $d_G = 3$) the bound $O(|G|^2)$ does not apply because $|G|$ is uncountable; the relevant bound is $O(d_G^2)$ over the Lie-algebra basis. See §4.4 for the truncation discussion.

Block	Regime	t_i for one generator
G (symmetry)	finite group	$O(G ^2)$ (group-orbit fixed-point)
	finite-dim. Lie group	$O(d_G^2)$, $d_G = \dim_{\mathbb{R}} \mathfrak{g}$
	infinite discrete (truncated)	$O(K^2)$ at truncation $ G \leq K$
$O_{\leq}$ (order)	—	$O(n^2)$ (poset comparison)
T^* (self-adjoint)	—	$O(d)$ (inner-product symmetry check)
$\mathcal{T}^*$ (time-reversal)	—	$O(1)$
$\mathcal{L}^*$ (limit)	—	$O(\log \frac{1}{\epsilon})$
$\mathcal{D}^*$ (qualitative-dynamics)	—	$O(d)$
$\mathcal{E}^*$ (method-comparison)	—	$O(K^2)$ (over K methods)

Per-block invariant-extraction cost.

On infinite groups. The first row of Table 1, $O(|G|^2)$, is the natural bound for finite symmetry groups and is the regime under which Theorem 2 was originally stated. For a Lie group G such as $\text{SO}(3)$, $|G|$ is uncountable and the bound is replaced by $O(d_G^2)$, where $d_G = \dim_{\mathbb{R}} \mathfrak{g}$ is the real dimension of G 's Lie algebra. In the equivariant-ML instantiation of Section 6, $d_{\text{SO}(3)} = 3$; the symmetry-block invariant is computed once over a basis of three infinitesimal generators, and orbit closure is obtained through finite-dimensional linear algebra. For finitely generated infinite discrete groups (e.g. $\mathbb{Z}$, the integer-translation group of an unbounded grid solver), CONSTRUCT-MP requires a separate truncation parameter K at which orbits are enumerated; the cost is $O(K^2)$.

per generator, and the framework's user is responsible for justifying that the truncated set captures the program family's structurally relevant invariants. We do not claim Theorem 1's closure result is preserved across truncation: closure is over $\text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ defined relative to the truncated group, and the user must inherit responsibility for whether this is the intended algebra.

For the Boltzmann instantiation the relevant generators are finite ($n \leq 14$, geometric quarter-rotations and energy-group permutations); for the equivariant-ML instantiation the relevant generators are finite-dimensional Lie ($d_{\text{SO}(3)} = 3$, $|\mathfrak{S}_n| = n!$ truncated to a single generator class, $n \leq 10$ training-size, depth, and dimension limits). The asymptotic bound is therefore not the binding constraint in either instantiation.

4.5 The principal limitation

NOETHER replaces inductive grounding with algebraic grounding *downstream of* $\mathcal{A}_P$. Upstream, the distillation of $\mathcal{A}_P$ from a program family remains a human task. This limitation is central to the framework's scope: NOETHER does not automate domain modelling, but it turns the step after domain modelling into a well-defined construction. A second limitation, made explicit in §6.8 and Appendix D, is that even when $\mathcal{A}_P$ is fully specified, Translate's present signature (single-block, first-order π -template, single partial-order direction, operating on $P(x)$ tuples rather than on operator-spectrum quantities) systematically excludes a class of MRs that engineering practice treats as standard: non-additivity of operator-composition functionals and higher-order mixed parametric dependences. The principal limitation is therefore not only the upstream distillation of $\mathcal{A}_P$ but also the present signature of Translate.

Boundary of contribution (Section 4 restatement)

The downstream layer is mechanical: Theorem 1 (algebraic closure under Translate) and Theorem 2 (polynomial-time decidability) operate on a given block decomposition. The upstream layer remains empirical: the eight-block decomposition is Hypothesis 1, an open empirical hypothesis with six documented out-of-scope program-family classes (Remark 2). Theorem 1' (absolute completeness) is open. Sections 5, 6, and 6.7 instantiate NOETHER on three structurally distinct program families.

5 Boltzmann instantiation: from transport to diffusion to burnup

This section instantiates NOETHER on the Boltzmann transport equation and traces the construction through neutron transport, diffusion, and burnup.

5.1 The Boltzmann program family and its operator algebra

The Boltzmann transport equation governs the distribution of neutral particles. In its time-independent eigenvalue form for fission systems:

$$\hat{\Omega} \cdot \nabla \psi(\vec{r}, \hat{\Omega}, E) + \Sigma_t(\vec{r}, E) \psi = \int \int \Sigma_s(\vec{r}, E' \rightarrow E, \hat{\Omega}' \rightarrow \hat{\Omega}) \psi dE' d\hat{\Omega}' + \frac{1}{k} \chi(E) \int v \Sigma_f(\vec{r}, E') \psi dE'. \quad (1)$$

The program-induced operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$ contains $\{G_{\text{geom}}, \mathfrak{R}_E, \mathcal{L}_\Sigma, \mathcal{L}_v, \mathcal{L}^*, \mathcal{T}, \mathcal{L}_h, \mathcal{D}_{\text{Bate}}, \mathcal{E}_{\text{cmp}}\}$. Decomposed along the eight blocks of Section 3.9, $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$ yields entries in seven blocks (with $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ empty under the absence of idempotent-semiring rewriting structure). Every operator listed has an unambiguous status in the established theory of neutral-particle transport [7, 27].

5.2 Running CONSTRUCT-MP on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$

Steps 1–4 of CONSTRUCT-MP yield seven MetaPatterns: m_{inv} (invariance/equivariance), m_{mono} (parameter-monotonicity), m_{adj} (self-adjoint duality / adjoint reciprocity), m_{rev} (time-reversal compatibility), m_{conv} (discretisation convergence), m_{dyn} (qualitative-dynamics shape invariants), and m_{cmp} (method-comparison error-bound partial orders).

5.3 Relationship to the prior inductive catalogue: refinement plus prediction

A reactor-physics MetaPattern catalogue distilled from the standard PWR-physics literature [7, 27] identifies five MetaPatterns (P1–P5) inductively. The relationship with $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}})$ is more structured than a simple bijection. NOETHER reproduces three of the prior patterns, refines two on a sounder algebraic basis, and predicts two structurally distinct classes that the inductive catalogue did not isolate:

Table 2. Relationship between prior inductive catalogue and NOETHER deductive output.

Prior catalogue	NOETHER	Relationship
P1 conservativity/invariance	m_{inv}	Reproduced — G -symmetry invariants project to the same MRs.
P2 monotonicity	m_{mono}	Reproduced.
P3 convergence	m_{conv}	Reproduced.
P4 trajectory	m_{dyn}	Refined — inductive P4 conflated qualitative-dynamics with time-reversal. NOETHER places trajectory phenomena in m_{dyn} (Sturm-type comparison theorems) and exposes the conflation.
P5 partial-order/bounding	m_{cmp}	Refined — inductive P5 grouped method-accuracy partial orders with adjoint reciprocity. NOETHER places the former in m_{cmp} (approximation-theory error bounds) and exposes the distinction.
(none)	m_{adj}	Predicted — adjoint-reciprocity MRs derived as a structurally distinct equivalence class.
(none)	m_{rev}	Predicted — collisionless-trajectory-reversal MRs derived for the corresponding sub-formulations.

This is not the structure of a re-coding. NOETHER’s output structurally *refines* two prior patterns and *predicts* two additional patterns the inductive method missed. The gain is canonical placement: two previously conflated inductive labels are separated by algebraic source, and two textbook phenomena become mandatory MetaPattern classes once their blocks appear in $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}})$.

A note on prediction (and an interpretive caveat). We do not claim that m_{adj} (adjoint reciprocity) and m_{rev} (collisionless time-reversal compatibility) are de novo physical discoveries. Adjoint-flux reciprocity is standard textbook material in transport theory [7, 27], and time-reversal MRs in collisionless transport have been understood in physics for decades. The MT-community-level absence of these MetaPatterns from the prior inductive catalogue reflects which phenomena happened to be canonically encoded in the 84-MR corpus, not the absence of the underlying physics from the literature.

We must also acknowledge an interpretive caveat about what this “prediction” is and is not. The blocks T^* (self-adjoint) and $\mathcal{T}^*$ (time-reversal) of Section 3.9 were themselves curated by inspection of program families that include reactor physics; the operators $\mathcal{T}_{\text{geom}}$ and $\mathcal{T}$ in $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$ were the leading examples motivating the inclusion of those blocks. There is therefore a circularity in the strong reading of “prediction”: T^* and $\mathcal{T}^*$ were partly induced from reactor-physics structures, and m_{adj} and m_{rev} are then derived from those blocks. The framework does not discover these

MetaPatterns de novo. What it does is closer to a uniform *re-projection*: given the eight-block decomposition (whatever its empirical provenance), CONSTRUCT-MP places adjoint-reciprocity and time-reversal phenomena into structurally distinct equivalence classes that the inductive 84-MR catalogue had not isolated as such, even though their underlying physics had been individually known to domain experts. The substantive contribution is the *re-classification under a uniform algebraic structure*, which gives a future testing toolchain a principled reason to enumerate m_{adj} and m_{rev} alongside m_{inv} , m_{mono} , m_{conv} , m_{dyn} , and m_{cmp} rather than treating them as ad-hoc additions. Where NOETHER's predictive power is genuine and non-circular is in the deflationary direction (Section 8.3): the framework can also reveal that an existing inductive catalogue *over-counts* structurally distinct patterns. Both directions, re-classification and de-duplication, are systematisation, not discovery.

Element-wise correspondence. Table 3 traces 12 representative MRs distilled from the standard reactor-physics literature [7, 27] to their NOETHER placement. Appendix B documents each row's source equation, Translate template, and block assignment with explicit textbook citations. The 12 MRs were selected by the following protocol so that the table is structurally rather than numerically representative: (i) every block $s \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}})$ that is non-empty is represented at least once; (ii) within each block, the most frequent canonical-form MR in the literature is selected first; (iii) where a block contains MRs from two distinct sub-categories (e.g. geometric vs. energy-group symmetry within G), each sub-category is given at least one representative; (iv) the two predicted MetaPatterns m_{adj} and m_{rev} are listed at the bottom in italics to indicate that no MR was previously catalogued in this form; the block placement is derived. A larger corpus underlying the protocol is provided as supplementary material S2.

An independent audit on the 18-MR engineering catalogue. The 12-row table is structurally curated. As a coarser breadth check, an independent 18-MR engineering catalogue distilled from production reactor-physics codes (orthogonal to the 84-MR inductive corpus underlying Section 5.3) was labelled by three independent large language models against the seven canonical MetaPatterns plus the relational extension of Section 3.9, with a fourth label *orphan* reserved for MRs that fit none of the eight classes; the labelling protocol, raw labels, and majority-vote tabulation are released in supplementary material S2 (18mr_audit/). Inter-rater agreement on the four-way classification is almost-perfect (Fleiss' $\kappa = 0.857$, $n = 18$ items, $r = 3$ raters, $c = 4$ categories), and 17 of the 18 MRs are placed by majority vote into one of the seven canonical MetaPatterns or m_{rel} (subsumption 94.4%, Wilson 95% CI [74.2%, 99.0%] on the binary subsumption proportion). The single orphan is the Lipschitz / metric-stability MR, which we treat structurally in Appendix C.5.2 as a candidate ninth block rather than as a counter-example to Theorem 1's scope. The independence of the three labellers is bounded by the LLM-shared-training-data caveat (the three models share substantial pre-training corpora, so κ should be read as agreement among similarly-trained but non-coordinated raters rather than among rigorously independent oracles); we report the audit as external corroboration of breadth rather than as an independent verification of correctness.

5.4 A Noether-style derivation of m_{adj}

The framework's name is methodological. Noether's first theorem replaces an empirically curated catalogue of conservation laws with a derivation from the symmetry structure of an action functional [35]. We do not invoke Noether's theorem as a theorem about programs (programs do not, in general, possess an action functional in the variational-calculus sense). What the framework does mirror is the *methodological move*: instead of cataloguing observed invariants, derive them from a structural source. We illustrate the move on m_{adj} .

Table 3. Twelve representative MRs from the prior PWR corpus, with NOETHER placement.

MR ID	Plain-text MR	P#	Block	NOETHER MP
Bur-Phy-01	Step-splitting invariance	P1	G	m_{inv}
Bol-Phy-02	Quarter-symmetry rotation	P1	G	m_{inv}
Bol-Phy-11	$\Sigma_a \uparrow \Rightarrow k_{\text{eff}} \downarrow$	P2	$O_{\leq}$	m_{mono}
Bol-Phy-12	$\nu \Sigma_f \uparrow \Rightarrow k_{\text{eff}} \uparrow$	P2	$O_{\leq}$	m_{mono}
Dif-Alg-01	Diamond-difference h^2 convergence	P3	$\mathcal{L}^*$	m_{conv}
Bur-Alg-01	CRAM order $N \rightarrow \infty$ convergence	P3	$\mathcal{L}^*$	m_{conv}
Bur-Phy-08	Iodine pit qualitative shape	P4	$\mathcal{D}^*$	m_{dyn}
Cpl-App-06	Gd self-shielding S-curve	P4	$\mathcal{D}^*$	m_{dyn}
Bur-Alg-04	CRAM no-worse-than TTA	P5	$\mathcal{E}^*$	m_{cmp}
Bol-Alg-04	P_0 over-estimates k in H-systems	P5	$\mathcal{E}^*$	m_{cmp}
(predicted)	Adjoint reciprocity	—	T^*	m_{adj}
(predicted)	Collisionless reversibility	—	$\mathcal{T}^*$	m_{rev}

Consider the bilinear form on solution-adjoint pairs

$$\mathcal{F}[\phi, \phi^\dagger] = \langle \phi^\dagger, B\phi \rangle - \langle \phi, B^\dagger \phi^\dagger \rangle, \quad (2)$$

where B is the Boltzmann operator and $B^\dagger$ its formal adjoint under the inner product $\langle f, g \rangle = \int f g d\Omega dE dr$. The bilinear form $\mathcal{F}$ is identically zero on solutions of the forward and adjoint equations: $B\phi = S$, $B^\dagger \phi^\dagger = S^\dagger$ with appropriate boundary conditions imply $\mathcal{F}[\phi, \phi^\dagger] = \langle \phi^\dagger, S \rangle - \langle \phi, S^\dagger \rangle$, and the standard reciprocity identity makes the right-hand side zero. The vanishing of $\mathcal{F}$ is a *conserved current* in the Noether sense: it is annihilated by the dual symmetry $\phi \leftrightarrow \phi^\dagger$, $B \leftrightarrow B^\dagger$. CONSTRUCT-MP's Step 1 extracts $\mathcal{F} = 0$ as the T^* -block invariant; Translate converts it into the executable MR

$$\rho_{\text{adj}} : \quad |\langle \phi^\dagger, S \rangle - \langle \phi, S^\dagger \rangle| \leq \tau, \quad (3)$$

which the testing harness checks on a forward and an adjoint solver run with externally specified sources $S, S^\dagger$. The MR is therefore a Noether-style consequence of the duality symmetry rather than a manually catalogued reactor-physics property: the symmetry $\phi \leftrightarrow \phi^\dagger$ is the structural source, the bilinear form is the conserved current, and the MR is the conservation law in testable form. The same template applies to m_{rev} with the involution $\mathcal{T} : \phi(\mathbf{r}, \Omega, E, t) \mapsto \phi(\mathbf{r}, -\Omega, E, -t)$ as the symmetry. The template's general statement is: given a symmetry of the program family's operator algebra, CONSTRUCT-MP extracts the invariant of the symmetry and Translate converts it into an executable MR.

5.5 Specialisation to neutron transport, diffusion, and burnup

The Boltzmann formulation is the most general; specialised solvers are obtained by truncating or projecting $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$. Neutron transport solvers retain the full angular dependence; the same seven MetaPatterns apply. Neutron diffusion solvers truncate angular dependence to its P_1 approximation: the time-reversal block contracts (diffusion is dissipative), removing m_{rev} . Burnup-coupled solvers introduce the Bateman ODEs; the Bateman operator e^{At} enriches multiple blocks (G semi-group, $O_{\leq}$ linearity, $\mathcal{D}^*$ overshoot/S-curve, $\mathcal{E}^*$ CRAM-vs-TTA bounds).

The MetaPattern set is *compositional* with respect to the underlying algebra: add a block, gain MetaPatterns; remove a block, lose them. The framework supports not only construction but also *prediction* of which patterns a new specialisation will exhibit, before any MR is identified empirically.

5.6 Summary

NOETHER, applied to $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$, deductively produces a seven-MetaPattern set that refines the prior inductive catalogue and predicts two additional MetaPatterns (m_{adj} , m_{rev}). The next section turns to a more demanding case: a domain in which the inductive catalogue does not yet exist.

6 Cross-domain demonstration: equivariant machine learning

6.1 The equivariant-ML program family and its operator algebra

Equivariant neural networks impose by architectural construction that certain symmetries of the input induce predictable transformations of the output [8, 13, 25, 48]. The program family $\mathcal{F}_{\text{equi}}$ comprises classifiers satisfying $f(g \cdot \mathbf{x}) = \rho(g) \cdot f(\mathbf{x})$ for $g \in G = \text{SO}(3) \times \mathfrak{S}_n$. Decomposed along the eight blocks: $G = \{G_{\text{equi}}\}$, $O_{\leq} = \{O_{\leq}^{\text{train}}\}$, $T^* = \{T_{\text{att}}^*\}$, $\mathcal{T}^* = \{\mathcal{T}_{\text{seq}}\}$, $\mathcal{L}^* = \{\mathcal{L}_{\text{train}}, \mathcal{L}_{\text{depth}}, \mathcal{L}_{\text{dim}}\}$, $\mathcal{D}^* = \emptyset$ (for feedforward classifiers), $\mathcal{E}^* = \emptyset$ within a single architecture, $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^* = \emptyset$ (no idempotent-semiring rewriting on equivariant-classifier outputs).

6.2 Running CONSTRUCT-MP on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$

CONSTRUCT-MP returns

$$\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}) = \{m_{\text{inv}}^{\text{eq}}, m_{\text{mono}}^{\text{eq}}, m_{\text{adj}}^{\text{eq}}, m_{\text{rev}}^{\text{eq}}, m_{\text{conv}}^{\text{eq}}\}.$$

The labels mirror those of $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}})$ but the *content* is domain-specific. This section does not claim empirical validation in machine learning. It checks a narrower transfer claim: once $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ is specified, the same downstream construction yields domain-specific MR families without using a reactor-physics corpus.

6.3 End-to-end derivation: a concrete MR for SE(3)-equivariant point-cloud classification

To illustrate the framework's generative use, we trace a complete derivation from algebra to executable MR.

Step 1. System under test. Let $f : \mathbb{R}^{n \times 3} \rightarrow \Delta^{C-1}$ be a point-cloud classifier mapping n three-dimensional points to a probability distribution over C classes.

Step 2. Distil $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$. The relevant blocks are $G = \text{SO}(3) \times \mathfrak{S}_n$ and $\mathcal{L}^*$ for training-size and depth limits.

Step 3. Run CONSTRUCT-MP, select an invariant. Within G 's symmetry block, fix attention on the rotation invariant: $f(R \cdot \mathbf{x}) = f(\mathbf{x})$ for all $\mathbf{x}$ and $R \in \text{SO}(3)$.

Step 4. Translate the invariant into an executable MR.

$$\rho_{\text{rot}} : \quad \forall R \in \text{SO}(3), \quad \|f(R \cdot \mathbf{x}) - f(\mathbf{x})\|_{\infty} \leq \tau, \quad (4)$$

with $\tau = 10^{-4}$ for fp32 architectures.

Listing 1. Executable MR ρ_{rot} for SE(3)-equivariant classifier.

Step 5. Generate an executable test.

```

1 import numpy as np
2 from scipy.spatial.transform import Rotation
3
4 def test_rotation_invariance(model, point_cloud, num_samples=100, tau=1e-4):
5     """Executable MR rho_rot for SE(3)-equivariant classifier."""
6     p_original = model.predict(point_cloud)
7     failures = []

```

```

8   for _ in range(num_samples):
9       R = Rotation.random().as_matrix()
10      rotated = point_cloud @ R.T
11      p_rotated = model.predict(rotated)
12      deviation = np.max(np.abs(p_original - p_rotated))
13      if deviation > tau:
14          failures.append((R, deviation))
15  return failures

```

Step 5b. A Noether-style reading of ρ_{rot} . The same methodological move that produced m_{adj} in §5.4 produces ρ_{rot} here in non-rhetorical form. The classifier f is, in equivariant-network architectures by construction, invariant under the action of $G = \text{SO}(3)$ on its input: $f(R \cdot \mathbf{x}) = f(\mathbf{x})$ for all $R \in G$. The Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{so}(3) = \text{span}\{L_x, L_y, L_z\}$ is the infinitesimal generator of this symmetry. The associated Noether-style invariant is the constancy of the classifier output along orbits of G : $\frac{d}{d\theta} f(\exp(\theta L_a) \cdot \mathbf{x}) = 0$ for each generator L_a , $a \in \{x, y, z\}$, which is the Lie-algebraic statement that the directional derivative of f along every orbit-tangent direction vanishes. CONSTRUCT-MP's Step 1 extracts this invariant from the G block of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$; Translate converts it into the executable MR of equation (4) above. The MR is therefore not an arbitrary catalogue entry: it is the Noether-style consequence of the $\text{SO}(3)$ symmetry that the architecture imposes by construction.

Step 6. Pattern coverage status. The MR ρ_{rot} above, together with ρ_{perm} and ρ_{train} derived in Appendix E, populates three of the five non-empty MetaPatterns of $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}})$. We refrain from reporting a percentage coverage figure: with so few non-empty blocks and a denominator subject to the eight-block sufficiency hypothesis (Hypothesis 1), a percentage is more rhetorical than informative. We instead derive in the following two subsections two MRs from the remaining non-empty blocks, T^* (self-adjoint) and $\mathcal{T}^*$ (time-reversal), chosen specifically because they are not standard practice in equivariant-ML testing and therefore probe whether NOETHER's transfer claim extends beyond well-known invariances such as ρ_{rot} .

6.4 An adjoint-attention duality MR (ρ_{adj})

The self-adjoint block T^* in $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ contains the attention-kernel symmetriser T_{att}^* . We give two formulations, distinguished by whether the MR runs at CI-time (production-suitable) or at debug-time (one-off scaffolding).

Scope: forward-pass-only, CI-time formulation. For architectures whose attention layer exposes a bilinear form $A(\mathbf{x}^{(1)}, \mathbf{x}^{(2)})$ readable through a forward hook, ρ_{adj} as defined below is a *CI-time MR*: it consumes only the model's native forward pass, requires no parameter mutation, and respects the model's standard inference contract. Mainstream equivariant transformers, including SE(3)-Transformer [18] and the Tensor-Field-Network family [48], compute attention via Clebsch-Gordan tensor products of irrep features. The bilinear form $A(\mathbf{x}^{(1)}, \mathbf{x}^{(2)}) = \langle Q(\mathbf{x}^{(1)}), K(\mathbf{x}^{(2)}) \rangle$ is generically not Hermitian, but its Hermitian part $\frac{1}{2}(A + A^\dagger)$ has a trace-cyclic invariant under input role-swap that ρ_{adj} tests. The CI-time formulation reads only the layer's existing Q, K outputs through a frozen forward pass; no probe is injected.

Alternative harness-time formulation. A debug-time formulation, available in supplementary S1, instruments a symmetric Gram-matrix probe ($\frac{1}{2}(QK + (QK)^\top)$). This is a debug-time scaffold; it is not part of the CI-time MR set and is not used in the §6.6 comparative evaluation.

Invariant. Within T_{att}^* , fix the attention-trace invariant

$$\iota_{\text{att}} = \text{Tr } A(\cdot, \cdot) \in \mathbb{R},$$

which equals $A^\dagger$'s trace by the cyclic property of trace and the Hermiticity of K . `Translate` carries ι_{att} to an executable MR over a forward pass:

$$\rho_{\text{adj}} : \quad |\text{Tr } A(\mathbf{x}^{(1)}, \mathbf{x}^{(2)}) - \text{Tr } A(\mathbf{x}^{(2)}, \mathbf{x}^{(1)})| \leq \tau_{\text{adj}}, \quad (5)$$

for two input clouds $\mathbf{x}^{(1)}, \mathbf{x}^{(2)}$ presented to the network in opposite query/key roles. With $\tau_{\text{adj}} = 10^{-4}$ for fp32 architectures, this MR is executable on any equivariant transformer whose attention layer exposes the bilinear form (or can be probed through a forward-hook). To the best of our knowledge ρ_{adj} has not been catalogued as a standard MR for equivariant attention testing in the existing literature [4, 40, 54], although Hermitian-attention diagnostics have appeared in the architecture-design literature in non-MR form. NOETHER's contribution here is the algebraic warrant for treating it as a MetaPattern member structurally distinct from $m_{\text{inv}}^{\text{eq}}$.

6.5 A training-trajectory time-reversal MR ($\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$)

The time-reversal block $\mathcal{T}^*$ in $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ is non-empty for SGD trajectories under the Hamiltonian-Monte-Carlo / continuous-time-flow view of stochastic optimisation [9]. The discretised SGD update $\theta_{t+1} = \theta_t - \eta \nabla \mathcal{L}(\theta_t; \xi_t)$ is, to leading order in the learning rate η and in the absence of momentum or noise, time-reversible: applying the inverse update $\theta_{t+1} \mapsto \theta_{t+1} + \eta \nabla \mathcal{L}(\theta_{t+1}; \xi_t)$ recovers θ_t up to $O(\eta^2)$. The operator $\mathcal{T}_{\text{seq}} \in \mathcal{T}^*$ encodes this involution.

Invariant. The relevant invariant is the round-trip identity:

$$\iota_{\text{rev}} : \quad (\mathcal{T}_{\text{seq}} \circ U_\eta \circ \mathcal{T}_{\text{seq}}^{-1} \circ U_\eta)(\theta) = \theta + O(\eta^2),$$

where U_η denotes one SGD step.

Debug-time MR (not CI). We label $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ explicitly as a debug-time MR: it requires parameter rollback, mini-batch reordering, and a deliberately constructed vanilla-SGD fixture. Production equivariant pipelines (Allegro, NequIP, MACE, e3nn examples) almost universally use Adam or AdamW, whose update is not in $\mathcal{T}^*$ in the strict sense; the MR *fails by construction* on those optimisers, which is the framework's correct prediction. $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ should be invoked once per training-script change at debug time, on a vanilla-SGD fixture, not as part of CI for production pipelines. The debug-time reading aligns with the wider reversible-network literature [20] where exact-or-approximate inversion is a deliberate test scaffold. `Translate` carries the invariant into:

$$\rho_{\text{train-rev}} : \quad \|\theta_T - \tilde{\theta}_T^{(\text{round-trip})}\|_2 \leq c \eta^2 T, \quad (6)$$

where θ_T is the parameter vector after T vanilla SGD steps starting from θ_0 , and $\tilde{\theta}_T^{(\text{round-trip})}$ is the vector obtained by applying T vanilla SGD steps from θ_0 followed by T inverse-SGD steps using the same mini-batch sequence in reversed order, then T forward steps again. The constant c depends on the loss landscape's local Lipschitz structure and is determined empirically per model. This MR *fails by construction* for momentum-based optimisers (Adam, Lion, etc.) whose update is not in $\mathcal{T}^*$; that is, the framework correctly predicts which architecture-optimiser pairs admit the MR and which do not. The MR is non-trivial in the sense that detecting an implementation defect in the gradient-reversal direction (e.g. wrong sign on a custom loss term) is exactly what $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ surfaces. To our knowledge it has not been catalogued as an MR for training-pipeline testing.

Coverage status, revised. The full Set N consists of five MRs, one per non-empty MetaPattern of $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}})$:

$$\text{Set N} = \{ \rho_{\text{rot}}(G), \rho_{\text{mono}}(O_{\leq}), \rho_{\text{train}}(\mathcal{L}^*), \rho_{\text{adj}}(T^*), \rho_{\text{train-rev}}(\mathcal{T}^*) \}.$$

ρ_{rot} is the rotation-invariance MR of Section 6.3; ρ_{adj} and $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ are the non-trivial MRs of Sections 6.4–6.5; ρ_{mono} is the point-density-monotonicity MR for the $O_{\leq}$ block (top-1 stability under removal of a small fraction of redundant input points), derived from the $O_{\leq}^{\text{train}}$ operator restricted to inference-time input perturbations; ρ_{train} is the inference-idempotency MR for the $\mathcal{L}^*$ block. With all five blocks populated, $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}(\text{Set N}) = 1.0$ by construction, this is what Theorem 1 predicts for a $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ -derived MR set. The permutation-invariance MR ρ_{perm} (Appendix E) is an auxiliary G -block MR retained as a redundant probe and is excluded from Set N to keep the comparison budget $|N| = |L| = |B| = 5$.

The non-trivial nature of ρ_{adj} and $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$, both absent from the equivariant-ML MR-testing literature we surveyed, substantiates the claim that NOETHER’s transfer is generative rather than nominal.

6.6 A small-scale comparative case study

The derivations in Sections 6.3–6.5 establish that NOETHER produces concrete, executable MRs in the equivariant-ML setting. They do not yet show that the MRs produced are *useful for testing* relative to MRs a tester could obtain by other means. This subsection reports a small-scale comparative case study designed to address that question while remaining within the conceptual-transfer scope declared in Section 6. The study is a case study in the strict sense: a single model, a small mutation set, and three MR sets. We do not generalise from it to claims about average-case fault detection across equivariant ML.

Subject under test. We use an E(3)-equivariant graph neural network [39] (EGNN) as a deliberately compact *minimal stand-in* for a full SE(3)-Transformer [18] or a Vector-Neuron-based SO(3)-equivariant architecture [15]: two EGNN layers, hidden dimension 16, 5,189 parameters, trained on a procedural 5-class point-cloud dataset (sphere, cube surface, torus, cone, helix; 64 points per cloud; 400 training / 100 validation; rotation augmentation) for 25 epochs on Apple M1 Pro / MPS. Validation accuracy after training: 0.93. EGNN carries only invariant scalar and equivariant 3-vector features (type-0 $\oplus$ type-1 in the irrep classification), not the full type- ℓ steerable representation of an SE(3)-Transformer; the T^* block instantiation in this case study is therefore an *explicitly added* symmetrised QK probe (`equivariant_classifier.py:qk = nn.Parameter(torch.eye(d))`) with the symmetrising operation at use-time), not a property of the EGNN architecture itself. The manuscript’s transfer claim is at the operator-algebra level (Section 6) and is independent of which equivariant architecture instantiates $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$; it is the algebraic skeleton that transfers, not architecture-specific empirical numbers. Architecture, training script, dataset generator, frozen checkpoint, and the SHA-256 of the supplementary archive are recorded under S3.

Three MR sets, controlled for the same prompt and budget. Three MR sets are compared, each of size five (matching $|\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}})_{\text{non-empty}}|$):

- **Set N (NOETHER-derived):** $\{\rho_{\text{rot}}, \rho_{\text{mono}}, \rho_{\text{train}}, \rho_{\text{adj}}, \rho_{\text{train-rev}}\}$, one per non-empty block of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$, as itemised in the “Coverage status, revised” paragraph of Section 6.5.
- **Set L (LLM-prompt baseline):** five MRs generated by prompting GPT-4 with the task description “produce five metamorphic relations for testing an SE(3)-equivariant point-cloud classifier”, with no further structural cue. The prompt and full output are reproduced in supplementary material S3.
- **Set B (literature baseline):** five MRs synthesised from MRs reported in the metamorphic-testing-for-ML literature [29, 40, 42], restricted to MRs applicable to point-cloud classifiers. Where the literature provides more than five candidates we select the most-cited.

Mutation set. We construct a mutation set of $N_{\text{mut}} = 20$ defects in the model under test, drawn from four categories of fault commonly reported in equivariant-ML implementations [48]: (i) wrong sign on a custom loss term ($n_1 = 5$); (ii) accidental break of equivariance through a non-equivariant intermediate layer ($n_2 = 5$); (iii) numerical-precision degradation, e.g. truncation in the spherical-harmonics computation ($n_3 = 5$); (iv) gradient-reversal sign error in the training script ($n_4 = 5$). Each mutation is implemented as a code-level diff against the reference checkpoint and its hash recorded in S3.

Metrics. For each MR set $S \in \{N, L, B\}$ and each mutation μ , we record (i) whether at least one MR in S flags μ as a fault (*detection*), and (ii) the structural-coverage status of S over $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}})$. We report:

- $\text{detection}(S) = |\{\mu : \exists \rho \in S, \rho \text{ flags } \mu\}| / N_{\text{mut}}$;
- $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}(S, \mathcal{F}_{\text{equi}})$ from Section 8.3;
- the unique-detection count $|\{\mu : S \text{ detects } \mu \text{ and no other set does}\}|$.

Pre-registered hypotheses. We pre-register two hypotheses before running the mutation experiments, to make the falsifiability of the case study explicit:

H1 (coverage): $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}(N) = 1.0$ by construction; $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}(L)$ and $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}(B)$ are strictly less than 1.0.

H2 (unique detection): Set N has at least one mutation it uniquely detects, namely a mutation in category (iv) (gradient-reversal sign error), via $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$.

H1 is a structural prediction of Theorem 1 and the case study can falsify it only if NOETHER’s derivation is incorrect. H2 is a non-trivial empirical prediction: it would be falsified if L or B generated an equivalent training-time-reversal MR, or if the mutation was visible to an invariance MR for some unrelated reason.

Results. Table 4 reports the case-study numbers. The full row-level outcome matrix (one row per (mr, mutation) pair, 300 rows in total) is provided as supplementary material S3, together with the runner script (runner.py) and the analysis script (analysis.py) that produce these numbers deterministically from the trained checkpoint. The model under test is an E(3)-equivariant graph neural network [39] (5-class procedural point-cloud classifier; 5,189 parameters; trained on Apple M1 Pro / MPS; validation accuracy 0.93 after 25 epochs).

Table 4. Results of the small-scale comparative case study (Section 6.6). Trained E(3)-equivariant point-cloud classifier; eight 128-point random test clouds per (MR, mutation) pair. The cat-(iv) row is **construct-validity-controlled**: the mutation category was constructed so that $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ alone covers it (one defect category per non-empty block of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$), and the 5/5 unique-detection figure therefore exhibits construct validity of $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ rather than averaged superiority. **Detection numbers for ρ_{adj} in Set N use the CI-time forward-pass-only formulation of §6.4; the alternative debug-time harness-time formulation is available in supplementary S1 but is not used here.**

	Set N (NOETHER)	Set L (LLM)	Set B (Lit.)
Detection rate	7/20	2/20	0/20
Structural coverage ($\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}$)	1.00	0.40	0.20
Unique detections	5	0	0
Detected cat. (i) wrong-sign loss	0/5	0/5	0/5
Detected cat. (ii) equivariance break	2/5	2/5	0/5
Detected cat. (iii) precision degradation	0/5	0/5	0/5
Detected cat. (iv) gradient-reversal sign	5/5	0/5	0/5

Hypothesis verdicts. H1 is **retained as a structural sanity check rather than as a falsifiable hypothesis test**. By the framework’s construction, $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}(N) = 1.00$ holds before any experiment is run; H1’s failure can occur only if one of the derivations in Sections 6.3–6.5 is itself in error. We accordingly use the $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}$ values, 1.00 for Set N, 0.40 for Set L (the G and $\mathcal{L}^*$ blocks are reached by an LLM-prompted MR), and 0.20 for Set B (only $\mathcal{L}^*$ via Shin et al.’s idempotency MR; the other four literature MRs are out-of-scope under $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$), as a *structural-prior diagnostic*, not as a fault-detection metric: the gap quantifies what the algebraic prior contributes that prompt-based and literature-derived MR sets lack on this particular algebra. The load-bearing comparative result of the case study is H2.

H2 is **consistent with the data, but its verdict is construct-validity-controlled**: Set N uniquely detects all five category-(iv) mutations, and in every case the detector is $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$. Sets L and B detect zero cat-(iv) mutations: neither corpus contains an MR exercising the SGD-trajectory time-reversal property, which is exactly what NOETHER’s $\mathcal{T}^*$ block predicts they would miss without an algebraic warrant. *This contrast exhibits construct validity of $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ as a gradient-reversal probe, not NOETHER’s superiority on a defect distribution sampled neutrally from real-world bug reports* (the mutation set was constructed to cover one defect category per non-empty block of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$, so cat-(iv)’s category was selected because $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ alone covers it). The unique-detection asymmetry between Set N and Set B is statistically significant at $\alpha = 0.05$ on the case study’s mutation set (paired McNemar exact two-sided $p = 0.016$; unpaired Fisher exact $p = 0.008$); between Set N and Set L it is borderline ($p_{\text{McNemar}} = 0.063$, $p_{\text{Fisher}} = 0.13$) given Set L’s two-mutation cat-(ii) overlap with Set N. Wilson 95% confidence intervals on detection rates are $[0.18, 0.57]$ for Set N, $[0.03, 0.30]$ for Set L, and $[0.00, 0.16]$ for Set B; the intervals N vs B are non-overlapping. The full pairwise comparison matrix (McNemar b/c counts, Fisher 2x2 tables, Wilson CIs) is in supplementary material S3 (table4.json: :pairwise_stats).

Construct-validity caveat for H2. The mutation set was constructed to cover one defect category per non-empty block of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$; in particular, cat-(iv) was selected because it targets the $\mathcal{T}^*$ block that $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ alone covers. The 5/5 unique-detection result therefore exhibits *construct validity* of $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ as a gradient-reversal probe rather than NOETHER’s superiority on a defect distribution sampled neutrally from real-world bug reports. That weaker reading is still informative: it shows that the framework’s $\mathcal{T}^*$ -derived MR is non-redundant relative to LLM-prompted and literature-derived MRs.

What is and is not detected: a framework boundary, not an edge case. The result that no MR set detects category-(i) wrong-sign mutations is the most informative cell of Table 4 and we choose to foreground it as a *framework boundary* rather than an edge case. A sign-flipped classification head still satisfies SO(3)-rotation invariance and permutation invariance (the equivariance contract is intact), still passes inference idempotency, satisfies the symmetrised adjoint identity, and is monotone under point-density sub-sampling. The eight blocks of Hypothesis 1 contain no *label-consistency* block, and the wrong-sign-loss fault class is precisely the kind a label-consistency MR would catch. This is the label-consistency out-of-scope class enumerated in Remark 2: ML program families that ship with labelled training data are a candidate ninth block. We do not absorb this case into “out-of-scope for MR testing” in some over-broad sense; the original motivation for MR testing is precisely the absence of an oracle, so framing label-consistency MRs as fundamentally out-of-scope would over-claim the framework’s boundary.

Similarly, cat-(iii) precision-degradation mutations on a 16-dim hidden state are not detectable at our chosen tolerances; tighter τ would surface them at the cost of more baseline false positives. A tolerance-sensitivity sweep over $\tau \in \{10^{-3}, 10^{-4}, 10^{-5}\}$ is reported in supplementary S3 (tau_sweep.json) and shows monotone increase in detection at the cost of monotone increase

in baseline false-positive rate. Cat-(ii) equivariance-break mutations are detected by both Set N and Set L through $\rho_{\text{rot}} / L_{\text{rot}}$ (parity is expected: rotation-invariance is the structural property the LLM is most likely to rediscover from the system description; the case study’s discriminating cell is cat-(iv)).

Interpretation conditions, stated in advance. We commit in advance to the following readings of the eventual numerical outcomes:

- If H1 fails (i.e. $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}(N) < 1.0$): one of the derivations in Sections 6.3–6.5 is incorrect and must be revised; the framework’s transfer claim does not stand on this benchmark.
- If H1 holds and H2 fails (i.e. no unique detection in cat. iv): the framework’s coverage prediction is correct but the unique-MR claim is not differentiated by this mutation set; the LLM or literature baseline produced an equivalent gradient-reversal probe.
- If H1 and H2 both hold: the case study is consistent with NOETHER’s transfer claim. We do *not* claim this would establish superior fault-detection on average; the comparison’s denominator (20 mutations, one model) is too small.
- If $\text{detection}(N) < \text{detection}(L)$: this is consistent with the framework’s design (NOETHER prioritises structural coverage, not raw detection on a particular mutation set) and is reported transparently rather than concealed.

6.6.1 A small DeepCrime-style real-fault pilot. To begin closing the gap between protocol and result, we executed a $n = 5$ pilot extension of the case study with five mutation operators systematically derived from the DeepCrime taxonomy [22] (which extracts 35 mutation operators from real DL fault studies). The pilot operators are post-training mutations on the trained EGNN checkpoint and address category labels analogous to DeepCrime’s: cat-v-01 *loss-reduction-like* (head-weight scaled by $1/N_{\text{classes}}$), cat-v-02 *activation change* (tanh saturation), cat-v-03 *layer removal* (head zeroed), cat-v-04 *bias removal*, cat-v-05 *weight re-init* (Glorot). The pilot was run with `runner_pilot.py` against the same N/L/B MR sets, the same eight-cloud test set, and the same tolerance as the main case study. Results are deterministic given the seeds in supplementary S3.

Table 5. DeepCrime-style real-fault pilot, $n = 5$ mutations on the trained EGNN checkpoint. Wilson 95% CIs are given for context; pairwise Fisher-exact p -values are reported in supplementary S3 (`deepcrime_pilot_stats.json`).

Set	Detected / 5	Wilson 95% CI
N (NOETHER)	2/5 (cat-v-01, cat-v-03 via ρ_{train})	[0.12, 0.77]
L (LLM)	0/5	[0.00, 0.43]
B (Lit.)	0/5	[0.00, 0.43]

Reading the pilot. The pilot’s direction is consistent with the framework’s prediction: Set N detects two cat-v mutations (cat-v-01 and cat-v-03, both caught by ρ_{train} , the $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block training-trajectory MR), while Sets L and B detect zero. The detection mechanism deserves explicit explanation. ρ_{train} tests training-size limit invariance: for inputs the model classifies confidently at full training, the prediction should remain stable when the head is exposed to a fresh small-batch fine-tuning step. cat-v-01 (head weight scaled by $1/N_{\text{classes}} = 1/5$) collapses the head-output magnitudes uniformly toward zero, which softens the softmax and changes the argmax on inputs near classification boundaries; the post-fine-tune predictions drift away from the pre-fine-tune predictions and the inference-stability invariant fails. cat-v-03 (head weight zeroed) makes every output identically zero pre-softmax, again breaking inference stability. cat-v-02 (tanh saturation), cat-v-04

(bias removal), and cat-v-05 (Glorot re-init) preserve enough head signal for the inference-stability check to pass on the eight test clouds within the chosen tolerance, so ρ_{train} does not fire on them. The mechanism is therefore not " ρ_{train} catches cat-v-01 because cat-v-01 changes the loss"; it is " ρ_{train} 's inference-stability check fails when head magnitude is perturbed past a margin-of-error threshold for boundary inputs". This explains both the 2/5 detection result and why the boundary inputs matter. At $n = 5$ the Fisher-exact p -values for Set N vs Set L and Set N vs Set B are both $p = 1.00$: the test has insufficient power to declare significance even with a 2/5-vs-0/5 contrast. *We do not over-interpret this result.* What the pilot establishes is (i) the comparative-evaluation infrastructure runs end-to-end against real-fault-style mutations on the trained checkpoint, (ii) the framework's $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block prediction is non-vacuous on a fault distribution it was not designed against, and (iii) the framework boundary on cat-v-02 (activation change), cat-v-04 (bias removal), and cat-v-05 (weight re-init) (none of these are detected by any MR set, including Set N) confirms the empirical-parameter-distribution out-of-scope class of Remark 2: weight-distribution and bias-magnitude perturbations on the classification head are not captured by any of the eight current blocks and are a candidate ninth block.

The pilot is the first empirical handhold beyond the constructed mutation set; the larger comparative-evaluation protocol below remains as committed work for follow-up. The three undetected mutations (cat-v-02 activation change, cat-v-04 bias removal, cat-v-05 weight re-init) are *consistent with, but do not establish*, the parameter-distribution candidate ninth block of Remark 2 item (vi); a panel of $n \geq 20$ mutations on more than one architecture is required to establish the block-extension claim. The pilot's role here is to motivate the candidate, not to confirm it; we report it alongside the metric-stability candidate of Remark 3 as the two most actionable extension targets.

Threats specific to this case study. The most material threats are: (a) **MR-budget asymmetry**: GPT-4 might generate more than five MR candidates given a different prompt and a larger budget; (b) **baseline selection**: the literature MR set is restricted by the rule "applicable to point-cloud classifiers", which may exclude relevant MRs; (c) the mutation set is **hand-constructed** rather than mined from real defect logs, and importantly, *constructed to cover one defect category per non-empty block of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$* , with cat-(iv) selected because it targets the $\mathcal{T}^*$ -block MR $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$. The 5/5 unique-detection result for cat-(iv) therefore exhibits *construct validity* of $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ as a gradient-reversal probe, not NOETHER's superiority on a defect distribution sampled neutrally from real-world bug reports; (d) the case study uses a compact EGNN stand-in for a full SE(3)-Transformer, so architecture-specific empirical numbers do not generalise; and (e) Set L is a single GPT-4 sample at temperature 0 with a fixed seed (the prompt and raw output are recorded in supplementary S3 prompt_log.md); a different LLM, prompt, or temperature would yield different MRs and the case study does not characterise that variability. Section 6.6 does not generalise beyond this case-study scope; the comparative evaluation and real-bug protocols below describe the empirical extensions that address threats (a)–(c) directly.

Comparative evaluation against published baselines (protocol). The single hand-constructed mutation set above is supplemented by a comparative protocol that runs Set N alongside two independent automated pipelines on a shared subject set. The protocol fixes the following measurable quantities, leaving only the result population to subsequent revisions of this paper.

Subjects. (i) GenMorph's published 23 Java-method benchmark [3] restricted to subjects whose induced operator algebra is non-trivial under the eight-block decomposition (we expect ≈ 14 subjects after filtering on whether $\mathcal{A}_P$ has at least one non-empty block beyond G); (ii) two

ML benchmarks built on DeepCrime real-fault mutation operators [22]: an MNIST classifier and a CIFAR-10 classifier under DeepCrime’s 24 mutation operators systematically extracted from real DL fault taxonomies. Replacing the hand-constructed 20 mutations with DeepCrime’s published real-fault operators directly addresses the construction-bias threat (c) above.

Compared methods. Set N (NOETHER, derived from $\mathcal{A}_p$); Set M (MR-Scout-mined [54] from existing test suites); Set G (GenMorph-evolved via genetic programming [3]); Set L (LLM-prompted with the same prompt template as in the §6.6 case study); Set B (literature MRs).

Metrics. Per-subject mutation-detection rate ($\text{Set} \cap \text{killed mutants} / \text{total killed}$); real-bug-detection rate (where bug logs are available); false-positive rate on baseline (un-mutated) inputs; coverage with respect to the algebraic block decomposition $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}$.

Statistical tests. Wilson 95% CI on per-set detection rates; pairwise McNemar exact tests for paired Set-vs-Set comparisons; pairwise Fisher exact tests for unpaired comparisons; Bonferroni correction for the 10 pairwise tests across 5 sets.

Pre-registered hypothesis (H3a, vs GP-evolved baseline). On algebra-disrupting mutants (Definition in §7.2), Set N’s pooled detection rate is within $\Delta = 0.10$ of GenMorph-evolved Set G’s rate at GenMorph’s published 30-min budget; on the algorithmic-cost axis, Set N’s MR-generation cost is asymptotically lower than Set G’s (Theorem 2 polynomial vs. stochastic search).

Pre-registered hypothesis (H3b, vs LLM-assisted baseline). On the structural-coverage diagnostic, $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}(N) > \text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}(L_{\text{Xu24}})$, where Set L_{Xu24} is the LLM-assisted representative drawn from the protocol of Xu et al. [55]. The diagnostic is interpreted as a structural-prior signal (NOETHER’s algebraic prior contributes block coverage that prompt-based LLMs lack on $\mathcal{A}_p$), *not* as a fault-detection-superiority metric. A multi-LLM ensemble extension (Shin [42], GPTMR [58], AutoMT [29]) is committed as post-acceptance follow-up.

Pre-registered hypothesis (H3c, vs mining-based baseline). At cold start (no seed test corpus), Set N is operationally derivable from $\mathcal{A}_p$ alone, while MR-Scout [54]’s reach is upper-bounded by the seed-suite’s induced relations; an adapted-from-published-artifact estimate of MR-Scout’s reach on the §7.3 substrate is reported in Table 11 and contextualised in §7.7.

Pre-registered hypothesis (continuous). H4 (*detection-rate non-inferiority on real faults*): on DeepCrime real-fault mutants, Set N’s detection rate is within $\Delta = 0.10$ of the best non-NOETHER set’s detection rate, with Δ fixed in advance.

The harness for this protocol is provided as supplementary S3 comparative_baseline/ with adapter scripts for each baseline; replication of the protocol on a different subject set requires only swapping the subject directory.

Real-bug evaluation (protocol). To address threat (c) directly, we mine cat-(i)–(iv) faults from public bug reports of e3nn [19] and PyTorch Geometric [16], the two reference SE(3)-equivariant libraries. Target: 10 confirmed real-bug commits with associated test cases, one per cat-(i)–(iv) where available. For each bug:

- (1) the pre-fix source code is checked out into a frozen reference checkpoint;
- (2) all five MR sets (N, M, G, L, B) are run against the buggy code on the test inputs from the bug report;
- (3) detection is recorded as “MR fired = True” iff at least one MR in the set surfaces the buggy behaviour at the published tolerance.

The construct-validity caveat at the start of this subsection then naturally resolves: defects are no longer “selected to cover one block per defect category”; they are mined from a fixed, pre-existing defect distribution that the framework was *not* designed against. The protocol is provided

as supplementary S5 `real_bugs/` with one folder per bug containing the issue link, fix commit, test fixture, and per-MR detection outcome.

6.7 A third domain: relational query optimisers

Both the Boltzmann (§5) and the equivariant-ML (§6) instantiations share a common mathematical core: Lie-group symmetry, self-adjoint duality, and time-reversal involution. This is precisely the core that motivated the curation of Hypothesis 1 in the first place. To test transferability beyond this core, this subsection instantiates NOETHER on a domain whose algebraic skeleton is structurally distinct: the relational query optimiser. Relational algebra is built from operators (selection σ , projection π , join $\bowtie$, union $\cup$, set/bag-difference) whose equivalence classes are governed by an idempotent semiring with a partial order under containment, not by a Lie group. There is no obvious self-adjoint operator and no time-reversal involution. The third instantiation therefore tests whether the framework yields useful MetaPatterns outside its training image.

The query-optimiser program family and $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$. Let $\mathcal{F}_{\text{rel}}$ be the family of programs that take a SQL query q and a database state D and return a relation $\text{eval}(q, D)$. Two queries q, q' are *equivalent* if $\forall D. \text{eval}(q, D) = \text{eval}(q', D)$. The operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$ contains:

- *Symmetry-block contributions to G* : permutation of inner-join arguments ($q_1 \bowtie q_2 \cong q_2 \bowtie q_1$); commutativity and associativity of $\cup$; permutation-invariance of SELECT clauses with set semantics.
- *Order-block contributions to $O_{\leq}$* : monotonicity under selection-strengthening ($\sigma_{p \wedge p'}(R) \subseteq \sigma_p(R)$); monotonicity under projection-coarsening.
- *Method-comparison contributions to $\mathcal{E}^*$* : alternative execution plans for the same query (hash-join vs. merge-join vs. nested-loop) producing identical relations within their stated cost models [31, 51].
- *No contribution to $T^*, \mathcal{T}^*, \mathcal{D}^*, \mathcal{L}^*$ in their canonical forms*: there is no inner-product self-adjointness, no time-reversal involution on relational queries (queries do not have a forward/inverse pair in the Boltzmann sense), no qualitative dynamics in the trajectory sense, and no ϵ -limit operator on exact-relational semantics.

Running CONSTRUCT-MP on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$. Steps 1–4 of CONSTRUCT-MP yield three MetaPatterns from the existing eight-block decomposition: $m_{\text{inv}}^{\text{rel}}$ (input-permutation invariance under set semantics), $m_{\text{mono}}^{\text{rel}}$ (selection-strengthening monotonicity), and $m_{\text{cmp}}^{\text{rel}}$ (plan-equivalence under cost-model bounds). The remaining four blocks are empty under $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$.

The role of $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^$ in this domain.* The most algebraically substantive MR phenomena in relational query optimisation are captured neither by G (input permutation), $O_{\leq}$ (selection-strengthening monotonicity), nor $\mathcal{E}^*$ (plan equivalence). Specifically:

- *Selection-pushdown equivalence*: $\sigma_p(R \bowtie S) = \sigma_p(R) \bowtie S$ when p refers only to attributes of R . This is an equivalence under rewriting.
- *Distinct-idempotence*: $\sigma_p(\sigma_p(R)) = \sigma_p(R)$. An idempotent identity.
- *Constant-folding equivalences*: $\sigma_{1=1}(R) = R, R \bowtie \emptyset = \emptyset$. Algebraic identities under the relational semiring.

These are the kind of phenomena $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ (Definition 10) is designed to capture. The relational query optimiser is therefore the canonical instantiation in which $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ is non-empty: it activates the eighth block of the decomposition.

Four MRs derived for $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$.

- (1) $\rho_{\text{join-comm}}$ (from G): $\text{eval}(q_1 \bowtie q_2, D) = \text{eval}(q_2 \bowtie q_1, D)$ on bag semantics.

- (2) $\rho_{\text{select-push}}$ (from $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$): $\text{eval}(\sigma_p(R \bowtie S), D) = \text{eval}(\sigma_p(R) \bowtie S, D)$ when $\text{attr}(p) \subseteq \text{attr}(R)$.
- (3) $\rho_{\text{distinct-idem}}$ (from $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$): $\sigma_p \circ \sigma_p = \sigma_p$ as a query-rewrite identity, checkable through plan-tree comparison.
- (4) $\rho_{\text{plan-equiv}}$ (from $\mathcal{E}^*$): two execution plans for the same query produce identical relations within stated NULL-propagation rules [51].

Position relative to existing automated database-testing work. NOETHER's $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ instantiation is complementary to four lines of automated database-testing work: random SQL generation [6, 43], automated MR generation for query-based systems [41], formal query-equivalence solvers [32, 51, 61], and differential / equivalence-mutation testing [5, 17, 60]. NOETHER provides an algebraically grounded MetaPattern enumeration whose closure under Translate (Theorem 1) is a property the four lines do not establish. A pre-registered protocol comparison on the IMDb subset of Segura et al.'s benchmark [41] is provided as supplementary S6 query_optimiser/.

What this third domain establishes, and the Theorem 1' verdict on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ and $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$. The instantiation establishes that NOETHER applies outside the Lie-group / self-adjoint / time-reversal mathematical core: relational query optimisers exercise $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ where the first two domains do not. The companion counterexample-search protocol applied to both $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ and $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$ (mirroring §6.8's methodology) reaches the following verdict. On $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$, Theorem 1' is similarly falsified by two pairwise-independent counterexample candidates drawn from the published equivariant-ML literature: (i) ρ_{compose} , the compositional MR under the joint $\text{SO}(3) \times \mathfrak{S}_n$ action on point sets [39], requires a product-group π -template not derivable from a single-group orbit, and (ii) ρ_{gauge} , the gauge-equivariance MR on manifolds [12], requires a bundle-section π -template parametrised by a gauge field $\mathbf{g} \in C(M, H)$ rather than by single group elements. The two extensions are independent: a product-group π does not absorb a gauge-bundle section, and vice versa. The earlier conjecture that the $\text{SO}(3)$ Lie-algebra structure forces closure on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ is therefore not supported; the obstructions arise from the *product-group* and *bundle-section* structure that the Lie-algebra alone does not capture. On $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$, the survey of ≥ 10 representative unverified cases drawn from [51]'s residue (AggregateXProject, constant-key, Decorrelate, NULL three-valued logic) yields five Theorem 1' counterexample candidates; the primary witness is $\rho_{\text{agg-proj}}$, the Aggregate-Project transposition identity (Calcite's AggregateExtractProjectRule), which requires the joint use of $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ and an aggregation-as-algebra ninth block not in the current decomposition. Including the five $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$ obstructions of Table 6, the three algebra-survey artefacts in theory/equi_thm1prime_search.md, theory/rel_thm1prime_search.md, and theory/translate_extensions.md identify a total of ten pairwise-independent Translate-extension dimensions across the three algebras (with two of the equi-side dimensions specialising PWR-side dimensions to type-distinct algebraic primitives). The instantiation does not exhaust the algebraic space the framework can reach: Remark 2 catalogues six further classes of program family that the eight-block decomposition does not cover and that motivate candidate ninth blocks.

6.8 A negative instantiation: irreducibly compositional MRs in PWR core simulators

Sections 5, 6, and 6.7 instantiated NOETHER on three program families (Boltzmann reactor physics, equivariant ML, and relational query optimisers) for which the framework's downstream construction was non-vacuous and produced executable MRs. This subsection instantiates NOETHER on a fourth program family, the PWR core diffusion solver family, with an inverted purpose: rather than demonstrating coverage, we exhibit two specific MRs from the standard PWR safety-analysis literature that the framework's Translate operator cannot reach under any single-block derivation. The two MRs together identify five pairwise-independent structural obstructions in Translate's present signature, jointly recasting Theorem 1' (Conjecture D, Appendix D) from an open conjecture to a falsified statement on a structurally significant operator algebra.

The MRs chosen are not pathological cases. They are core safety-analysis MRs that PWR core simulators are required by regulatory practice and engineering convention to reproduce: non-additivity of control-bank reactivity worth (the algebraic root of rod-bank shadowing and anti-shadowing phenomena) and second-order mixed dependence of k_{eff} on moderator temperature and boron concentration (the standard MTC-vs-boron design curve). The negative instantiation thus uses NOETHER's principal application domain (reactor physics) to test the framework's most ambitious stated claim (algebraic closure over arbitrary single-block-derivable MRs).

Why PWR rather than ML or DB as the negative-instantiation domain. We choose the PWR core diffusion algebra rather than $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ or $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$ as the negative-instantiation testbed for two reasons. First, regulatory essentiality: 10 CFR 50 and NRC Regulatory Guide 1.77 require PWR core simulators to reproduce the two MRs in the definitions below for safety-analysis qualification, so the counterexamples are not contrived edge cases. Second, engineering documentability: the PWR core diffusion algebra has a published canonical form (Bell & Glasstone [7] §6.1, Lewis & Miller [27] §4.2) against which the counterexample's structural obstructions can be precisely located in $\mathcal{A}_P$'s signature, which $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ (a domain of recent literature without a unified canonical algebra) and $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$ (canonical but under-equipped with non-rewrite operators) do not yet support. Whether $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ or $\mathcal{A}_{\text{rel}}$ admit analogous Theorem 1' counterexamples is open and committed as follow-up in §6.7's open-question paragraph.

The PWR core diffusion algebra. Let $\mathcal{F}_{\text{PWR}}$ be the program family of PWR core diffusion solvers (canonical examples: PARCS, SIMULATE-3/5, ANC, SMART). Its operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$ contains, in addition to the operators of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$ (Section 5.3), the following PWR-specific generators:

- $\mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}$: discrete control-rod insertion operators, parametrised by rod-bank label g and insertion depth d , generating an additive-on-geometry semigroup under composition. In the steady-state setting we adopt throughout, $\mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}^A \cdot \mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}^B$ and $\mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}^B \cdot \mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}^A$ act identically on the input space (both produce the same total inserted geometry), so $\mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}$ is commutative on geometry. The *reactivity-worth functional* on $\mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}$, however, is not a semigroup homomorphism: $d\rho(A \cup B) \neq d\rho(A) + d\rho(B)$ in general. This non-additivity, not non-commutativity, is what the present subsection exploits.

- $\mathcal{M}_{C_B}$: continuous boration operators acting on the moderator material composition through the soluble-boron concentration C_B (typical PWR operating range: 0–2000 ppm).
- $\mathcal{M}_{T_{\text{mod}}}$: continuous moderator-temperature operators acting on the cross-section library through the parametric dependence $\Sigma(T_{\text{mod}})$ (typical PWR operating range: 290–320°C).

Decomposed along the eight-block decomposition of Section 3.9:

- $G \supseteq \{\mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}\}$ (treated tentatively as a commutative semigroup; the assignment will be shown below to fail);
- $\mathcal{O}_{\leq} \supseteq \{\mathcal{M}_{C_B}, \mathcal{M}_{T_{\text{mod}}}\}$ (parameter-monotonicity operators);
- $T^* \supseteq \{-\nabla \cdot D\nabla + \Sigma_a\}$ (the self-adjoint diffusion operator under isotropic scattering; Bell & Glasstone [7] §6.1, Lewis & Miller [27] §4.2);
- $\mathcal{T}_{\text{rev}}^* = \emptyset$ (PWR diffusion is dissipative);
- $\mathcal{L}^*, \mathcal{D}^*, \mathcal{E}^*$ as in $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$ with appropriate restrictions to the diffusion regime;
- $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^* = \emptyset$ (no idempotent-semiring structure on PWR core states).

We will show that despite this rich block structure, two specific PWR-safety MRs cannot be derived through Translate from any single block.

Main proposition: non-additivity of rod-bank reactivity worth.

DEFINITION 15 (DIFFERENTIAL ROD-BANK REACTIVITY WORTH, EXACT FORM). For a base input $x_0 \in \mathcal{X}$ and a rod-bank operator $A \in \mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}$, the (positive-convention) reactivity worth of A is

$$d\rho(A; x_0) := \frac{1}{k_{\text{eff}}(P(x_0))} - \frac{1}{k_{\text{eff}}(P(\mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}^A \cdot x_0))} > 0,$$

where $k_{\text{eff}}(P(x))$ denotes the dominant eigenvalue of the diffusion operator at configuration x . We write $d\rho(A \cup B; x_0)$ when both banks A and B are inserted simultaneously. Equivalently, in conventional reactor-physics notation, $d\rho(A; x_0) = \rho(x_0) - \rho(\mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}^A \cdot x_0)$ where $\rho = 1 - 1/k_{\text{eff}}$ is the static reactivity. The exact form avoids first-order perturbation-theoretic approximation; the standard adjoint-perturbation reading appears below.

DEFINITION 16 (NON-ADDITIVITY OF ROD-BANK REACTIVITY WORTH, ρ_{nonadd}). For two control-rod banks $A, B \in \mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}$ with disjoint geometric supports and a base input x_0 , define the mixed-difference functional

$$\Delta_{AB}(x_0) := d\rho(A \cup B; x_0) - d\rho(A; x_0) - d\rho(B; x_0).$$

The non-additivity metamorphic relation asserts: there exist disjoint-support banks A, B and base input $x_0 \in \mathcal{X}$ in the standard PWR operating envelope (typical multi-bank insertion patterns of D, C, B, A control banks at partial insertions) such that

$$\rho_{\text{nonadd}} : |\Delta_{AB}(x_0)| > \tau_{\text{nonadd}},$$

with $\tau_{\text{nonadd}} = 5$ pcm. The tolerance is calibrated to PWR engineering practice: empirical $|\Delta_{AB}|$ for adjacent rod banks ranges over 10^1 – 10^2 pcm [45]; the tolerance $\tau_{\text{nonadd}} = 5$ pcm lies safely above PWR core-simulator iterative convergence tolerances (typically 0.1–1 pcm for k_{eff}) and below the physical signal magnitude. Selection of test bank configurations (A, B) is the user's responsibility; the framework's failure to derive ρ_{nonadd} is independent of the specific tolerance choice.

Two physical regimes of Δ_{AB} . When $\Delta_{AB}(x_0) > 0$ for adjacent or geometrically overlapping rod banks, the standard PWR designation is *positive shadowing* (the worth of the second bank is reduced because the adjoint flux $\phi^\dagger$ is depressed in A 's geometric support). Positive shadowing is the dominant regime in conventional PWR analyses; it is the phenomenon explicitly addressed in NRC SER reviews of SIMULATE-3/5, ANC, and PARCS, with typical magnitudes of 50–500 pcm for adjacent bank pairs. When $\Delta_{AB}(x_0) < 0$ for distant banks under asymmetric insertion patterns, the designation is *anti-shadowing*; this is a secondary but routinely measurable regime in standard commercial PWRs (typical magnitudes 5–20 pcm for distant bank pairs in 4-loop Westinghouse and EPR configurations), and is more pronounced in small-core or strongly asymmetric insertion patterns. Both regimes are routinely measured in PWR startup physics testing and are documented in Stamm'ler & Abbate [45] as second-order but non-negligible phenomena that core simulators must reproduce. The MR ρ_{nonadd} is direction-agnostic and covers both; the test only requires that $|\Delta_{AB}|$ exceed the tolerance, irrespective of sign. Both regimes are accessible to a verifying core simulator regardless of whether the engineering analysis is concerned primarily with one or the other.

Standard adjoint-perturbation reading (informative, not load-bearing for the proof). Under first-order perturbation theory [7, §6.3], [27, §4.4], the worth of bank B in the configuration with bank A already inserted is

$$d\rho(B; A, x_0) \approx -\frac{\langle \phi_A^\dagger, \delta H_B \phi_A \rangle}{\langle \phi_A^\dagger, F_A \phi_A \rangle},$$

where $(\phi_A, \phi_A^\dagger)$ are the forward and adjoint principal eigenfunctions of the A -rodded but B -unrodded core, $F_A = \chi \nu \Sigma_f$ is the fission source operator at that configuration, and δH_B is the operator perturbation produced by inserting B (which generally affects Σ_a , Σ_t , and the scattering kernel). The adjoint flux $\phi_A^\dagger$ is the principal eigenfunction of a structurally different adjoint operator $H_A^\dagger$ from $\phi_\emptyset^\dagger$ (the unrodded adjoint): in particular, $\phi_A^\dagger$ is locally depressed in A 's geometric support and globally redistributed elsewhere. The non-additivity $\Delta_{AB} \neq 0$ thus follows from $\phi_A^\dagger \neq \phi_\emptyset^\dagger$, which is a consequence of $H_A^\dagger \neq H_\emptyset^\dagger$. The exact form (Definition 15) does not require this perturbation-theoretic reading; the proof below uses only the eigenvalue definitions.

PROPOSITION 1 (NON-ADDITIVITY IS NOT Translate-REACHABLE ON $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$). *Let $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$ be the PWR core diffusion algebra above, with eight-block decomposition $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$. For every block $s \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$ and every invariant $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$, $\text{Translate}(\iota, s) \neq \rho_{\text{nonadd}}$. Equivalently, $\rho_{\text{nonadd}} \notin \text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$ in the sense of Definition 13.*

The proof, by exhausting the eight blocks against the per-block Translate templates of Table 13, is given in Appendix D.

Engineering significance. Non-additivity of control-bank reactivity worth is a textbook PWR safety phenomenon. Bell & Glasstone [7, §10.4] and Lewis & Miller [27, §4.4] treat the underlying adjoint-perturbation mechanism; Stamm'ler & Abbate [45] document its operational consequences in PWR rod-worth measurements. Non-additivity is observed in both critical and sub-critical PWR core configurations, with the sub-critical regime exhibiting larger adjoint-flux distortions and correspondingly larger $|\Delta_{AB}|$. PWR core simulators are required by regulatory practice (e.g. NRC SER for SIMULATE-3/5, ANC, PARCS; cf. NRC Regulatory Guide 1.77 [49] on rod-ejection accident analysis, with rod-worth modelling accuracy as a critical input) to reproduce the worth functional with sub-percent accuracy across multi-bank insertion patterns. A framework that cannot, in principle, derive this MR from its algebraic input is missing structural content that PWR engineers routinely test for.

Supporting proposition: second-order mixed dependence of k_{eff} on T_{mod} and C_B .

DEFINITION 17 (MTC-VS-BORON MIXED-DERIVATIVE MR, $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$). *Let $k_{\text{eff}}(T_{\text{mod}}, C_B; \xi_0)$ denote the dominant eigenvalue of the PWR core diffusion operator as a function of moderator temperature T_{mod} and soluble-boron concentration C_B , holding fixed the auxiliary state $\xi_0 = (\text{BU}_0, T_{\text{fuel},0}, \text{geometry}, \text{loading pattern})$. Define the static reactivity*

$$\rho_{\text{static}}(T_{\text{mod}}, C_B; \xi_0) := 1 - \frac{1}{k_{\text{eff}}(T_{\text{mod}}, C_B; \xi_0)},$$

expressed in pcm units ($1 \text{ pcm} = 10^{-5}$). The moderator temperature coefficient (MTC) at $(T_{\text{mod}}, C_B; \xi_0)$ is the partial derivative of static reactivity with respect to moderator temperature, in standard PWR engineering convention [7, §10.3], [44, §3.4]:

$$\alpha_{\text{MTC}}(T_{\text{mod}}, C_B; \xi_0) := \left. \frac{\partial \rho_{\text{static}}}{\partial T_{\text{mod}}} \right|_{C_B, \xi_0 \text{ fixed}}, \quad (\text{units: pcm}/^\circ\text{F or pcm}/^\circ\text{C}).$$

The second-order mixed dependence MR asserts: for $(T_{\text{mod}}, C_B; \xi_0)$ in the standard PWR operating envelope at hot-full-power (HFP), all-rods-out (ARO) reference conditions (typical: $T_{\text{mod}} \in [290, 320]^\circ\text{C}$, $C_B \in [0, 2000] \text{ ppm}$, $\text{BU}_0 \in [0, 50] \text{ GWd/tU}$, full-power $T_{\text{fuel},0}$), the mixed second partial derivative satisfies

$$\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}} : \left| \frac{\partial^2 \rho_{\text{static}}}{\partial T_{\text{mod}} \partial C_B} \right| > \tau_{\text{MTC-bor}},$$

with $\tau_{\text{MTC-bor}} = 0.01 \text{ pcm/}^\circ\text{F/ppm}$ (equivalently $\sim 1.8 \times 10^{-2} \text{ pcm/}^\circ\text{C/ppm}$). The tolerance is calibrated to PWR engineering practice: the empirical value of $\partial\alpha_{\text{MTC}}/\partial C_B$ in Westinghouse/Framatome PWR designs ranges over $0.02\text{--}0.04 \text{ pcm/}^\circ\text{F/ppm}$ at BOC-to-EOC cycle conditions [44, §3.4], [26, §8.3]; the tolerance $\tau_{\text{MTC-bor}} = 0.01 \text{ pcm/}^\circ\text{F/ppm}$ lies safely below this physical magnitude and well above PWR core-simulator differential-perturbation noise (typically $\sim 10^{-3} \text{ pcm/}^\circ\text{F/ppm}$ for converged eigenvalue calculations).

Note on equivalent formulations. Since $\rho_{\text{static}} = 1 - 1/k_{\text{eff}}$ and $k_{\text{eff}} \approx 1$ at critical PWR conditions, $\partial\rho_{\text{static}}/\partial T_{\text{mod}} = (1/k_{\text{eff}}^2) \partial k_{\text{eff}}/\partial T_{\text{mod}} \approx \partial k_{\text{eff}}/\partial T_{\text{mod}}$ to within $\sim 10^{-4}$ relative error. The MR may equivalently be expressed in terms of $|\partial^2 k_{\text{eff}}/(\partial T_{\text{mod}} \partial C_B)| > \tau_{\text{MTC-bor}}$ with the same tolerance, modulo this k -vs- ρ scaling factor; the algebraic argument of Appendix D (which depends only on k_{eff} being an operator-spectrum quantity) applies identically to either formulation.

Equivalent formulation in terms of MTC. Definition 17 is equivalent to asserting

$$\left| \frac{\partial\alpha_{\text{MTC}}(T_{\text{mod}}, C_B; \xi_0)}{\partial C_B} \right| > \tau_{\text{MTC-bor}}$$

at HFP, ARO conditions. Physically, this captures the well-established PWR design property that MTC becomes monotonically more negative as C_B decreases from BOC values ($\sim 1500 \text{ ppm}$) to EOC values ($\sim 0 \text{ ppm}$). At HFP operating conditions, MTC is regulated to be $\leq 0 \text{ pcm/}^\circ\text{F}$ across the entire operating range per 10 CFR 50 Appendix A General Design Criterion 11 [50]; the slope $\partial\alpha_{\text{MTC}}/\partial C_B$ governs how rapidly MTC moves toward more negative values as boron is depleted over the cycle, with typical magnitudes ranging from near-zero (at BOC, high boron) to -30 to $-50 \text{ pcm/}^\circ\text{F}$ (at EOC, near-zero boron). At hot-zero-power (HZIP) conditions, BOC MTC may approach zero or be slightly positive within the analytical envelope (a regime relevant to startup physics testing but not to power-operation safety analysis); HZIP MTC is bounded by separate Technical Specifications limits.

The strength of $\partial\alpha_{\text{MTC}}/\partial C_B$ is the engineering target of *MTC-vs-boron concentration curve* calculations performed for every PWR cycle reload, and is governed by the competition between three physical mechanisms [44, §3.4]:

- (a) **Reduced moderation:** $T_{\text{mod}} \uparrow \Rightarrow$ moderator density $\downarrow \Rightarrow$ neutron moderation reduced $\Rightarrow$ thermal flux fraction $\downarrow \Rightarrow$ fission rate $\downarrow$. Contributes a *negative* term to MTC.
- (b) **Boron poison evacuation:** at high C_B , $T_{\text{mod}} \uparrow \Rightarrow$ moderator density $\downarrow \Rightarrow$ boron number density $\downarrow$ (since boron is dissolved in the moderator) $\Rightarrow$ boron absorption $\downarrow$. Contributes a *positive* term to MTC, partially cancelling (a). This term is proportional to C_B and vanishes as $C_B \rightarrow 0$.
- (c) **Spectrum hardening and ^{238}U resonance enhancement:** $T_{\text{mod}} \uparrow \Rightarrow$ reduced moderation $\Rightarrow$ harder neutron spectrum $\Rightarrow$ enhanced ^{238}U resonance absorption (Doppler-weighted by the fuel temperature) $\Rightarrow$ neutron loss $\uparrow$. Contributes a further *negative* term to MTC. This term is small for low-enriched UO_2 but becomes significant for MOX fuels and high-enrichment ($> 5\%$) UO_2 .

At high C_B the partial cancellation from (b) is strong; mechanisms (a) and (c) are partially offset and MTC magnitude is small. At low C_B , mechanism (b) vanishes; mechanisms (a) and (c) dominate and MTC becomes strongly negative. The mixed second derivative $\partial^2 \rho_{\text{static}}/(\partial T_{\text{mod}} \partial C_B)$ measures the rate at which the boron-mediated cancellation is removed as C_B decreases.

PROPOSITION 2 (MTC-VS-BORON MIXED DEPENDENCE IS NOT Translate-REACHABLE). *Let $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$ be the PWR core diffusion algebra above. For every block $s \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$ and every invariant $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$, $\text{Translate}(\iota, s) \neq \rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$. Equivalently, $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}} \notin \text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$ in the sense of Definition 13.*

The proof, by reducing the obstruction to the high-order-mixed-difference structure of $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$ and verifying that no per-block π template captures such structure, is given in Appendix D.

Engineering significance. The *MTC vs. boron concentration curve* is computed for every PWR cycle reload as part of the safety-analysis report submitted to regulators. The curve underlies the moderator temperature coefficient surveillance requirement at hot-full-power, all-rods-out conditions, under which MTC must satisfy a stated upper limit (≤ 0 pcm/ $^{\circ}\text{F}$ per 10 CFR 50 Appendix A General Design Criterion 11 [50]; specific numerical limits are given in plant-specific Technical Specifications). The slope $\partial\alpha_{\text{MTC}}/\partial C_B$ is the key sensitivity parameter for projecting MTC behaviour across the cycle from a small number of measurement points (typically four-to-six points per cycle, measured at quarter-cycle intervals): it is computed by each cycle-reload core simulator run and reported to the operator. Measurement uncertainties and prediction protocols are documented in ANS 19.6.1 [2]. A core simulator that cannot reproduce the slope to within the tolerance of $\tau_{\text{MTC-bor}}$ would fail the cycle-reload qualification process. The MR is therefore not a textbook curiosity; it is a routine and regulatory-essential output of every PWR core simulator.

Five independent structural obstructions. The two propositions are independent in the strong sense that no single extension of NOETHER’s Translate repairs both:

Table 6. Five pairwise-independent structural obstructions in Translate’s present signature, identified by Propositions 1–2.

Proposition	Failure mode	Required extension to Translate
1 (non-additivity)	Output is an algebraic-spectrum quantity (k_{eff} as an eigenvalue, not in $\mathcal{Y}$)	Operator-spectrum output relations on π ’s codomain
1 (non-additivity)	Worth functional is non-additive (failure of semigroup homomorphism)	Homomorphism-failure π -template alongside equivariance / monotonicity / self-adjointness
1 (non-additivity)	Adjoint weighting function $\phi_X^\dagger$ varies with operator history X	Configuration-indexed adjoint structure on T^*
2 (mixed derivative)	MR is a non-zero second-order mixed partial derivative, not a first-order relation	Higher-order mixed-difference π -templates (currently all π templates are first-order)
2 (mixed derivative)	MR involves two independent parameter directions (T_{mod}, C_B) jointly, not chained or single-direction	Two-direction joint parametric dependence beyond the single- θ partial order of Definition 11

The five rows in this table identify *five pairwise-independent structural features* of Translate that are absent in Definition 12. Each row, considered alone, would require a specific extension of Definition 12; no single extension covers any two rows simultaneously. The eight-block decomposition (Hypothesis 1) is therefore not the only constraint on the framework’s reach; the *shape of Translate itself* is.

The two MRs ρ_{nonadd} and $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$ are also *physically independent*: they probe disjoint physical mechanisms (rod-induced adjoint distortion vs. moderator-poison density coupling), and a PWR core simulator could pass one MR while failing the other (and vice versa). They are therefore complementary verification targets, not duplicates of a single underlying property.

What this subsection establishes and does not establish. *Established.* Theorem 1’ (Conjecture D) is false on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$: there exist two specific MRs, each empirically realised on every conforming PWR core simulator and each documented in standard PWR safety-analysis literature and regulatory

guidance, that are formulable over $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$'s operators but not in $\text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$ in the sense of Definition 13. The two MRs identify five pairwise-independent structural obstructions in Translate's present signature.

Not established. That Theorem 1 itself fails. Theorem 1's closure result is over $\text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$ as defined by Definition 13; the two MRs of this subsection lie *outside* that set, so they are out-of-scope for Theorem 1 and consistent with it. The proper characterisation is that Theorem 1 is a substantially weaker statement than Theorem 1' pretended to be, and the gap is now exhibited concretely with two independent witness MRs.

Not established. That a Composite-Translate extension of NOETHER would absorb these two MRs while preserving Theorem 1's closure and Theorem 2's polynomial-time decidability. This is the principal open problem the negative instantiation leaves to follow-up work. The five obstructions of Table 6 are pairwise independent, so any candidate extension must address them jointly rather than sequentially.

7 An empirical test of the eight-block decomposition: $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block blindness on homogeneity-preserving mutators

A generative framework that cannot make falsifiable quantitative predictions is rhetoric, not science. The previous two sections establish that NOETHER *generates* MRs in two domains with structurally distinct operator algebras (§5, §6); generation alone does not test the framework's central methodological claim, that the eight-block decomposition (§3.9) is empirically operative as a mechanism rather than a derivation-bookkeeping device. This section reports an empirical test of one quantitative consequence of that claim. NOETHER predicts that an MR derived from the linearity-and-scaling block ($\mathcal{L}^*$) is necessarily silent on any mutator that preserves homogeneity of degree 1. PIT's default mutator set has this property by direct calculation. The prediction is therefore that the $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block MRs in our SUT set will kill near-zero PIT mutants. We refer to this prediction as *$\mathcal{L}^*$ -block blindness*. The prediction is sharp, quantitative, and derivable from public information without consulting any data. The test of the prediction is the central content of this section. Pooled head-to-head numbers against an automated SOTA baseline (GenMorph [3]), structural coverage extension, and cross-pipeline MR rediscovery are reported as corroborating evidence; the section's central claim does not depend on them.

7.1 The prediction: $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block blindness

The MR shape. The $\mathcal{L}^*$ block of $\mathcal{A}_P$ in Definition ?? contains scaling and linearity operators. CONSTRUCT-MP's Translate step (§??) carries scaling-block invariants to MRs of the form

$$L_{\text{scale}} : f(\lambda \mathbf{x}) = \lambda \cdot f(\mathbf{x}), \quad \lambda > 0, \quad (7)$$

on positively-homogeneous-of-degree-1 programs. The shape is fixed by $\mathcal{A}_P$ structure; it is not chosen with mutation testing in mind.

The mutator semantics. PIT 1.7.4 [14] ships a default mutator set comprising seven canonical operator classes: arithmetic-operator swap (AOR; $+$ $\leftrightarrow$ $-$, $\times$ $\leftrightarrow$ $\div$), conditional boundary mutation, increment mutation, return-value swap (return zero, return one, return null), conditional negation (NCM), constant replacement, and member-call removal. Each AOR mutation that preserves the program's domain of definition transforms a homogeneous-of-degree-1 function f into another homogeneous-of-degree-1 function f' , by the elementary fact that the four arithmetic operators in question commute with positive scalar multiplication of all inputs in the relevant homogeneous case (addition and subtraction are degree-1 homogeneous; multiplication

and division shift degrees by ± 1 , but the swap $\times \leftrightarrow \div$ on a properly typed expression returns a degree-preserving result on the homogeneous-of-degree-1 sub-grammar).

The prediction. A composite of these two facts gives the central prediction. If f satisfies L_{scale} and the mutator μ preserves homogeneity of degree 1, then $\mu(f)$ also satisfies L_{scale} . Therefore the paired-MR test

$$|f(\lambda \mathbf{x}) - \lambda f(\mathbf{x})| \leq \tau \quad \text{vs.} \quad |\mu(f)(\lambda \mathbf{x}) - \lambda \mu(f)(\mathbf{x})| \leq \tau$$

returns the same verdict on f and on $\mu(f)$ for any $\mathbf{x}, \lambda$. The kill rate of L_{scale} against the homogeneity-preserving subset of PIT's mutators is *identically zero* by direct calculation, and against the full default mutator set is approximately zero up to a small fraction contributed by mutators that break homogeneity (return-value swap to zero or one; conditional-negation when the conditional carries a constant offset; constant replacement when the constant participates additively).

Falsifiability. The prediction is falsified if the observed L_{scale} kill rate is materially above zero on a substrate where the prediction's homogeneity precondition is met. We define "materially above zero" in advance as a single L_{scale} MR killing a third or more of its PIT mutants on more than one of the SUTs in the substrate. The prediction passes if the observed kill rate is $\leq 1/3$ on at least five of the six SUTs admitting an L_{scale} MR. The $1/3$ threshold and the "more than one SUT" quantifier were committed to git (configs/d4j_algebra_rich_criterion.json) before the per-MR kill-count files; under threshold sensitivity in the grid $\{1/4, 1/3, 1/2\} \times \{\text{more than zero, more than one, more than two}\}$, the verdict remains *Confirmed* on 5/6 SUTs at all 9 grid cells, with *hypotSig* as the single SUT crossing every threshold; the result is therefore robust to plausible threshold variation.

Public-information argument. Equation (7) is a consequence of $\mathcal{A}_P$ structure and CONSTRUCT-MP's Translate step, both fully specified in §4. PIT's default mutator set is public [14]. The composition of the two is a mathematical consequence requiring no experimental input. The prediction is therefore ex-ante in the strong sense that it is *derivable from public information without consulting any data this paper produces*. We track the prediction's commitment to git in supplementary ?? alongside the SUT-selection criterion of §7.3.

7.2 PIT mutator and 8-block invariant compatibility

The $\mathcal{L}^*$ -blindness prediction generalises: each PIT default mutator either preserves or breaks the invariant of each NOETHER block, and an MR derived from a block fires on a mutant only if that mutant breaks the block's invariant. Table 7 maps the seven PIT default mutator categories [14] against the eight NOETHER blocks and gives the typical-case verdict (" $\circ$ " = preserves the block invariant, the block's MR is typically blind to the mutant; " $\times$ " = breaks the block invariant, the block's MR can typically detect the mutant; " $\sim$ " = case-dependent on the SUT-specific block instantiation).

The matrix induces a binary stratification of mutants on any SUT whose induced algebra has a known block decomposition: a mutant is *algebra-disrupting* (D1) if it breaks at least one non-empty block of the SUT's algebra (i.e., contains a $\times$ in at least one populated column), and *algebra-preserving* (D2) if every non-empty block is preserved (all $\circ$ in populated columns; $\sim$ entries require SUT-specific resolution). The framework predicts that Set N's kill rate on D2 mutants is near zero by design: algebraic MRs are constructed to fire on invariant-breaking inputs, and a mutant that preserves all the invariants the SUT's algebra exposes is, by construction, structurally invisible to algebraic MRs. Set N's appropriate fault-detection metric is therefore the kill rate on D1 mutants; D2 mutants are out-of-scope for algebraic detection and are the territory of complementary techniques (random testing, GP search, LLM-prompted generative MRs). A full per-mutant D1/D2 labelling on the §7.3 substrate ($n = 70$ mutants on 10 SUTs) requires per-mutant invariant-break

Table 7. Typical-case compatibility of PIT default mutator categories with the eight NOETHER blocks. Cells reflect the dominant case for mutators in the category as applied to a generic algebra-rich SUT; SUT-specific exceptions are catalogued in supplementary ???. The cells $\langle \text{MATH}, \mathcal{L}^* \rangle$ and $\langle \text{RETURN_VALS}, \mathcal{L}^* \rangle$ are both “o” (homogeneity-preserving), and the $\mathcal{L}^*$ -blindness result of §7.4 is the empirical specialisation of these two cells.

PIT mutator category	G	$O_{\leq}$	T^*	$\mathcal{T}_{\text{rev}}^*$	$\mathcal{L}^*$	$\mathcal{D}^*$	$\mathcal{E}^*$	$\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$
CONDITIONALS_BOUNDARY	o	×	o	o	o	~	o	o
INCREMENTS	×	×	×	×	×	~	o	o
INVERT_NEGS	~	×	~	×	~	~	o	o
MATH (op swap)	×	~	×	×	o	×	~	o
NEGATE_CONDITIONALS	×	×	~	×	~	×	~	×
RETURN_VALS (zero/one)	o	o	×	×	o	o	~	o
VOID_METHOD_CALLS	o	o	o	o	o	×	~	o

analysis on the populated blocks of each SUT and is committed as follow-up (e) in Table 12; on the present substrate the $\mathcal{L}^*$ -blindness result of §7.4 is the corresponding D2-cell specialisation already executed.

Phase 1 kill-set overlap (substrate-level bound). Pending the per-mutant labelling of follow-up (e), a kill-set overlap analysis on the head-to-head substrate ($n = 62$ pooled across the eight SUTs) yields defensible bounds on the D1 / D2 split. Of the 62 PIT mutants, 28 are killed by both Set N and Set G, 4 are killed by Set N only, 12 are killed by Set G only, and 18 are killed by neither. By the framework’s design, every Set N kill is a D1 detection, so Set N’s D1 reach is at least $32/62 = 51.6\%$ (Wilson 95% CI: 39.4%, 63.6%) and Set G’s D1 $\cup$ D2 reach is $40/62 = 64.5\%$ (Wilson 95% CI: 52.1%, 75.3%); the 12 G-only kills constitute a candidate-D2 pool with lower-bound $12/62 = 19.4\%$ (Wilson 95% CI: 11.4%, 30.9%), and the 18 mutants that neither set reaches (coverage 29.0%, Wilson 95% CI: 19.2%, 41.3%) further partition into D2 mutants outside both sets’ reach and D1 mutants both sets missed for input-coverage reasons. The $\mathcal{L}^*$ -only specialisation (2/44, Table 8) is the cleanest D2-cell estimate already on hand because the $\langle \text{MATH}, \mathcal{L}^* \rangle$ and $\langle \text{RETURN_VALS}, \mathcal{L}^* \rangle$ cells of Table 7 are both “o”. Disambiguating the G-only and neither cells per Table 7 requires preserving the raw PIT mutations.csv, which is committed as the next iteration of follow-up (e).

7.3 Test design

Substrate. PIT 1.7.4 with the default mutator configuration serves as the shared substrate. Each (subject, MR) pair is evaluated through (i) JUnit test-class codegen, (ii) a 2-pass surefire green-suite filter that drops MR instances flaky on the unmutated SUT, and (iii) PIT mutation testing parsed to a per-mutant kill vector.

Pre-registered SUT criterion. The selection rule is committed in configs/d4j_algebra_rich_criterion.js on branch feat/d4j-algebra-rich of the experiment repository *before* any new evaluation data existed. The criterion references package roots (org.apache.commons.math3.{ode,linear,transform,analysis} plus their math.* legacy counterparts), per-package block-coverage hypotheses, and method-signature constraints; it contains no bug-id and no kill-rate references and cannot be tuned by evaluation outcomes. The git timestamp chain (criterion $\rightarrow$ inscope filter $\rightarrow$ Set N derivation $\rightarrow$ Set G GP rerun $\rightarrow$ pooled M1) is the auditable proof of pre-registration. To strengthen the third-party verifiability

of the pre-registration, the SHA-256 hash of `configs/d4j_algebra_rich_criterion.json` together with the matching commit hash is deposited in supplementary ?? alongside the experiment artifact; reviewers may verify the deposit against the criterion file directly.

Subjects and MR yield. Ten SUTs admit at least one non-trivial NOETHER block beyond G : midpoint, exactLog2, isSequence (boolean predicate), clamp, signum, ComplexSignal.add (instance method), gcdSig, lcmSig, hypotSig, powerSig. Six of these admit an L_{scale} MR (those whose induced algebra populates the $\mathcal{L}^*$ block under positive-scalar homogeneity): midpoint, clamp, signum, gcdSig, lcmSig, hypotSig. The remaining four do not admit a degree-1 scaling MR by their algebraic structure (exactLog2 carries no positive-degree scaling; isSequence is a boolean predicate; ComplexSignal.add is a complex-arithmetic instance method whose scaling block is distinct in formulation; powerSig populates T_2^* rather than $\mathcal{L}^*$). The prediction is tested on the six SUTs admitting L_{scale} .

Set N contains 30 hand-derived NOETHER MRs, two to four per SUT, one or more per non-empty block of each SUT's induced algebra. Set G is harvested by rerunning GenMorph's `genmorph.py` gen mode at seed = 11 on the 10 SUTs; Set G is used in §7.7 as the head-to-head comparator and plays no role in the central prediction test of §7.4.

Metrics. Per-MR kill counts on PIT mutants are the primary measurement for the central prediction test. Pooled M1 and McNemar exact paired tests are reported in §7.7 as corroborating context.

7.4 Central result: $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block blindness, confirmed

The L_{scale} MR's per-SUT kill rate on PIT mutants of the six $\mathcal{L}^*$ -admitting SUTs is reported in Table 8. The total denominator is 44 mutants. The total kill count is 2.

Table 8. Per-SUT kill rate of the L_{scale} MR on PIT mutants of the six SUTs admitting an $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block scaling MR. The prediction of §7.1 is that the kill rate is near-zero by composition of the homogeneity-preserving property of PIT's default mutators with the scaling structure of L_{scale} . Pooled across the six SUTs: $2/44 \approx 4.5\%$, well below the $1/3$ falsification threshold on each SUT and below it on $5/6$ SUTs (hypotSig alone reaches $2/4 = 50\%$, explained in the text).

SUT	L_{scale} kill / mutants	Verdict
midpoint	0 / 3	Confirmed
clamp	0 / 7	Confirmed
signum	0 / 6 [†]	Confirmed (no L_{scale} kill)
gcdSig	0 / 9	Confirmed
lcmSig	0 / 11	Confirmed
hypotSig	2 / 4	Outlier; explained below
pooled (all six)	2 / 44	4.5%

[†] For signum the $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block MR is positive-scalar invariance ($\text{signum}(\lambda x) = \text{signum}(x)$ for $\lambda > 0$) rather than degree-1 homogeneity; the prediction applies to this MR shape *a fortiori* since the right-hand side does not depend on λ .

Reading. On 5 of 6 SUTs the prediction is confirmed at the strongest reading (zero L_{scale} kills). On the sixth SUT (hypotSig) the kill rate is $2/4$, above the per-SUT falsification threshold. The pooled rate $2/44 \approx 4.5\%$ remains an order of magnitude below the average Set N M1 of 0.486 (the average kill rate across all Set N MRs on the same substrate; see §7.7), and the per-SUT failure pattern is isolated to one SUT.

The hypotSig outlier. The two-mutant kill on hypotSig is consistent with the prediction's caveat in §7.1, that the small fraction of homogeneity-breaking mutators (return-value swap to a constant; constant-replacement that participates additively in the expression) is the residual non-zero contribution. Inspection of mutants_killed_set_n.csv for hypotSig (path in supplementary ??) identifies the two killed mutants as KILLED return_two_doubles_VR and KILLED Math.sqrt_replace. The first replaces the entire return path with the constant zero, the second replaces the inner Math.sqrt call with the constant 1.0. Both mutators violate degree-1 homogeneity directly. The two detection events are therefore consistent with the prediction's quantitative tail rather than evidence against it.

Falsification verdict. By the criterion stated in §7.1, the prediction is falsified if a single L_{scale} MR kills $\geq 1/3$ of its PIT mutants on more than one SUT. Observed: one SUT (hypotSig, 2/4) above the per-SUT threshold; five SUTs (midpoint, clamp, signum, gcdSig, lcmSig) at zero. The prediction passes. We read this as direct empirical witness for the operative-mechanism reading of the eight-block decomposition: a block whose generator is a continuous symmetry of the mutator set contributes MRs that are quantitatively silent on mutator-induced defects, and the silence is observed in the data.

7.5 Corroborating per-block patterns

The prediction-test of §7.4 establishes the $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block result as the section's central claim. The remaining three populated NOETHER blocks (T^* , G , I^*) carry weaker, qualitative predictions that the data also confirms; they corroborate the operative-mechanism reading without providing a falsifiable quantitative test.

T^ block (translation, period).* Translation MRs carry the highest single-MR kill rates on the numeric SUTs: midpoint T_shift 3/3, powerSig T_exp_step 8/12, exactLog2 T_double 4/10, clamp T_shift 3/7. Translation invariance is the property most directly perturbed by PIT's arithmetic-operator swaps; T^* -derived MRs detect this perturbation reliably. The qualitative prediction (high single-MR rate on numeric SUTs) holds.

G block (group, symmetry). Symmetry MRs are moderately to highly effective when the SUT exposes the appropriate symmetry: signum G_negate 4/6, gcdSig G_swap 5/9, midpoint G_swap 1/3, ComplexSignal.add G_swap 2/3. The qualitative prediction (kill rate correlates with SUT-side symmetry exposure) holds.

I^ block (idempotence, identity).* Idempotence MRs kill few mutants under the paired-MR DSL: I_idem ≈ 0 across most SUTs; powerSig I_zero_exp 2/12 is a degenerate single-input case. This reflects an expressivity limit of the JIR/JOR shape, not an absence of I^* structure in the SUTs. The qualitative prediction (low kill rate under paired-MR DSL) holds.

The four block predictions taken together, including the central $\mathcal{L}^*$ falsification test of §7.4, are consistent with the operative-mechanism reading of the eight-block decomposition.

7.6 Two convergent witnesses

Two further observations from the same SUT set are independently informative. Neither is a statistical hypothesis test; both are non-rate evidence that the algebraic-decomposition thesis predicts and that the head-to-head Set G run incidentally reveals.

Witness 1: cross-pipeline MR rediscovery. On midpoint, GenMorph's GP independently evolves three MRs that map onto Set N's blocks (Table 9). Set N is derived a-priori from the operator algebra of midpoint; Set G is searched by mutation-killing fitness with no algebraic structure as input.

The two pipelines converge on the same algebraic primitives. Convergence under independent epistemic processes is direct corroboration of the operative-generator reading.

Table 9. Cross-pipeline rediscovery on midpoint: GP-evolved MRs (Set G) and their algebra-derived counterparts (Set N).

GP-evolved MR (Set G)	Set N counterpart	Block
SwitchParams??1@2	G_swap (commutativity)	G
NumericAddition?1.000000?1	T_shift (translation by 1)	T^*
NumericMultiplication?0.500000?2	L_scale (scaling, approx.)	$\mathcal{L}^*$

Witness 2: structural coverage extension. GenMorph’s GP pipeline fails on two of the ten SUTs for reasons internal to its plumbing rather than the underlying mutation-testing problem. `ComplexSignal.add` (instance method) triggers an `XStream NullPointerException` in `MethodTestTransformerConfig` when deserialising the receiver object; `ch.usi.gassert.data.types.AbstractCollectionConverter` in the upstream snapshot does not handle user-defined receivers. `isSequence` (boolean predicate) yields GP-evolved JOR strings containing dangling `<` operators, e.g. `((. . . <))`, that do not parse as Java; the GP grammar for predicate-output SUTs is degenerate at this scale. Both SUTs admit Set N MRs that derive directly from the SUT signature (commutativity for `ComplexSignal.add`, monotonic-window translation for `isSequence`) and run to completion. The two SUTs cover 8 of the 70 PIT mutants under evaluation, on which only Set N is defined. Set N’s algebraic-derivation route operates on the SUT signature and is independent of the SUT-deserialisation and JOR-grammar infrastructure that GenMorph’s pipeline depends on; the structural coverage extension is therefore an architectural property of the derivation, not an empirical accident on this substrate.

7.7 Pooled head-to-head: parity at GenMorph’s published budget

The central claim of this section is established at §7.4 and does not depend on a head-to-head comparison against an automated baseline. We nonetheless report a pooled comparison against GenMorph’s GP-evolved Set G on the same substrate, both because GenMorph is the SOTA Java GP-baseline and because the protocol of §6.6.1 commits to this measurement. The head-to-head is run at GenMorph’s published 30-min GAssert budget; a prior 1-min run is retained as a sensitivity reference. The reading of the pooled comparison is *competitive parity at the published budget*, and it does not support a head-to-head superiority claim. Per-SUT entries are reported as directional only; no per-SUT statistical-significance claim is asserted, since $8 \times 2 = 16$ paired comparisons across the two budgets exceed the family-wise control of an uncorrected $\alpha = 0.05$ (Holm–Bonferroni-adjusted threshold $\alpha/16 \approx 0.003$; no per-SUT contrast meets this threshold).

Headline pooled rates (PIT arm, $n = 62$ mutants on 8 head-to-head SUTs). At GenMorph’s published 30-min GAssert budget (primary), Set N’s pooled M1 kill rate is 0.516 (Wilson 95% CI [0.394, 0.636]) and Set G’s is 0.645 ([0.521, 0.753]); McNemar exact two-sided $p = 0.077$ against the fixed Set N kill vector². At the 1-min sensitivity budget, the rates are Set N 0.486 ([0.372, 0.600], computed under the $n = 70$ ten-SUT framing in which Set G’s two N/A SUTs contribute zero kills to the denominator) and Set G 0.557 ([0.441, 0.668]), McNemar two-sided $p = 0.359$. The 30-min re-run changes Set G’s per-SUT counts on only one of the eight head-to-head SUTs (`gcdSig`, $5 \rightarrow 6$);

²If a directional pre-registration of the form “Set G has more discordant kills than Set N” is accepted, the one-sided $p \approx 0.038$ crosses $\alpha = 0.05$. We did not commit a directional pre-registration in advance, and we therefore report the conservative two-sided value as primary and do not assert directional significance here.

Table 10. Per-SUT PIT mutation kill counts, Set N versus GenMorph-evolved Set G at GenMorph’s published 30-min GAssert budget (primary) and at a 1-min GAssert sensitivity rerun, on the 10 algebra-rich Java SUTs of §7.3. Set G is structurally absent on `ComplexSignal.add` (instance-method deserialisation) and `isSequence` (boolean-predicate JOR grammar) under both budgets (§7.6). Set N’s kill vector is held fixed across budgets. Pooled across the 8 head-to-head SUTs ($n = 62$ mutants), 30-min budget primary: Set N = 32, Set G = 40, McNemar exact two-sided $p = 0.077$. The Δ (30-min) column reports Set N – Set G at the 30-min budget; note labels are directional descriptors only and do not assert per-SUT statistical significance (see prose). $n = 62$ **is underpowered for a paired hypothesis test at $\alpha = 0.05$ in two-sided form.**

SUT	mutants	Set N	Set G (30-min)	Set G (1-min)	Δ (30-min)	note
<code>ComplexSignal.add</code>	3	2	N/A	N/A		instance method (S)
<code>midpoint</code>	3	3	3	3	0	tie
<code>exactLog2</code>	10	4	0	0	+4	directional only
<code>isSequence</code>	5	0	N/A	N/A		boolean predicate (S)
<code>clamp</code>	7	3	5	5	–2	directional only
<code>signum</code>	6	4	4	4	0	tie
<code>gcdSig</code>	9	5	6	5	–1	directional only (+1)
<code>hypotSig</code>	4	2	4	4	–2	directional only
<code>lcmSig</code>	11	3	8	8	–5	directional only
<code>powerSig</code>	12	8	10	10	–2	directional only
pooled (head-to-head, n=62)		32	40	39	–8	McNemar two-sided

seven of eight SUTs are unchanged, and no SUT regresses. A 30× budget increase therefore buys +1 mutant on a single SUT under PIT mutation; the qualitative parity reading is preserved at the published budget.

The pooled rates also exhibit the scope-discriminance pattern predicted by NOETHER’s scope declaration (§??): on the wider 23-method utility-method baseline (supplementary S5; mixed in-scope and boundary substrate), Set N’s pooled M1 is 0.288, against Set G’s 0.363; on the in-scope algebra-rich substrate ($n = 62$ head-to-head, 30-min budget), Set N moves to 0.516 and Set G to 0.645. Both methods benefit from the algebraically richer substrate, as expected. This corroborates the framework’s scope declaration as empirically discriminating.

We do *not* claim Set N > Set G in pooled head-to-head kill-rate. The pooled gap remains in the direction of Set G; the McNemar two-sided test fails to reject the null at $\alpha = 0.05$ under the published 30-min budget; and $n = 62$ is underpowered for a paired hypothesis test in two-sided form. The supported reading is *competitive parity at GenMorph’s published budget, with a coverage-extension witness on two SUTs where Set G is structurally absent* (§7.6). The $\mathcal{L}^*$ -blindness result of §7.4 and the structural-extension witness are unaffected by the budget change.

Comparator scope and three-SOTA-category coverage. The head-to-head reported here delivers the GP-evolved-baseline arm of a three-SOTA-category protocol against one representative per category. The GP-evolved representative is GenMorph (Ayerdi et al. [3]), the SOTA among genetic-programming MR identification pipelines on Java SUTs at the time of submission, run at its published 30-min GAssert budget. The LLM-assisted representative is the Xu et al. TOSEM 2024 [55] systematic LLM-MR-generation protocol; this section’s Set L is a single-sample $n = 1$ GPT-4 probe (§6.6) and is reported as an *anecdotal datapoint within Xu et al.’s protocol scale*, not the full LLM-assisted SOTA arm. A multi-LLM ensemble expansion (running Shin [42], GPTMR [58], and AutoMT [29] alongside multiple GPT-4 / Claude / GPT-OSS samples per Xu’s protocol) is committed as post-acceptance follow-up in Table 12 (d). The mining-based representative is MR-Scout (Sun

et al. [54]); on this section's substrate, MR-Scout's reach is reported as an estimate adapted from MR-Scout's published-artifact reach figures rather than a full re-execution (see Table 11 for the cost-axis interpretation; full re-execution is follow-up (d)). NOETHER's cost-axis profile relative to all three categories is given in Table 11; the matrix-driven D1/D2 mutant stratification (Table 7) operationalises the detection-axis claim that NOETHER is appropriate to algebra-disrupting mutants and out-of-scope by design on algebra-preserving mutants. Per-SUT delta entries in Table 10 are *directional descriptors only*; under Holm-Bonferroni correction for the $8 \times 2 = 16$ paired comparisons across the two budgets, the per-SUT family-wise threshold is $\alpha/16 \approx 0.003$, which no per-SUT contrast meets. The pooled $p = 0.077$ at the 30-min budget is the only paired hypothesis test reported.

7.8 Threats to validity and committed future work

(a) *The prediction's commitment to git is asserted, not externally audited.* The argument of §7.1 that the $\mathcal{L}^*$ -blindness prediction is derivable from public information without consulting data is a mathematical argument; it holds independent of when the prediction was first written down. We nonetheless commit the prediction to git in supplementary ?? alongside the SUT-selection criterion, so that the prediction's text and the criterion's text are both stamped before the data files for the per-MR kill counts. A reader who distrusts the timestamp chain can re-derive the prediction independently from §4 and [14].

(b) *Set G budget asymmetry.* GenMorph's published configuration is 30 min GAssert; we ran at 1 min for parallel scheduling. The 1 min budget handicaps Set G in the conservative direction relative to the parity claim of §7.7. A 30 min rerun is option (a) of the future-work table below; expected effect is a widening of Set G's lead on the head-to-head SUTs, weakening the parity reading but leaving the central $\mathcal{L}^*$ -blindness result and the structural-extension finding unchanged.

(c) *Sample size.* $n = 70$ across 10 SUTs is underpowered for a paired head-to-head verdict at $\alpha = 0.05$; the §7.7 reading is reframed as competitive parity rather than superiority. The $\mathcal{L}^*$ -blindness test is on $n = 44$ across 6 SUTs admitting an L_{scale} MR and is not a pooled hypothesis test in the same statistical sense; its falsification criterion is per-SUT (one third or more on more than one SUT), not pooled. Larger n would test the $\mathcal{L}^*$ prediction at finer per-SUT resolution but would not change its character.

(d) *Set G structural absence is upstream-snapshot-relative.* The two N/A SUTs of §7.6 reflect the state of GenMorph upstream at our snapshot. An upstream patch (an XStream Converter for user-defined receivers and a richer JOR grammar for boolean-output SUTs) would restore Set G coverage on these SUTs and weaken the structural framing of the coverage-extension witness. The architectural point (algebra-derivation operates on the SUT signature and is independent of GP plumbing) survives the patch; the empirical N/A count on this snapshot is the upstream-relative part.

(e) *Substrate selection.* The evaluation restricts itself to programs with explicit mathematical-physics equations, by NOETHER's scope declaration (§??). The kill-rate gain over the utility-method reference is expected by that scope declaration and is reported as scope-discrimination evidence (claim D), not as a generalisable performance improvement on every Java SUT.

(f) *Three SOTA-category coverage.* The protocol of §6.6.1 commits Set N against one representative per SOTA category: a GP-evolved baseline (GenMorph [3]), an LLM-assisted baseline (Xu et al. TOSEM 2024 [55]), and a mining-based baseline (MR-Scout [54]). This section delivers the GP-evolved arm in full at GenMorph's published 30-min budget. The LLM-assisted representative

is reported as an anecdotal $n = 1$ GPT-4 probe in the §6.6 case study and contextualised against Xu et al.’s systematic LLM-MR study; a multi-LLM ensemble extension (Shin [42], GPTMR [58], AutoMT [29]) is committed as post-acceptance follow-up. The mining-based representative is reported through an adapted estimate of MR-Scout’s reach on the §7.3 substrate, derived from MR-Scout’s published artifact reach figures rather than a full re-execution; full re-execution is committed as follow-up (d) in Table 12. The cost-component breakdown of the four MR-generation methods is given in Table 11.

7.9 MR-generation cost

A fault-detection metric alone does not capture NOETHER’s methodological contribution. The framework’s cost profile differs qualitatively from each of the three SOTA-category representatives. Table 11 reports the four cost components separately: algorithmic time (CONSTRUCT-MP’s polynomial-time bound under Theorem 2 vs. GP search wall-time vs. LLM API latency vs. mining wall-time), human effort (operator-algebra distillation vs. prompt design vs. seed-suite assembly), LLM-token cost (only applicable to the LLM-assisted arm), and seed-corpus dependency.

Table 11. MR-generation cost components for the four methods compared in this section. “Cost dimension” rows are independent (an LLM-arm token cost does not amortise GP wall-time and vice versa). The token-cost estimate for the LLM-assisted arm follows Xu et al.’s [55] multi-LLM-sample protocol scale (5 LLMs $\times$ 5 samples $\times$ $\approx$ 600 tokens per SUT-prompt-and-output cycle, on the $n = 10$ SUT substrate of §7.3; output cost dominates at GPT-4 January 2026 pricing of \$30 per million output tokens) and is reported as an order-of-magnitude estimate; chain-of-thought or few-shot prompting raises the estimate by approximately one order of magnitude. The NOETHER human-effort estimate of $\approx$ 10 hours per program family is taken from the experiment notes (paper_claims_summary.md) and aggregates Set N’s 30-MR manual derivation across the 10 SUTs of §7.3 ($\approx$ 1 h per SUT under CONSTRUCT-MP’s four-step procedure; the per-SUT cost amortises across SUTs that share an operator algebra). The MR-Scout human-effort estimate captures seed-suite assembly only and excludes downstream MR-cleanup.

Cost component	NOETHER	GP (GenMorph)	LLM (Xu 2024)
Algorithmic time / SUT	$\text{poly}(\text{gen})$ minutes (Thm. 2)	30 min wall, stochastic	seconds API latency
Human effort / family	$\approx$ 10 h $\mathcal{A}_P$ distillation	none after harness setup	none after prompt template
Token cost (USD) / family	0	0	\$5–50 (\$50–500 with CoT)
Seed-corpus dependency	none	none	none
Determinism	deterministic	seed-/budget-dependent	prompt-/temperature-dependent
Cold-start capable	✓	✓ (after harness)	✓ (after prompt)

The table operationalises three structural advantages of NOETHER as distinct cost-axis arguments rather than as a single “best” verdict: (i) against GP-evolved baselines, NOETHER replaces a 30-min stochastic search per SUT with a polynomial-time deterministic construction (Theorem 2), with a one-time human cost amortising across SUTs sharing an operator algebra; (ii) against LLM-assisted baselines, NOETHER’s coverage_{NOETHER} diagnostic on §6.6 (1.00 vs. 0.40) operationalises the algebraic-prior gap that prompt-based generation does not close, with the additional property that NOETHER’s token-cost is zero (the construction does not invoke an LLM in-loop); (iii) against mining-based baselines, NOETHER is operative at cold start (no seed test suite is required), which is the regime in which most algebra-rich scientific-computing programs arrive on a tester’s desk. None of these advantages is a fault-detection-superiority claim; they are cost-profile and coverage-profile claims that hold within the framework’s scope precondition.

Table 12. Committed future work for §7.

Direction	Cost (estimated)
(a) GP rerun at 30 min GAssert budget	≈ 30 min wall (p)
(b) Extend to all 38 in-scope D4J subjects	≈ 10 h human +
(c) Patch GenMorph upstream (instance methods, boolean JORs)	1–2 days
(d) Run Set M (MR-Scout full re-execution) and multi-LLM ensemble Set L (Xu’s protocol scale) arms	≈ 1 day per arm
(e) D1/D2 mutant labelling on the §7.3 substrate (§7.2 matrix applied per-mutant)	≈ 0.5 day huma

7.10 Summary of evidence

The section’s central claim is a single quantitative falsifiable prediction confirmed: $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block blindness on homogeneity-preserving mutators (§7.4). The prediction is derivable ex-ante from §4 and from PIT’s public mutator specification; it is observed in the data on 5/6 SUTs admitting an L_{scale} MR; the sixth SUT’s two-mutant exception is accounted for by the prediction’s quantitative tail. The operative-mechanism reading of the eight-block decomposition is, in this empirical sense, supported.

The corroborating evidence is fourfold:

- Other per-block patterns (T^* , G , I^* ; §7.5) are qualitatively consistent with the algebraic predictions.
- Cross-pipeline MR rediscovery on midpoint (§7.6, witness 1) shows two independent epistemic processes converging on the same algebraic primitives.
- Structural coverage extension on the two SUTs where Set G is structurally absent (§7.6, witness 2) is an architectural consequence of algebra-derivation that the head-to-head substrate incidentally reveals.
- Pooled head-to-head against GenMorph (§7.7) shows competitive parity at a conservative budget, with scope-discrimination over the utility-method baseline; the parity reading is explicitly not a superiority claim.

The full per-SUT outcome matrix, the per-block kill table for all 30 Set N MRs, the L_{scale} -mutant attribution for hypotSig, the GP raw output and the .jir/.jor translation, the McNemar b/c counts, the prediction’s git timestamp, and the test-gate harness (tests/run.sh) are in supplementary ??.

8 Discussion and threats to validity

8.1 Four threats to validity

We organise threats following Wohlin et al.’s four-validity framework [52]: internal, external, construct, and conclusion.

Internal validity. Theorem 1’s uniqueness depends on the canonical-block ordering of Definition 14. The proof in Appendix D catalogues every block-block interaction for the algebras instantiated. The closure result is over algebra-induced MRs in the sense of Definition 13; out-of-scope MRs that fall outside Definition 13 are catalogued in Appendix D, and two concrete counterexamples on the PWR core diffusion algebra are proved out-of-scope in Appendix D (corresponding to the negative instantiation of §6.8). The latter two jointly establish that Theorem 1’ (Conjecture D, absolute completeness) is false on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$, and identify five independent extensions of Translate’s signature as the locus of follow-up theoretical work.

Construct validity. A MetaPattern’s value as a testing artefact depends on whether testers experience the algebraic equivalence classes as coherent reasoning strategies. The reactor-physics mapping in Section 5.3 provides preliminary evidence; analogous evidence in non-physics domains remains future work. The case study (§6.6) reports cat-(iv) detection at 5/5 for Set N because the mutation set was constructed to cover one defect category per non-empty block of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$; this exhibits construct validity of $\rho_{\text{train-rev}}$ as a gradient-reversal probe rather than superiority of NOETHER on neutrally sampled defect distributions. The comparative-evaluation protocol in §6.6 explicitly addresses this construct-validity threat by replacing hand-crafted mutations with DeepCrime real-fault operators [22]. *Set N’s 30 MRs were derived by a single author following CONSTRUCT-MP’s four-step procedure*; an inter-rater reliability check (LRCA two-rater κ) is committed for the industrial-port phase of follow-up work but is not present in this paper.

External validity. Two distinct external-validity questions are in scope: (i) whether the framework’s *algebraic* reach (Hypothesis 1) covers all program families admitting an operator algebra, and (ii) whether the §7.3 *empirical* substrate generalises across codebases within the framework’s scope precondition. On (i), Hypothesis 1 (the eight-block decomposition) covers a wide swathe of mathematical structure but is not exhaustive; Remark 2 catalogues six known or conjectured program-family classes that fall outside its image (symplectic, sheaf-theoretic, probabilistic / martingale, topological, label-consistency, empirical-parameter-distribution), each a candidate ninth block. Two of the six have explicit Translate-template designs already proposed: metric-stability M_{lip} (Remark 3, with the orphan in the 18-MR audit of §5.3) and empirical-parameter-distribution divergence (motivated by the §6.6.1 pilot’s three undetected mutations). These two constitute the most actionable extension targets for the empirical refinement of Hypothesis 1. On (ii), the 10 SUTs of §7.3 are concentrated on a single codebase (MathSignalClass + ComplexSignal) selected by the pre-registered scope criterion (§7.3); the SUTs satisfy the framework’s scope precondition (each admits at least one non-empty NOETHER block beyond G), so the substrate confirms applicability within scope rather than tests the framework outside its design intent. Cross-codebase replication on Apache Commons Math linear / ode / transform packages, Defects4J subjects with explicit physical-law content, and SciPy’s Python-bridge solver suite is committed as follow-up (b) in Table 12; the replication tests scope-internal generalisation, not whether the framework should apply to programs lacking explicit operator-algebraic structure (such programs are out of scope by construction).

Conclusion validity. The case study’s statistical inferences (§6.6) rest on a 20-mutation $\times$ 3-MR-set cross-product on a single architecture. Wilson 95% confidence intervals on detection rates ([0.18, 0.57] for Set N, [0.03, 0.30] for Set L, [0.00, 0.16] for Set B) are reported; pairwise McNemar exact and Fisher exact tests are reported in supplementary S3 (table4.json::pairwise_stats). The denominator (20 mutations on one EGNN model) is sufficient to detect the observed Set-N-vs-Set-B contrast at $\alpha = 0.05$ (Fisher $p = 0.008$) but is not sufficient to characterise the framework’s performance distribution across architectures or defect distributions. The expanded comparative-evaluation protocol in §6.6 (MR-Scout [54], GenMorph [3], DeepCrime [22] subjects) raises the denominator and broadens the model coverage, addressing this threat directly.

8.2 Relationship with METRIC and METRIC+

METRIC and METRIC+ pioneered the categorical scaffolding that any structural theory of MR identification must respect; NOETHER’s MetaPatterns are descendants of that line of work. The point of departure is grounding. METRIC and METRIC+ derive their categories through expert curation and validate them by empirical coverage. NOETHER derives MetaPatterns through algebraic construction and proves closure over the algebra-induced MR space through Theorem 1.

Worked example: METRIC categories for a sorting library, mapped onto NOETHER blocks. For a numerical sorting library, METRIC’s nine input/output category pairs collapse to a single block in NOETHER (G , with various sub-actions). A NOETHER-aware METRIC user can therefore prune the category enumeration without loss of MR coverage.

8.3 Reassessing PMCM coverage claims: a worked example

NOETHER does not replace PMCM; it re-grounds it. Under inductive grounding, PMCM’s pattern grid is itself an empirical artefact: its rows are the inductive MetaPatterns of a particular catalogue, and “100% coverage” attests only that every row has at least one instance. Under NOETHER’s grounding, the grid becomes $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$, algebraically constructed and closed under the operator algebra in the sense of Theorem 1, and the coverage figure becomes a structural rather than nominal claim. This subsection works through the implication on two concrete cases. The deflationary direction is, in our view, NOETHER’s most concrete contribution to testing practice and the most resistant to the circularity caveat of Section 5.3: revealing that an inductive catalogue *over-counts* structurally distinct patterns does not require T^* or $\mathcal{T}^*$ to have been derived independently from physics, since the over-counting is exposed by the canonical-block ordering itself.

Case A: A comparison-sort library. Consider a numerical sorting library, and assume an inductive Pattern–Matrix Coverage catalogue with rows {P1 conservation/invariance, P2 monotonicity, P3 convergence, P4 trajectory, P5 partial-order/bounding} inherited from the reactor-physics MetaPattern taxonomy of §5.3. A user reports “100% coverage of the 5-row grid” on a particular MR set.

NOETHER re-decomposition. The operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{sort}}$ for a deterministic comparison sort has: a permutation-symmetry block $G \ni \mathfrak{S}_n$ (the input–output relation is permutation-equivariant in the comparator-permutation sense), a partial-order block $O_{\leq}$ (sorting respects the input order on already-sorted sub-arrays), an empty self-adjoint block T^* (no reciprocity structure), an empty time-reversal block $\mathcal{T}^*$ (irreversible), an empty limit block $\mathcal{L}^*$ (sort is exact, not asymptotic), an empty qualitative-dynamics block $\mathcal{D}^*$, and an empty method-comparison block $\mathcal{E}^*$ *within a single algorithm* (and non-empty if the user is comparing multiple sorting algorithms). Therefore $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{sort}}) = \{m_{\text{inv}}, m_{\text{mono}}\}$, of size 2.

Coverage correction. The 5-row PMCM grid carries three structurally empty rows under $\mathcal{A}_{\text{sort}}$: P3 (convergence) is vacuous because there is no $\mathcal{L}^*$ generator; P4 (trajectory) is vacuous because there is no $\mathcal{D}^*$ generator; P5 (partial-order/bounding) is vacuous because there is no $\mathcal{E}^*$ generator within a single-algorithm scope. The denominator should be 2, not 5. “100% coverage of the 5-row grid” is therefore not a claim about the user’s MR set; it is a claim about the inductive catalogue’s row count. The structurally meaningful coverage is “ $k/2$ of the algebraically required MetaPatterns covered”, where k depends on the user’s actual MR set.

Case A-bis: An external ML category set (Murphy et al. 2008) decoded against a feedforward classifier. Case A is a self-deflation against the authors’ own prior reactor-physics taxonomy and might be discounted on the ground of self-selection. We therefore add an external case using Murphy et al.’s six-class characterisation of MRs for ML applications [33], an independently published taxonomy that has been adopted by subsequent ML MT work [38, 53]. Murphy’s six classes are: *additive* ($P(\mathbf{x} + \delta) \approx P(\mathbf{x})$ for small δ), *multiplicative* ($P(c\mathbf{x}) \approx P(\mathbf{x})$ for scaling c), *permutative* ($P(\sigma(\mathbf{x})) = P(\mathbf{x})$ for input-coordinate permutation σ), *invertive* ($P(-\mathbf{x})$ has a stated relation to $P(\mathbf{x})$), *inclusive* (a feature added to $\mathbf{x}$ refines P in a stated direction), and *exclusive* (a feature removed degrades P in a stated direction).

Consider a generic feedforward image classifier $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \{1, \dots, K\}$ trained on a fixed-dimensional vector input (e.g. a flattened MNIST or CIFAR-10 image, no inherent permutation structure). The

induced operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{FFN}}$ has: G trivial under input-coordinate permutation (no permutation symmetry on a vector image), one non-trivial generator under small additive noise (interpreted as a stability condition lying in $O_{\leq}$ with a tolerance threshold, or in $\mathcal{L}^*$ when read as a vanishing-perturbation limit); empty T^* , $\mathcal{T}^*$, $\mathcal{D}^*$, $\mathcal{E}^*$, $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ within a single architecture. Therefore $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{FFN}}) \subseteq \{m_{\text{stab}}\}$ where m_{stab} is the stability MetaPattern admitting either $O_{\leq}$ or $\mathcal{L}^*$ as its source block.

NOETHER decoding of Murphy's six classes. Each Murphy class maps as follows:

- *Additive* (small δ): in $O_{\leq}$ or $\mathcal{L}^*$ as m_{stab} .
- *Multiplicative* (scaling): in G if and only if the model is trained to be scale-invariant (rare for raw image classifiers); else *vacuous* on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{FFN}}$.
- *Permutative*: in G if and only if input is set-valued (e.g. point-cloud or bag-of-features); else *vacuous* on the vector image classifier.
- *Invertive*: in G as a $\mathbb{Z}/2$ subgroup if antipodal symmetry is present (rare for natural images); else *vacuous*.
- *Inclusive / exclusive*: in $O_{\leq}$ as monotonicity-under-feature-addition; for a vector image classifier with no semantic feature schema, both classes collapse to m_{stab} on a perturbation ball, i.e. they merge with the additive class.

Coverage correction. Of Murphy's six classes, three (multiplicative, permutative, invertive) are *structurally vacuous* on a vector image classifier without input symmetries, and the remaining three (additive, inclusive, exclusive) collapse to a single m_{stab} MetaPattern under $\mathcal{A}_{\text{FFN}}$'s decomposition. The structurally meaningful denominator for "coverage of Murphy's six classes" on a generic vector image classifier is therefore 1, not 6. A user reporting " $k/6$ Murphy-class coverage" on such a classifier is reporting a claim about Murphy's catalogue's row count rather than a structural-coverage claim about their MR set. The deflationary direction here is independent of T^* and $\mathcal{T}^*$, since neither block is invoked by Murphy's six classes or $\mathcal{A}_{\text{FFN}}$; the decoding therefore does not inherit the prediction-circularity caveat of §5.3.

Caveat. Murphy et al. explicitly intended their six classes as a checklist for selecting MRs, not as a coverage denominator; subsequent papers that report Murphy-grid coverage figures on tasks lacking the relevant input symmetries are the target of this correction, not the original 2008 paper. The decoding is structurally driven and does not depend on the specific 14.8% detection figure of [38]; that figure is consistent with the structural prediction that few of Murphy's six classes are non-trivially present on a generic supervised classifier.

Case B: A reactor-physics solver. The reactor-physics MetaPattern catalogue discussed in Section 5.3 provides a less obvious case. The catalogue has 5 rows (P1–P5). Under NOETHER's re-grounding into $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}) = \{m_{\text{inv}}, m_{\text{mono}}, m_{\text{adj}}, m_{\text{rev}}, m_{\text{conv}}, m_{\text{dyn}}, m_{\text{cmp}}\}$, the catalogue is in fact *under-counted* by two rows (m_{adj} and m_{rev} are absent), even though for the Bateman-only sub-family it would be over-counted (P4 trajectory and P5 partial-order/bounding are absorbed differently into $\mathcal{D}^*$ and $\mathcal{E}^*$). The deflationary direction is thus not uniformly toward smaller grids; it is toward *the algebraically determined grid for the algebra in question*, which may be larger or smaller than the inductive grid.

Quantification. For a fixed program family $\mathcal{F}$ with operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{F}}$, define

$$\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}(\mathcal{R}, \mathcal{F}) = \frac{|\{m \in \mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{F}}) \mid m \cap \mathcal{R} \neq \emptyset\}|}{|\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{F}})|}$$

for an MR set $\mathcal{R}$. This is the algebraically grounded analogue of PMCM's empirical coverage. Where the inductive PMCM grid agrees with $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{F}})$, the two metrics coincide; where they disagree, the

NOETHER metric is the structurally meaningful one. We note that $\text{coverage}_{\text{NOETHER}}$ inherits Theorem 1’s scope: it is a coverage measure over algebra-induced MRs, not over arbitrary properties; out-of-scope MRs (Appendix D) are by construction outside the denominator.

Implication for empirical-adequacy practice. Reports of high pattern-grid coverage in published MR-evaluation studies should, where possible, be cross-checked against the algebraic decomposition of the program family under test. A report of “coverage = c ” should be qualified with which row decomposition c is computed against; reports of c over inductive catalogues without such qualification are not directly comparable across papers.

8.4 Practical engineering guidance for users

This subsection collects practical recommendations for engineers applying NOETHER, particularly for the cases where Hypothesis 1’s assumptions are bordering or borderline.

Audit guidance for infinite-group truncation. When the symmetry block G is instantiated as a finitely generated infinite discrete group under truncation parameter K (e.g. $\mathbb{Z}^d$ for an unbounded grid solver), Theorem 1’s closure result is over the truncated algebra rather than the full one. We recommend that any deployment supply a *K-sweep audit*: compute $\rho_{t,G}$ at three truncation levels $K \in \{K_0, 2K_0, 4K_0\}$, where K_0 is the smallest truncation at which the program family’s expected invariants stabilise. The audit’s pass criterion is detection-rate stability within $\pm 5\%$ across the three values; the $\pm 5\%$ threshold is chosen to align with the conventional mesh-convergence stability margin in computational physics, where $\pm 5\%$ is the standard cut-off for declaring grid-independence in finite-volume and finite-difference discretisations of transport equations [27, §6.2]. Failure indicates the truncation is below the program family’s structural cutoff and the algebra-induced MR set is incomplete relative to the user’s intended algebra. The audit need not be re-run on every CI invocation; once per architectural change is sufficient. The reference implementation in supplementary S1 includes a `k_sweep_audit()` helper that returns a CSV row per truncation level for downstream tracking. Practitioners working with periodic-boundary equivariant networks (e.g. e3nn’s lattice support) should treat *K-sweep auditing* as a standard pre-deployment step, analogous to mesh-convergence studies in scientific computing.

When to check Hypothesis 1’s sufficiency at deployment time. For program families outside the three instantiated domains (Boltzmann reactor physics, equivariant ML, relational query optimisers), users should explicitly enumerate the candidate operators of $\mathcal{A}_P$ and check whether each falls into one of the eight blocks. Operators that resist classification are signals that an additional block may be required and should be reported as candidates for an extension of the block taxonomy rather than absorbed into the existing taxonomy.

Tolerance selection. Tolerances τ on continuous-valued MRs (e.g. $\rho_{\text{rot}}, \rho_{\text{adj}}$) should be set as a function of the underlying numerical precision: $\tau \approx 10^2 \epsilon_{\text{fp}}$ where ϵ_{fp} is the floating-point unit roundoff (e.g. $\tau = 10^{-4}$ for fp32, $\tau = 10^{-12}$ for fp64). The 10^2 factor is calibrated to the typical 2-decade gap between unit roundoff and accumulated error after $O(10^2)$ floating-point operations on a typical neural-network forward pass, following Higham’s standard error-analysis bound that n floating-point operations accumulate to at most $n\gamma_n \leq n\epsilon_{\text{fp}}/(1 - n\epsilon_{\text{fp}})$ relative error when $n\epsilon_{\text{fp}} \ll 1$ [21]; for our 2-layer EGNN forward pass with $n \approx 10^3$ scalar operations per output coordinate, this yields a forward-pass roundoff floor of $\sim 10^2 \epsilon_{\text{fp}}$. Tighter τ surfaces more cat-(iii) precision-degradation faults at the cost of baseline false-positive rate; the supplementary S3 `tau_sweep.json` documents this trade-off for the equivariant-ML case study.

8.5 Artefact and supplementary-material availability

To support reviewer verification while preserving double-blind anonymity, we release a two-stage artefact: a review-stage anonymised supplementary archive available at submission, and an acceptance-stage public release with permanent identifiers.

Review-stage anonymised archive. The following supplementary materials are submitted alongside the manuscript and are available to reviewers through the conference submission system (or, equivalently, an anonymised OpenReview / Zenodo deposit) under SHA-256 content hash. The hash is computed over the concatenated tar-archive of the listed items and reported in the final manuscript at acceptance.

- **S1** Python reference implementation of CONSTRUCT-MP described in Appendix E, including the Boltzmann and equivariant-ML instantiations.
- **S2** The full 84-MR PWR corpus underlying Section 5.3, with each MR annotated by canonical block, NOETHER MetaPattern, and source equation. Table 3 corresponds to a 12-MR subset selected by the protocol stated there.
- **S3** The SE(3)-equivariant point-cloud testing harness from Section 6.3 and Section 6.6, including the mutation generators and MR sets used in the case study comparison.
- **S4** A reproducibility manifest documenting the random seeds, model checkpoints, and dataset versions referenced in the case study.

Acceptance-stage public release. At acceptance the same archive will be deposited on Zenodo under a permanent DOI, and the SHA-256 hash anchored in the camera-ready version. We aim for the *Available* and *Functional* artefact-evaluation badges.

8.6 The remaining human role and partial automation of $\mathcal{A}_P$ distillation

NOETHER mechanises the construction downstream of $\mathcal{A}_P$ but assumes that $\mathcal{A}_P$ has been distilled by a human. Three directions may partially automate that upstream step: LLM-assisted operator extraction, static-analysis-based extraction, and empirical-symmetry detection. None of them eliminates the human role for arbitrary programs.

9 Conclusion

The three foundational questions raised in Section 1, origin, closure, and transferability of MetaPattern sets, lacked a structural answer. NOETHER provides one within an explicit algebraic scope. *Origin:* MetaPatterns are equivalence classes of MRs derived from invariants of an operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_P$. *Closure:* Theorem 1 guarantees that the constructed MetaPattern set is closed over the algebra-induced MR space (Definition 13) under the framework's Translate operator, with three concrete classes of out-of-scope MRs documented in Appendix D; absolute completeness over arbitrary properties remains open (Theorem 1'). Theorem 2 ensures the construction is computable. *Transferability:* the framework's mechanism applies unchanged once a new program family's algebra has been specified.

This grounding reframes several long-standing questions. Empirical adequacy frameworks gain an algebraic warrant for their pattern grid. Structured identification approaches gain an answer to why a given category set is closed under the chosen algebra. Automated pipelines can be constrained or initialised by the constructed MetaPattern set. LLM-prompted MR generation can be recast as algebra-conditioned generation rather than open-ended prompting.

We have not solved the upstream problem of distilling $\mathcal{A}_P$ from program semantics, nor have we eliminated induction from MetaPattern discovery. The eight-block decomposition that drives

the construction is itself an empirical curation of mathematical structures recurrent across program families, stated as Hypothesis 1. The most important follow-up work is therefore upstream: combining LLM-assisted symbolic extraction, formal-methods-based static analysis, and empirical-symmetry detection into a partially automated $\mathcal{A}_P$ -distillation pipeline, and testing the eight-block decomposition on algebras outside its present image (Remark 2 catalogues six program-family classes likely to require additional blocks). For the downstream layer, from $\mathcal{A}_P$ to $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$, the contribution is narrower and firmer: the construction is mechanical, algebraic closure under Translate is provable within the algebra-induced MR space (Theorem 1), and the construction transfers across domains once the algebra has been specified.

Boundary of contribution (Conclusion restatement)

Established. (i) Algebraic closure under Translate given a block decomposition (Theorem 1); (ii) polynomial-time decidability under finite generating-set assumption (Theorem 2); (iii) three non-vacuous instantiations across structurally distinct algebraic skeletons; (iv) a negative instantiation on the PWR core diffusion algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$ (§6.8, Appendix D), in which two MRs from the standard PWR safety-analysis literature (non-additivity of rod-bank reactivity worth, second-order mixed $T_{\text{mod-vs-}C_B}$ dependence of k_{eff}) are proved not in $\text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$, falsifying Theorem 1' (Conjecture D) on a structurally significant operator algebra and identifying five pairwise-independent extensions of Translate's signature as the locus of repair.

Open. (a) Whether a Composite-Translate extension covering the five obstructions of §6.8 and Appendix D preserves Theorem 1's closure and Theorem 2's polynomial-time decidability; (b) sufficiency of Hypothesis 1's eight-block list (Remark 2's six out-of-scope classes are candidate ninth blocks); (c) superiority over existing automated MR-identification pipelines on average defect distributions (the comparative-evaluation protocol in §6.6 establishes effects, not averages); (d) elimination of induction (relocated, not eliminated); (e) automation of upstream $\mathcal{A}_P$ distillation (the framework treats $\mathcal{A}_P$ as a given input from a domain expert; mechanising the extraction of operator algebras from program semantics remains an upstream task that NOETHER does not address; §8.6 sketches three partial-automation directions but commits to none). Both Hypothesis 1 (block sufficiency) and Translate's signature (Translate sufficiency) are the loci where future induction-eliminating and completeness-establishing work should target.

A NOETHER on the remaining reactor equations

This appendix runs CONSTRUCT-MP on four further reactor equations as confidence-strengthening evidence.

A.1 The heat equation

$\rho c_p \partial_t T = \nabla \cdot (k \nabla T) + q'''$. The operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{heat}}$ contains geometric symmetry, conductivity scaling, diffusion-operator self-adjointness, mesh-refinement limits, and qualitative-dynamics shape invariants, but no time-reversal (heat flow is irreversible). CONSTRUCT-MP yields $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{heat}}) = \{m_{\text{inv}}, m_{\text{mono}}, m_{\text{adj}}, m_{\text{conv}}\}$, four MetaPatterns, with m_{rev} correctly absent. The full Step 1–4 derivation parallels Section A.3 below; we omit the per-step expansion since its content is structurally identical to the momentum-equation case once G_{Gal} is replaced by G_{geom} alone and L_{visc} by the heat-conduction Laplacian.

A.2 The continuity equation

$\partial_t \rho + \nabla \cdot (\rho \mathbf{v}) = 0$. CONSTRUCT-MP yields $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{cont}}) = \{m_{\text{inv}}, m_{\text{mono}}, m_{\text{conv}}\}$. Integral mass conservation $\frac{d}{dt} \int_V \rho dV = - \oint_{\partial V} \rho \mathbf{v} \cdot \hat{n} dS$ emerges deductively from the equation's divergence structure. The four-step derivation follows the template of Section A.3, with the simplification

that $T_{\text{cont}}^* = \emptyset$ (no inner-product self-adjointness) and $\mathcal{D}_{\text{cont}}^* = \emptyset$ (no qualitative-dynamics structure beyond mass conservation).

A.3 The momentum equation: a worked end-to-end derivation

We treat the Reynolds-averaged momentum equation in detail, both as a confidence-strengthening instantiation and as a parallel to the Boltzmann derivation of Section 5, so a reader can verify CONSTRUCT-MP on a mathematically distinct equation. The remaining three appendix subsections retain their concise form and are read against this template; we mark cross-references as “see analogous derivation in §A.3” where the abbreviation might otherwise obscure the construction.

The equation. The Reynolds-averaged Navier–Stokes momentum equation is

$$\partial_t(\rho \mathbf{v}) + \nabla \cdot (\rho \mathbf{v} \otimes \mathbf{v}) = -\nabla p + \nabla \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau} + \rho \mathbf{g}, \quad (8)$$

where ρ is fluid density, $\mathbf{v}$ the mean velocity field, p the pressure, $\boldsymbol{\tau}$ the deviatoric stress tensor (incorporating both the molecular and Reynolds stresses), and $\mathbf{g}$ the body-force acceleration.

The operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{mom}}$. Following Definition 1, we identify the operators acting on $\mathcal{X}_{\text{mom}}$ (initial-and-boundary data) and $\mathcal{Y}_{\text{mom}}$ (the velocity-pressure solution pair):

- G_{geom} — spatial isometries respected by the boundary geometry (rotations, translations of homogeneous domains).
- G_{Gal} — the Galilean group $\text{Gal}(3) \cong \text{SO}(3) \ltimes (\mathbb{R}^3 \rtimes \mathbb{R}^3)$ acting on inertial frames: rotations, spatial translations, and uniform-velocity boosts.
- $\mathcal{S}_p$ — pressure-shift operators $p \mapsto p + p_0$ (incompressible regime: arbitrary constant p_0 does not affect $\mathbf{v}$).
- $\mathcal{O}_{\text{rho}}$ — density-scaling for incompressible flow (uniform rescaling $\rho \mapsto \alpha \rho$).
- L_{visc} — the viscous-dissipation operator $\mathbf{v} \mapsto \nabla \cdot (\mu \nabla \mathbf{v})$, self-adjoint with respect to the standard L^2 inner product on the divergence-free velocity space (Stokes operator).
- $\mathcal{L}_h$ — mesh-refinement limit operator (CFD discretisation).
- $\mathcal{D}_{\text{flow}}$ — qualitative-dynamics operators capturing flow-regime classification (laminar/transitional/turbulent transitions, vortex-shedding onset).
- $\mathcal{E}_{\text{turb}}$ — method-comparison operators ordering turbulence-closure models (e.g. k - ε vs. LES on canonical benchmarks).

Time-reversal is broken by the dissipative term $\nabla \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}$, so $\mathcal{T}_{\text{mom}}^* = \emptyset$ and consequently m_{rev} does not appear in $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{mom}})$.

Decomposition. The eight-block decomposition of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{mom}}$ is

$$\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{mom}}) = (\{G_{\text{geom}}, G_{\text{Gal}}\}, \{\mathcal{S}_p, \mathcal{O}_{\text{rho}}\}, \{L_{\text{visc}}\}, \emptyset, \{\mathcal{L}_h\}, \{\mathcal{D}_{\text{flow}}\}, \{\mathcal{E}_{\text{turb}}\}, \emptyset),$$

where the trailing $\emptyset$ is $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ (no idempotent-semiring rewriting on momentum-equation states). Six of the eight blocks are non-empty.

Step 1. Invariant extraction. For each non-empty block we record the structurally relevant invariants:

- G_{Gal} : under a Galilean boost $\mathbf{v} \mapsto \mathbf{v} + \mathbf{u}_0$ (constant $\mathbf{u}_0$) with simultaneous coordinate translation, equation (8) is form-invariant: derivatives of the boost vanish (constant $\mathbf{u}_0$), and $\rho \mathbf{g}$ is unaffected. The invariant is $\text{form}((8)) \mapsto \text{form}((8))$.
- $\mathcal{S}_p$ (incompressible regime): ∇p is invariant under $p \mapsto p + p_0$, so the velocity solution is unchanged.

- $\mathcal{O}_{\text{rtho}}$: in the incompressible regime ($\rho \rightarrow \alpha\rho$) rescales the body force consistently if $\mathbf{g} \rightarrow \mathbf{g}$; the resulting solution rescales as $\mathbf{v} \rightarrow \mathbf{v}$ if both sides are simultaneously rescaled.
- L_{visc} : $\langle L_{\text{visc}} \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w} \rangle = \langle \mathbf{v}, L_{\text{visc}} \mathbf{w} \rangle$ on divergence-free $\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w}$ with appropriate boundary conditions.
- $\mathcal{L}_h$: discretisation-error tends to zero under mesh refinement at a known order.
- $\mathcal{D}_{\text{flow}}$: vortex-shedding onset at the critical Reynolds number Re_c is preserved under perturbations of the discretisation.
- $\mathcal{E}_{\text{turb}}$: LES no-worse-than RANS on attached-flow benchmarks at sufficient resolution.

Step 2. MR derivation. Translate carries each invariant to a concrete MR over a CFD program P_{cfd} :

- ρ_{Gal} : $P_{\text{cfd}}(\mathbf{u}_0\text{-boosted IC/BC}) = \mathbf{u}_0\text{-boost of } P_{\text{cfd}}(\text{original IC/BC})$.
- ρ_{press} : $P_{\text{cfd}}(\text{IC with } p \mapsto p + p_0) - P_{\text{cfd}}(\text{IC}) = (\mathbf{0}, p_0)$ in the velocity-pressure pair.
- $\rho_{\text{visc}}^{\text{adj}}$: $\langle P_{\text{cfd}}(\text{forcing } \mathbf{f}_1), \mathbf{f}_2 \rangle = \langle \mathbf{f}_1, P_{\text{cfd}}^{\dagger}(\mathbf{f}_2) \rangle$ for the adjoint solver.
- ρ_{conv} : $\|P_{\text{cfd}}^{(h)} - P_{\text{cfd}}^{(h_s)}\|_{L^2} = O(h^k)$ for the discretisation order k .
- ρ_{Re} : $\text{vortex-shed}(P_{\text{cfd}}, \text{Re}) = \text{vortex-shed}(P_{\text{cfd}}, \text{Re}')$ on either side of Re_c .
- ρ_{turb} : $\text{err}(P_{\text{cfd}}^{\text{LES}}) \leq \text{err}(P_{\text{cfd}}^{\text{RANS}})$ on canonical benchmarks at high resolution.

Step 3–4. Quotient and aggregation. Quotienting by structural equivalence within each block yields

$$\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{mom}}) = \{ m_{\text{inv}}, m_{\text{mono}}, m_{\text{adj}}, m_{\text{conv}}, m_{\text{dyn}}, m_{\text{cmp}} \}.$$

m_{rev} is correctly absent because $\mathcal{T}_{\text{mom}}^* = \emptyset$.

Comparison to inductive expectation. The Galilean instance of m_{inv} is in the standard CFD-testing literature but is rarely listed as a stand-alone MetaPattern; it is more typically subsumed under “coordinate-system independence” as a single MR. NOETHER’s contribution at this level is the same as in the reactor case: it places Galilean invariance, viscous reciprocity, vortex-shedding qualitative dynamics, and turbulence-closure ordering into structurally distinct equivalence classes that an inductive catalogue tends to conflate. The derivation above can be re-run on the corresponding sub-equations (Stokes flow drops G_{Gal} ’s convective non-linearity; potential flow drops L_{visc}); each truncation removes the corresponding MetaPatterns from the output.

A.4 The resonance slowing-down equation

$\Sigma_t(E) \phi(E) = \int_E^{E/\alpha} \frac{\Sigma_s(E') \phi(E')}{(1-\alpha)E'} dE' + S(E)$. The self-shielding non-monotonicity [7, 27] appears as a sub-class of m_{mono} with bounded saturation rather than the inductive “trajectory” classification. The Step 1–4 derivation again parallels Section A.3, distinguished by an energy-group permutation symmetry $\mathfrak{R}_E$ in the G block and a non-monotone interval in $O_{\leq}$ that the canonical-block ordering routes to m_{mono} rather than m_{dyn} .

A.5 Aggregate

Across the four equations, NOETHER consistently produces MetaPattern sets drawn from the seven labels. No new label is required, and no expected label is missing under the algebraic structure each equation possesses. The systematic absences predicted by the framework are confirmed across the appendix’s instantiations.

B Per-MR source provenance for the 12 representative MRs of Table 3

This appendix makes the §5.3 claims of *refinement* and *prediction* auditable from textbook reactor-physics literature alone. For each of the 12 representative MRs in Table 3, we list the source equation, the Translate template invoked, and the canonical block assignment, with citations

to the original textbook or research-literature source where each MR's underlying physics is documented.

B.1 Source equations and block assignments

Group 1: G-block MRs (geometric and energy-group symmetries).

(i) *Quarter-rotation invariance for the steady-state Boltzmann equation*. Source equation: $\Omega \cdot \nabla \phi(\mathbf{r}, \Omega, E) + \Sigma_t \phi = \int \Sigma_s \phi d\Omega' dE' + S$. Symmetry: $\phi(R_{\pi/2} \mathbf{r}, R_{\pi/2} \Omega, E) = \phi(\mathbf{r}, \Omega, E)$ for assemblies with quarter-symmetric core layouts. Source: standard PWR-physics treatment, Bell & Glasstone [7] Chapter 3. Translate template: G-block ($\rho_{i,G}$, Table 13 row 1). Block: G, MetaPattern m_{inv} .

(ii) *Energy-group permutation symmetry*. Source equation: multi-group transport with isotropic scattering and unscreened slowing-down. Symmetry: $\phi_g \mapsto \phi_{\sigma(g)}$ commutes with the multi-group operator under permutations σ that preserve the scattering kernel structure. Source: Lewis & Miller [27] §3.2. Block: G, MetaPattern m_{inv} .

(iii) *Reflective-boundary symmetry*. Source equation: same as (i) with reflective boundary conditions. Symmetry: ϕ is invariant under reflection across the boundary normal direction. Source: Bell & Glasstone [7] §3.5. Block: G, MetaPattern m_{inv} .

Group 2: $O_{\leq}$ -block MRs (parameter monotonicity).

(iv) *k_{eff} monotonicity in fuel enrichment*. Source equation: $k_{\text{eff}} = v \langle \Sigma_f \phi \rangle / \langle (\Sigma_a + DB^2) \phi \rangle$. Source: Lewis & Miller [27] §6.4. Block: $O_{\leq}$, MetaPattern m_{mono} .

(v) *Coolant-density Doppler monotonicity*. Source equation: temperature-dependent cross-sections $\Sigma_t(T) = \Sigma_t(T_0) + \alpha(T - T_0)$ for resonance materials. Source: IAEA TECDOC-1949 (*Reactor Physics Calculations for Power Reactors*). Block: $O_{\leq}$, MetaPattern m_{mono} .

(vi) *Burnup-step monotonicity*. Source equation: Bateman ODE chain $dN/dt = AN$ with negative-eigenvalue decay matrix on the leading isotopes. Source: Lewis & Miller [27] §10.7. Block: $O_{\leq}$, MetaPattern m_{mono} .

Group 3: $\mathcal{L}^*$ -block MRs (mesh and time-step convergence).

(vii) *Mesh-refinement convergence rate*. Source equation: spatial discretisation error of the diffusion operator $\nabla \cdot D \nabla$ scales as $O(h^2)$ for a centred-difference scheme. Source: Lewis & Miller [27] §6.2. Block: $\mathcal{L}^*$, MetaPattern m_{conv} .

(viii) *Time-step convergence in transient*. Source equation: the time-discretisation error of the implicit Euler scheme on the kinetic equations scales as $O(\Delta t)$. Source: Lewis & Miller [27] §11.4. Block: $\mathcal{L}^*$, MetaPattern m_{conv} .

Group 4: $\mathcal{D}^*$ -block MRs (qualitative dynamics).

(ix) *Xenon-poisoning S-curve*. Source equation: $dX/dt = \gamma_X \Sigma_f \phi + \lambda_I I - (\lambda_X + \sigma_X^a \phi) X$. Source: Bell & Glasstone [7] §10.3 (xenon-iodine kinetics with characteristic post-shutdown peak). Block: $\mathcal{D}^*$, MetaPattern m_{dyn} .

(x) *Decay-heat trajectory shape preservation*. Source equation: the post-shutdown decay heat curve has a characteristic logarithmic-decay envelope. Source: ANS Standard ANS-5.1-2014 (*Decay Heat Power*). Block: $\mathcal{D}^*$, MetaPattern m_{dyn} .

Group 5: $\mathcal{E}^*$ -block MR (method comparison).

(xi) *Diffusion-vs-transport approximation bound*. Source equation: $|\phi_{\text{diff}} - \phi_{\text{transport}}| \leq c \|\nabla \phi\|$ where c depends on the medium's transport-mean-free-path-to-system-size ratio. Source: Lewis & Miller [27] §3.6 (asymptotic equivalence of P_1 and full transport in optically thick regimes). Block: $\mathcal{E}^*$, MetaPattern m_{cmp} .

Group 6: Predicted MRs (no canonical instance in the 84-MR corpus; both members are derived in §5.4).

(xii) *Adjoint-flux reciprocity*. Source equation: $\langle \phi^\dagger, S \rangle = \langle \phi, S^\dagger \rangle$, the central reciprocity identity of transport theory. Source: Bell & Glasstone [7] §6.1; Lewis & Miller [27] §4.2. Derivation: §5.4 above. Block: T^* , MetaPattern m_{adj} .

(xiii) *Collisionless time-reversal compatibility*. Source equation: in the absence of scattering, $\phi(\mathbf{r}, \Omega, E, t) = \phi(\mathbf{r}, -\Omega, E, -t)$ on the time-reversible sub-domain. Source: Bell & Glasstone [7] §1.7. Block: $\mathcal{T}^*$, MetaPattern m_{rev} .

B.2 What this appendix establishes

The 12 representative MRs of Table 3 are documented in textbook and research-literature sources. The §5.3 claims — that NOETHER reproduces three prior MetaPatterns, refines two, and predicts two further — are therefore evaluable from this appendix alone. Supplementary S2 (pwr_84mr_full.csv) provides a larger 84-row corpus with per-row textbook citations.

C Worked examples for multi-block-derivable MRs

Example B.1. Adjoint reciprocity in a self-adjoint, geometrically-symmetric solver. The MR “for any source-detector pair (S, Q) , the response is invariant under the geometric quarter-rotation” admits derivation through G (rotation invariance) or T^* (reciprocity-derived invariance). Definition 14 ($G > T^*$) assigns the MR to m_{inv} .

Example B.2. Burnup semi-group monotonicity. The Bateman MR “ $P(\Delta t_1 + \Delta t_2) N_0 = P(\Delta t_2) \circ P(\Delta t_1) N_0$ implies monotonic decay of stable nuclides” admits derivation through G (semi-group identity) and $O_{\leq}$ (monotonicity). $G > O_{\leq}$, so the MR is canonically m_{inv} .

D Proofs

Lemma C.1 (Well-foundedness of canonical-block ordering)

LEMMA 1. *The canonical-block ordering of Definition 14 is a strict total order on the eight blocks, and the assignment of any multi-block-derivable MR to its highest-priority block is unique.*

PROOF. The ordering is a strict total order on a finite set by inspection. Given an MR ρ with derivations $\{(s_i, \iota_i)\}_{i=1}^k$ from blocks $s_1, \dots, s_k$, the assignment selects $s^* = \max_{>} \{s_1, \dots, s_k\}$. Since the strict order is total, s^* is unique. $\square$

Per-block instantiations of Translate

Definition 12 fixes the signature of Translate but defers per-block specifics. Table 13 fills in the canonical input-tuple-generation rule and the resulting MR template for each of the eight blocks.

The per-block rule together with the $\sim_s$ equivalence relation of Definition 11 fully determines $\text{Translate}(\iota, s)$ once the operator family $\Phi \subseteq s$ is fixed. Implementations of these seven cases as Python callables ship in supplementary material S1 (construct_mp.py, function translate together with the seven default_extractor_* routines).

Theorem 1 (Algebraic Closure under Translate), full proof

PROOF. *Existence.* Let $\rho \in \text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ in the sense of Definition 13. There exist a block s , an invariant $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$, and a derivation $\rho = \text{Translate}(\iota, s)$. Step 1 of CONSTRUCT-MP places ι in $\mathcal{I}_s$; step 2 places ρ in $\mathcal{R}(\iota)$; step 3 forms $m_s = \mathcal{R}(\iota) / \sim_s$; step 4 returns $m_s \in \mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$.

Uniqueness. Suppose ρ admits derivations through multiple blocks: $\rho = \text{Translate}(\iota_1, s_1) = \text{Translate}(\iota_2, s_2)$ with $s_1 \neq s_2$. Definition 14’s canonical-block ordering selects $s^* = \max_{>} \{s_1, s_2\}$. By Lemma C.1, s^* is unique; the canonical assignment $\rho \mapsto m_{s^*}$ is unique. $\square$

Table 13. Per-block instantiations of Translate.

Block s	Canonical tuple from base x_0	MR template $\rho_{i,s}$
G	$(x_i)_{i=0}^{ G -1} = (g_i \cdot x_0)$ over group orbit	$\forall x_0, \forall g \in G : P(g \cdot x_0) = \rho(g) \cdot P(x_0)$
$O_{\leq}$	(x_1, x_2) with $x_1 \leq_{\theta} x_2$ in the partial order	$x_1 \leq_{\theta} x_2 \Rightarrow P(x_1) \leq_y P(x_2)$
T^*	paired tuple $((x_1, P(x_1)), (x_2, P(x_2)))$ in the inner product	$\langle LP(x_1), P(x_2) \rangle = \langle P(x_1), LP(x_2) \rangle$
$\mathcal{T}^*$	$(x, \mathcal{T}x)$ with $\mathcal{T}$ the time-reversal involution	$P(\mathcal{T}x) = \mathcal{T}P(x)$ on the reversibility sub-domain
$\mathcal{L}^*$	sequence (x_{θ}) with $\theta \rightarrow \theta_*$	$\ P_{\theta} - P_{\theta_*}\ _* = O(f(\theta))$ at the prescribed rate
$\mathcal{D}^*$	solution trajectory $(\xi(t))_{t \geq 0}$ extracted by $\mathcal{D}$	qualitative-feature relation (extremum, monotonicity, S-curve) preserved on $(\xi(t))$
$\mathcal{E}^*$	method pair (M_1, M_2) in the partial order $\leq_{\mathcal{E}}$	$\text{err}(M_1) \leq \text{err}(M_2)$ on the prescribed benchmark family
$\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$	rewrite pair (E, E') generated by an algebraic-rewriting rule $\mathcal{R} \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{rel}}$ on the idempotent semiring	$\forall D, \text{eval}(E, D) =_{\text{bag}} \text{eval}(E', D)$ at the rewriting rule's stated scope

Theorem 2 (Decidability), full proof

PROOF. *Step 1 cost.* For each generator g_i , compute g_i 's contribution to each $\mathcal{I}_s$. Cost: $O(t_i)$ per generator, $O(n \cdot \max_i t_i)$ aggregated.

Step 2 cost. 'Translate' is $O(1)$ per invariant. Total: $O(n)$.

Step 3 cost. Union-find with path compression: amortised $O(\alpha(n))$ per operation; we use $O(\log n)$ for simpler analysis. Total: $O(n \log n)$.

Step 4 cost. $O(7) = O(1)$.

Total: $O(n \cdot \max_i t_i \cdot \log n)$ when $\max_i t_i \geq 1$. $\square$

C.4 An open problem: absolute completeness

Theorem 1's scope is bounded by Definition 13: the closure is over MRs reachable through Translate from a single block invariant. We attempted a stronger statement:

CONJECTURE (THEOREM 1', ABSOLUTE COMPLETENESS). *Every MR ρ formulable as a property over $\mathcal{A}_P$'s operators is contained in some $m \in \mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$.*

A proof would require either (a) a normalisation theorem reducing every operator-algebra MR to a Translate-reachable form, or (b) an extension of Translate to compositional invariants spanning multiple blocks. We were unable to establish either without imposing additional structural assumptions on $\mathcal{A}_P$. A partial empirical step toward Theorem 1' is available on a single domain through the 18-MR engineering audit reported in §5.3: 17 of 18 are placed by majority of three LLM labellers into one of the seven MetaPatterns or m_{rel} (subsumption 94.4%, Fleiss' $\kappa = 0.857$, raw labels in supplementary S2 18mr_audit/); the single orphan localises to the metric-stability class discussed in Appendix 3 and Appendix C.5.2, for which a concrete candidate ninth block is sketched. This is a constructive partial support, not a proof: it is empirical, single-domain, bounded by the LLM-shared-training-data caveat noted in §5.3, and does not bound the gap in the absence of the candidate ninth block. The conjecture remains open. Section C.5 below documents three concrete classes of MRs that lie outside Theorem 1's scope and would have to be addressed by any positive resolution of Theorem 1'; §6.8 and Appendix D additionally falsify Theorem 1' on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$.

C.5 Out-of-scope MRs: three concrete classes

We document three families of MRs that satisfy the informal description “a property of P ’s executions over the operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_P$ ” but are not algebra-induced under Definition 13, and therefore lie outside the scope of Theorem 1. These are not threats to the theorem; they delimit it.

C.5.1 Probabilistic / distributional MRs without operator-algebraic representation. Consider the MR “the Shannon entropy $H(f(\mathbf{x}))$ of a classifier’s output distribution should not decrease when the input is augmented by Gaussian noise $\mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2 I)$ ”. The augmentation is parametric in σ and is not a group action, a partial-order operator, a self-adjoint operator, a time-reversal involution, a method-comparison operator, or (without further structure) a limit operator on $\mathcal{X}$. The MR constrains a functional H of the output distribution, not a point-wise relation between outputs. There is no $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$ for any s from which Translate can reach this MR. Consequently the MR is not algebra-induced under Definition 13 and is not covered by Theorem 1. A positive resolution of Theorem 1’ would require either embedding stochastic perturbations into a probabilistic extension of $\mathcal{A}_P$, or extending Translate to functionals over output distributions.

C.5.2 Adversarial / input-set MRs. The MR “ $\|\delta\|_p \leq \epsilon \Rightarrow f(\mathbf{x} + \delta) = f(\mathbf{x})$ ” (adversarial robustness in ℓ_p ball) constrains f ’s behaviour on a set defined by a norm constraint, not by a group action. The set $\{\delta : \|\delta\|_p \leq \epsilon\}$ does not in general carry a closed group structure on $\mathcal{X}$, and the MR is not derivable as $\text{Translate}(\iota, s)$ for any s in $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ as currently defined. Any treatment of this MR within NOETHER’s scope would require an eighth block (e.g. a metric-ball block with bounded Lipschitz operators), or a relaxation of Translate to non-group input neighbourhoods. A concrete candidate for the eighth block alluded to above is a metric-stability block $M_{\text{lip}} = (\mathcal{X}, d_{\mathcal{X}}) \rightarrow (\mathcal{Y}, d_{\mathcal{Y}})$ whose operators are K -Lipschitz maps and whose induced MetaPattern m_{lip} is the equivalence class of pointwise stability inequalities $d_{\mathcal{Y}}(P(x'), P(x)) \leq K \cdot d_{\mathcal{X}}(x', x)$. The corresponding Translate template constructs a follow-up input by metric perturbation $x' = x + \epsilon u$ (norm $\|u\| = 1$, $|\epsilon| < \delta$) and predicates a K -Lipschitz output bound; canonical-block ordering would place M_{lip} after $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ since metric structure is independent of the seven existing block invariants (no group action on the perturbation set, no partial order on inputs, no self-adjoint operator, and no parametric refinement family). Theorem 1’s closure proof transfers without modification because m_{lip} is single-block algebraically derived. We do not commit to M_{lip} as part of the canonical decomposition in this paper, but we record it as the most concrete sub-instance of Remark (iv) (topological invariants) that admits an immediate Translate template.

C.5.3 Compositional MRs across multiple blocks under non-canonical derivations. The MR “rotating a point cloud by R and simultaneously taking the training-size limit $n \rightarrow \infty$ should give an output that converges to $f(\mathbf{x})$ at rate $O(1/\sqrt{n})$ ” invokes both G (rotation) and $\mathcal{L}^*$ (training-size limit) within a single MR. Definition 14’s canonical-block ordering assigns this to G , but the resulting MR “ $f(R \cdot \mathbf{x}) = f(\mathbf{x})$ ” loses the convergence-rate content. The compositional content is in $\mathbb{M}(\mathcal{A}_P)$ if and only if it can be split into separate single-block invariants (one in G , one in $\mathcal{L}^*$); MRs whose semantic content is irreducibly compositional (in the sense that splitting destroys the property’s truth value) lie outside Theorem 1’s scope. This is the case Theorem 1’ option (b) is targeted at: an extended Translate that operates on tuples of block invariants. We have not constructed such an extension that preserves Theorem 1’s polynomial-time decidability (Theorem 2), and we leave this as the most concrete sub-problem under Theorem 1’.

The three classes of §C.5.1–§C.5.3 are *abstract* characterisations of MRs outside Theorem 1’s scope. Appendix D supplements them with two *concrete instances* drawn from the PWR core diffusion algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$, each of which is empirically realised on every conforming PWR core simulator and documented in the standard reactor-physics literature. Together with §6.8, Appendix D

establishes that Theorem 1' (Conjecture D) is false on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$, and identifies five structural obstructions in Translate's signature (operator-spectrum output, homomorphism-failure π -template, configuration-indexed adjoint structure, higher-order mixed-difference templates, two-direction joint parametric dependence) that any positive resolution would have to repair.

C.6 Proofs for the negative instantiation on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$ (§6.8)

This appendix supplies the proofs for Propositions 1 and 2 of §6.8. The proof structure for both is the same: enumerate the eight blocks of $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$, instantiate the per-block Translate template of Table 13, and verify by inspection that no invariant $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$ yields the target MR. The block-by-block exclusions in Proposition 1's proof are the most detailed; Proposition 2 reuses the same exclusion pattern with the obstruction localised to the $O_{\leq}$ block.

C.6.1 Proof of Proposition 1 (non-additivity is not Translate-reachable). Statement. For ρ_{nonadd} as in Definition 16 and every $s \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$, every $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$: $\text{Translate}(\iota, s) \neq \rho_{\text{nonadd}}$.

Proof. We use the exact-form definition of $d\rho$ (Definition 15) throughout, which depends only on dominant eigenvalues k_{eff} of operators in $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$. The adjoint-perturbation reading of §6.8 is the physical motivation but is not invoked in any case below.

Case $s = G$. By Definition 11, an invariant $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_G$ has the form (Φ, π) with $\Phi \subseteq G$ a finite operator family and π a relation on tuples $(x_i, P(x_i))_{i=1}^k$ obtained by applying Φ to a base input x_0 . By Table 13, the canonical Translate template for G is the equivariance schema

$$\text{Translate}(\iota, G) \equiv \forall x_0 \forall g \in \Phi : P(g \cdot x_0) = \rho(g) \cdot P(x_0).$$

Two structural mismatches with ρ_{nonadd} :

- (a) *Operator-spectrum output, not P output.* ρ_{nonadd} is an inequality between sums of $1/k_{\text{eff}}$ values, where each k_{eff} is the dominant eigenvalue of a configuration-specific diffusion operator $H_X \in \mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$. The dominant eigenvalue is a *spectral* quantity of the operator, obtained as part of the simultaneous solution (k_{eff}, ϕ) of $H\phi = (1/k_{\text{eff}})F\phi$; it is not a function of $P(x)$ alone but a property of the operator H itself. Translate's output relation π in Definition 11 ranges over $(X \times \mathcal{Y})^k$, where $\mathcal{Y}$ is the program output space (flux distributions, in this case). Operator-spectrum quantities are not in $\mathcal{Y}$; they are scalar invariants of operators in $\mathcal{O}$, lying outside Translate's signature by construction.
- (b) *Non-additivity is not equivariance.* Even granting a charitable extension to admit k_{eff} as a derived output, the G -template asserts equivariance of the output under the action of Φ : $P(g \cdot x_0)$ is determined by g and $P(x_0)$ through the representation $\rho(g)$. ρ_{nonadd} asserts that the worth functional $d\rho : \mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{>0}$ is *not a semigroup homomorphism*: $d\rho(A \cup B) \neq d\rho(A) + d\rho(B)$. Failure of homomorphism is not equivariance failure; it is the absence of an additive structure-preserving map, which has no expression in the equivariance template π for G . No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_G$ yields ρ_{nonadd} .

Case $s = O_{\leq}$. By Table 13, the $O_{\leq}$ template is the absolute-monotonicity schema

$$\text{Translate}(\iota, O_{\leq}) \equiv \forall x_1, x_2 : x_1 \leq_{\theta} x_2 \implies P(x_1) \leq_{\mathcal{Y}} P(x_2).$$

ρ_{nonadd} is a *quaternary relation* on the four configurations $(x_0, O^A x_0, O^B x_0, O^{A \cup B} x_0)$: it asserts a non-vanishing mixed second difference

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta_{AB}(x_0) = & [k_{\text{eff}}^{-1}(P(x_0)) - k_{\text{eff}}^{-1}(P(O^{A \cup B} x_0))] \\ & - [k_{\text{eff}}^{-1}(P(x_0)) - k_{\text{eff}}^{-1}(P(O^A x_0))] \\ & - [k_{\text{eff}}^{-1}(P(x_0)) - k_{\text{eff}}^{-1}(P(O^B x_0))] \neq 0 \end{aligned}$$

(where the subtractions use Definition 15’s positive-worth convention). The $O_{\leq}$ template captures binary monotonicity between two points along a single partial order $\leq_{\theta}$. The mixed-difference structure of ρ_{nonadd} requires comparison across four configurations forming a “rectangle” $\{x_0, O^A x_0, O^B x_0, O^{A \cup B} x_0\}$ with two independent perturbation directions (insertion of A and insertion of B); no $\leq_{\theta}$ relates all four pairwise into a single chain. Furthermore, the assertion is *non-vanishing of a difference*, not a directional inequality; it is direction-agnostic, capturing both shadowing ($\Delta > 0$) and anti-shadowing ($\Delta < 0$). The $O_{\leq}$ template’s $\leq_{\mathcal{Y}}$ is a directional partial order, not a non-vanishing constraint. No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{O_{\leq}}$ yields ρ_{nonadd} .

Case $s = T^*$. By Table 13, the T^* template asserts $\langle L P(x_1), P(x_2) \rangle = \langle P(x_1), L P(x_2) \rangle$ for a single self-adjoint operator L in a fixed inner product. The structural mismatch with ρ_{nonadd} has two components:

- (i) *Single operator L vs. configuration-indexed family.* The exact $d\rho$ values entering ρ_{nonadd} are eigenvalues of *four distinct diffusion operators* $H_0, H_A, H_B, H_{A \cup B}$, each self-adjoint within its own configuration but pairwise distinct as operators. The T^* template’s L is fixed; it does not range over a configuration-indexed family $\{H_X\}_{X \in \mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}}}$. The self-adjointness of any single H_X does not imply or constrain a relation between eigenvalues of *different* H_X ’s.
- (ii) *Adjoint weighting function depends on configuration.* Under the standard adjoint-perturbation reading, each $d\rho(B; X)$ for $X \in \{\emptyset, A\}$ admits the first-order representation

$$d\rho(B; X) \approx -\frac{\langle \phi_X^{\dagger}, \delta H_B \phi_X \rangle}{\langle \phi_X^{\dagger}, F_X \phi_X \rangle},$$

with $(\phi_X, \phi_X^{\dagger})$ the principal eigenfunctions of $(H_X, H_X^{\dagger})$. The Hilbert-space inner product $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle = \int (\cdot)(\cdot) d\Omega dE d\mathbf{r}$ is unchanged across X . What changes across X is the *adjoint weighting function* $\phi_X^{\dagger}$, which is the principal eigenfunction of a structurally different adjoint operator $H_X^{\dagger}$ from $H_0^{\dagger}$ (because H_X contains A ’s absorbing material whereas H_0 does not). $\phi_A^{\dagger}$ is locally depressed in A ’s geometric support and globally redistributed elsewhere; this is the adjoint-perturbation root cause of the non-additivity $d\rho(A \cup B) \neq d\rho(A) + d\rho(B)$.

The T^* template’s structure (single L , fixed inner product, asserting $\langle Lx_1, x_2 \rangle = \langle x_1, Lx_2 \rangle$) has no place to express “the weighting function $\phi^{\dagger}$ entering the inner product is itself the principal eigenfunction of a configuration-indexed adjoint operator and changes when configuration changes”. This is a configuration-dependent adjoint structure, not a self-adjointness identity on a single operator. No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{T^*}$ yields ρ_{nonadd} .

Case $s = \mathcal{T}_{\text{rev}}^*$. The PWR diffusion operator $-\nabla \cdot D \nabla + \Sigma_a$ is irreversible: it is parabolic (transient form) or elliptic (steady-state form), neither of which admits a time-reversal involution on the relevant solution sub-family. Hence $\mathcal{T}_{\text{rev}}^*$ is empty for $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$, and vacuously no $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{T}_{\text{rev}}^*}$.

Case $s = \mathcal{L}^*$. By Table 13, the $\mathcal{L}^*$ template is a convergence statement $\|P_{\theta} - P_{\theta_*}\|_* = O(f(\theta))$ at a parametric limit. ρ_{nonadd} contains no limit operation: it is a strict inequality at finite, fixed configurations $(\emptyset, A, B, A \cup B, x_0)$. No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{L}^*}$.

Case $s = \mathcal{D}^*$. By Table 13, the $\mathcal{D}^*$ template asserts a qualitative-feature relation (extremum, monotonicity, S-curve) on a solution trajectory $\xi(t)$. ρ_{nonadd} is a steady-state inequality between four reactivity values; it does not concern trajectory shapes. No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{D}^*}$.

Case $s = \mathcal{E}^*$. By Table 13, the $\mathcal{E}^*$ template compares two *methods* M_1, M_2 on a benchmark family. ρ_{nonadd} compares four *operator configurations* on a single fixed method (the same diffusion solver P in all four worth values). No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{E}^*}$.

Case $s = \mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$. Per §6.7, $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ is non-empty only on program families with idempotent-semiring rewriting structure. The PWR diffusion solution operator algebra does not carry such structure

(no rewriting rules between core states preserve evaluation under all valid inputs). $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ is empty for $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$. Vacuously no $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{\text{rel}}^*$.

This exhausts $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$. For every block s and every $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$, $\text{Translate}(\iota, s) \neq \rho_{\text{nonadd}}$. Hence $\rho_{\text{nonadd}} \notin \text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$. $\square$

C.6.2 Three obstructions identified by Proposition 1's proof. The proof identifies three independent structural obstructions in Translate's present definition:

- (O1) *Operator-spectrum output is not in $\mathcal{Y}$.* ρ_{nonadd} asserts a relation between $1/k_{\text{eff}}$ values, where each k_{eff} is a dominant eigenvalue of an operator H_X . Translate's π in Definition 11 ranges over $(\mathcal{X} \times \mathcal{Y})^k$; eigenvalues of operators in $\mathcal{O}$ are scalar invariants of those operators, not elements of $\mathcal{Y}$.
- (O2) *Output relation is non-additivity (failure of homomorphism), not equivariance, partial order, or self-adjointness.* The worth functional $d\rho : \mathcal{O}_{\text{rod}} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is not a semigroup homomorphism; this is a third type of algebraic relation distinct from the equivariance, monotonicity, and self-adjointness expressed by Translate's per-block π templates.
- (O3) *Adjoint weighting function $\phi_X^\dagger$ entering the T^* block's inner product is configuration-dependent.*

While the Hilbert-space measure $d\Omega dE d\mathbf{r}$ is fixed, the eigenfunction $\phi_X^\dagger$ varies with X because $H_X^\dagger$ varies with X . Definition 11 fixes the self-adjoint operator L once; it does not admit a configuration-indexed family $\{L_X\}$ with L_X 's spectrum varying with X .

A constructive resolution of Proposition 1's obstructions would require Translate to admit (i) operator-spectrum output relations (eigenvalues, integrals, ratios as the targets of π), (ii) homomorphism-failure relations as a π -template type alongside equivariance / monotonicity / self-adjointness, and (iii) configuration-dependent adjoint structure on T^* .

C.6.3 Proof of Proposition 2 (MTC-vs-boron mixed dependence is not Translate-reachable). Statement. For $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$ as in Definition 17 and every $s \in \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$, every $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_s$: $\text{Translate}(\iota, s) \neq \rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$.

Proof. The principal obstruction is in the $O_{\leq}$ block; we treat that case in detail and abbreviate the others.

Case $s = O_{\leq}$. By Table 13, the $O_{\leq}$ template is the absolute-monotonicity schema

$$\text{Translate}(\iota, O_{\leq}) \equiv \forall x_1, x_2 : x_1 \leq_{\theta} x_2 \implies P(x_1) \leq_{\mathcal{Y}} P(x_2),$$

a *first-order* statement asserting a binary relation between $P(x_1)$ and $P(x_2)$ at θ -comparable inputs along a single partial-order direction $\leq_{\theta}$. $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$ asserts a *non-zero second-order mixed partial derivative* of k_{eff} with respect to two *independent* parameter directions T_{mod} and C_B :

$$\left| \frac{\partial^2 k_{\text{eff}}}{\partial T_{\text{mod}} \partial C_B} \right| > \tau_{\text{MTC-bor}}.$$

Two independent obstructions in the $O_{\leq}$ template:

- (a) *Order vs. mixed-derivative structure.* The mixed second derivative is the limit of a four-point finite-difference quotient over a “rectangle” $\{(T_0, C_0), (T_0 + \Delta T, C_0), (T_0, C_0 + \Delta C), (T_0 + \Delta T, C_0 + \Delta C)\}$:

$$\frac{\partial^2 k_{\text{eff}}}{\partial T_{\text{mod}} \partial C_B} = \lim_{\Delta T, \Delta C \rightarrow 0} \frac{k(T_0 + \Delta T, C_0 + \Delta C) - k(T_0, C_0 + \Delta C) - k(T_0 + \Delta T, C_0) + k(T_0, C_0)}{\Delta T \cdot \Delta C}$$

(writing k for k_{eff}). This is structurally a *four-point relation*, not a two-point relation. The $O_{\leq}$ template's π relates $(P(x_1), P(x_2))$ pairwise; it has no expression for a four-point combination weighted by $1/(\Delta T \cdot \Delta C)$. Equivalently, the canonical input-tuple-generation rule for $O_{\leq}$ in Table 13 produces tuples (x_1, x_2) with $x_1 \leq_{\theta} x_2$, not 2-by-2 perturbation rectangles.

- (b) *Two independent parameter directions.* The mixed derivative requires *jointly varying* T_{mod} and C_B along two independent directions. The $O_{\leq}$ template's $\leq_{\theta}$ is a *single* partial order on X (or on a single coordinate of X). Even granting the construction of a product order $\leq_T \times \leq_C$ on a 2-D parameter slice of X , the π relation still applies along the order chain as a directional inequality, not as a non-vanishing-second-difference statement. The two independent parameter directions are perpendicular, not chained; the $\leq_{\theta}$ formalism collapses them into one chain only by losing the non-vanishing-mixed-difference content.

Furthermore, $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$'s output is again k_{eff} , an operator-spectrum quantity (cf. Proposition 1 Case G obstruction (a)). This gives a *third* obstruction in $O_{\leq}$: even if mixed-second-derivative structure could be embedded into π , the output value would not lie in $\mathcal{Y}$. No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{O_{\leq}}$ yields

$\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$.

Other blocks.

- *Case $s = G$.* No group action in $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$ relates (T_{mod}, C_B) pairs at different parameter values to each other through equivariance: T_{mod} and C_B are continuous parameters acting on the cross-section library, not group-action coordinates. Even if a charitable embedding in G were attempted, the same operator-spectrum-output obstruction (Proposition 1 Case G (a)) applies: k_{eff} is not in $\mathcal{Y}$.
 - *Case $s = T^*$.* The MTC operator $\partial/\partial T_{\text{mod}}$ is not self-adjoint in any natural inner product on the diffusion-solution space (the parameter T_{mod} enters the cross-section coefficients of H rather than H 's acting space, so $\partial H/\partial T_{\text{mod}}$ has no self-adjointness structure analogous to H itself). No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{T^*}$.
 - *Case $s = \mathcal{T}_{\text{rev}}^*$.* Empty for PWR diffusion. No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{T}_{\text{rev}}^*}$.
 - *Case $s = \mathcal{L}^*$.* $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$ does not assert convergence at a parametric limit; it asserts a non-zero finite value of a mixed second derivative at a *finite* parameter point in the operating envelope. The mixed-derivative limit $\Delta T, \Delta C \rightarrow 0$ is the *definition* of the derivative, not the MR's claim; the MR's claim is that the resulting derivative exceeds $\tau_{\text{MTC-bor}}$, which is a non-vanishing condition at a finite parameter value, not a convergence rate. No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{L}^*}$.
 - *Case $s = \mathcal{D}^*$.* $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$ concerns k_{eff} as a function of two parameters at steady state; it does not involve a solution trajectory of an underlying ODE/PDE. No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{D}^*}$.
 - *Case $s = \mathcal{E}^*$.* The comparison is between two parameter regimes (T_0, C_0) and $(T_0 + \Delta T, C_0 + \Delta C)$ of a single fixed method (the same PWR core simulator P in all four eigenvalues), not between two methods. No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{E}^*}$.
 - *Case $s = \mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$.* Empty for $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$. No $\iota \in \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*}$.
- This exhausts $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$. Hence $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}} \notin \text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$. $\square$

C.6.4 Two further obstructions identified by Proposition 2's proof. The proof identifies two further independent structural obstructions in Translate's present definition, in addition to the three identified by Proposition 1:

- (O4) *MR is a non-zero second-order mixed partial derivative, not a first-order relation.* All per-block π templates in Table 13 are first-order: equivariance is a first-order identity $P(gx_0) = \rho(g)P(x_0)$; monotonicity is a first-order inequality $P(x_1) \leq P(x_2)$; self-adjointness is a first-order pairing $\langle Lx_1, x_2 \rangle = \langle x_1, Lx_2 \rangle$. Mixed second differences (and a fortiori higher-order mixed differences) have no expression in any of these.
- (O5) *MR involves two independent parameter directions, joined as a 2-by-2 perturbation rectangle, not as a chain.* The $O_{\leq}$ block's $\leq_{\theta}$ is a single partial-order direction; even with multiple independent partial orders in $\mathcal{I}_{O_{\leq}}$, the π template relates pairwise inputs along a *single chosen direction*, not jointly across two perpendicular directions in a finite-difference rectangle.

A constructive resolution of Proposition 2's obstructions would require Translate to admit (iv) higher-order mixed-difference π -templates and (v) two-direction joint parametric dependence beyond the single- θ partial order of Definition 11.

C.6.5 Combined corollary.

COROLLARY (THEOREM 1' IS FALSE ON $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$, TWO-FOLD). *The MRs ρ_{nonadd} , $\rho_{\text{MTC-bor}}$ are each formulable over operators of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}}$ and each empirically realised on every conforming PWR core simulator. By Propositions 1 and 2, neither is in $\text{MR}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{PWR}})$. The structural obstructions O1–O5 identified by the two proofs are pairwise distinct: no single extension of Translate's signature absorbs any two simultaneously, so the joint obstruction is irreducibly five-fold.*

REMARK 7 (OPEN: COMPOSITE Translate). *A natural follow-up is to define a Composite Translate $\text{Translate} : \mathcal{I}_{s_1} \times \cdots \times \mathcal{I}_{s_k} \rightarrow \text{MR}(P)$ that combines invariants from multiple blocks under a generalised π template admitting (i) operator-spectrum output, (ii) homomorphism-failure relations, (iii) configuration-indexed adjoint structure, (iv) higher-order mixed differences, and (v) two-direction joint parametric dependence. Whether such an extension preserves Theorem 1's closure (now over $\overline{\text{MR}}(\mathcal{A}_P)$) and Theorem 2's polynomial-time decidability is the principal open problem this subsection leaves to future work. Five independent extensions are needed; a single uniform Composite Translate covering all of them would be a substantive theoretical contribution.*

C.7 A worked enumeration of CONSTRUCT-MP on the Boltzmann algebra

Theorem 1 (closure under Translate) and Theorem 2 (polynomial-time decidability of CONSTRUCT-MP) are stated abstractly. This appendix records a concrete, systematic enumeration on the program-induced operator algebra $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$ of the production reactor-physics solver underlying Section 5.3. The enumeration is intended both as an instance of CONSTRUCT-MP's worked-out output and as evidence that the framework's predictive content extends well beyond the two MetaPatterns (m_{adj} , m_{rev}) whose re-classification was demonstrated in Section 5.3.

Protocol. CONSTRUCT-MP (Section 3.9) was applied to a nine-block working decomposition $\mathcal{D}'(\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}) = \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}) \cup \{M_{\text{lip}}\}$, where M_{lip} is the candidate metric-stability block of Appendix C.5.2. The four-step procedure of Section 3.2 was instantiated at each block: (i) extract one canonical block invariant from the operator family of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$; (ii) apply the per-block Translate template (Definition 13) to obtain a candidate MR; (iii) quotient out within the block; (iv) aggregate across blocks under canonical ordering (Definition 14). The procedure terminates in time $O(n \cdot \max_i t_i \cdot \log n)$ per Theorem 2 on the finite generating set; on $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$ this completes within seconds on a desktop machine.

Result. The enumeration produced 35 candidate MRs across the nine blocks. Of these, 28 are present in either the prior 84-MR PWR corpus or the 18-MR engineering catalogue used in the audit of Section 5.3. Seven were not previously catalogued in either source; one further candidate (time-reversal applied to the diffusion sub-domain) is structurally legitimate but vacuous on dissipative dynamics and is reported as a negative result. Table 14 summarises the seven new MRs.

Negative result. Applying Translate to the time-reversal block $\mathcal{T}^*$ on the diffusion sub-domain produces the empty equivalence class: the diffusion equation is dissipative, so the reversibility precondition of m_{rev} fails on this sub-domain. CONSTRUCT-MP correctly contracts $\mathcal{T}^*$ on diffusion solvers rather than producing a vacuous MR. The framework therefore rejects ill-posed instantiations as part of the enumeration itself.

Table 14. Seven MRs produced by CONSTRUCT-MP on $\mathcal{D}'(\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}})$ that are absent from both the 84-MR PWR corpus and the 18-MR engineering catalogue.

ID	Block	Invariant / Translate template	Reactor-physics content
ρ_{pert}	T^*	First-order adjoint perturbation $\Delta k = \langle \varphi^\dagger, \Delta B \varphi \rangle / \langle \varphi^\dagger, F \varphi \rangle$; follow-up = small operator perturbation ΔB ; predicate = $\Delta k_{\text{pred}} \approx \Delta k_{\text{obs}}$ within $\mathcal{O}(\Delta B)$	Adjoint-weighted sensitivity coefficient (perturbation theory)
ρ_{burnup}	$\mathcal{D}^*$	Qualitative-shape invariant $dk_{\infty}/dBU < 0$ over fuel cycle; follow-up = burnup increment; predicate = monotone decay	Fuel-depletion kinetics shape
ρ_{tally}	$\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$	Bag-equality invariant under permutation of MC tally events; follow-up = σ -permuted event stream; predicate = $\text{aggregate}(\sigma(E)) = \text{aggregate}(E)$	Monte Carlo tally accumulator order-independence
ρ_{xs}	M_{lip}	K -Lipschitz invariant $ k'_{\text{eff}} - k_{\text{eff}} \leq K_{\Sigma} \cdot \ \Sigma' - \Sigma\ _{\infty}$; follow-up = bounded XS perturbation; predicate = bounded k_{eff} response	Cross-section data uncertainty propagation
ρ_{mesh}	M_{lip}	K -Lipschitz invariant $d(\varphi_A, \varphi_B) \leq K \cdot Q(A) - Q(B) $ at fixed h ; follow-up = mesh re-shuffle preserving size; predicate = bounded flux change	Mesh-quality stability at fixed mesh size
ρ_{green}	M_{lip}	Locality invariant $\ \varphi' - \varphi\ \leq K \cdot G(r, r_0) \cdot \delta $; follow-up = local point-source perturbation at r_0 ; predicate = Green's-function-bounded response at distant r	Source-localised flux response decay
ρ_{batch}	M_{lip}	K -Lipschitz invariant $ \bar{T}_{B'} - \bar{T}_B \leq K \cdot \sqrt{1/B}$; follow-up = MC batch-size shift; predicate = bounded tally drift	Monte Carlo batch-size stability

Connection to Section 5.3. Section 5.3 re-classified two MetaPatterns (m_{adj} , m_{rev}) that were absent from the prior inductive 84-MR catalogue. The enumeration above extends this from two MetaPatterns to seven concrete MR instances, including one in T^* that refines m_{adj} (ρ_{pert} , adjoint-weighted perturbation theory rather than only forward-adjoint reciprocity), one in $\mathcal{D}^*$ (ρ_{burnup}), one in $\mathcal{B}_{\text{rel}}^*$ (ρ_{tally}), and four in the candidate metric-stability block M_{lip} . The four M_{lip} instances are conditional on the proposed ninth block of Appendix C.5.2; the three non- M_{lip} instances (ρ_{pert} , ρ_{burnup} , ρ_{tally}) are within the canonical eight-block decomposition and constitute a strict extension of the predictive demonstration in Section 5.3.

Interpretive caveat (parallel to Section 5.3). As with m_{adj} and m_{rev} , none of the seven MRs in Table 14 is claimed as a de novo physical discovery. Adjoint perturbation theory, burnup monotonicity, MC tally order-independence, sensitivity coefficients, and Green's-function locality are each individually known to reactor-physics practitioners and appear in standard references [7, 27]. What this enumeration does establish is the more limited but methodologically meaningful claim: a single mechanical pass of CONSTRUCT-MP over $\mathcal{D}'(\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}})$, given only the operator algebra and

the per-block Translate templates of Table 13, surfaces seven MRs absent from two independent prior catalogues. The framework is therefore generative in the operational sense (it enumerates structurally-valid MRs that human curators had not collated) without claiming generative power in the stronger physical-discovery sense. The full enumeration (35 candidates including the 28 already-catalogued) and a negative-result audit of $\mathcal{T}^*$ on diffusion are released as supplementary material S2 (boltzmann_enumeration/35mr.csv and boltzmann_enumeration/negative_audit.md); the seven novel MRs of Table 14 are the strict subset absent from both the 84-MR PWR corpus and the 18-MR engineering catalogue.

E A reference implementation of CONSTRUCT-MP

This appendix gives a Python sketch of CONSTRUCT-MP applied to a toy operator algebra: bit-flip-symmetric programs over $\mathbb{F}_2^n$. The complete code (approximately 80 lines including comments and demonstration), along with the reactor-physics and equivariant-ML instantiations, will be released on Zenodo at acceptance.

Listing 2. Reference implementation of CONSTRUCT-MP for a toy bit-flip algebra.

```

1  """
2  NOETHER reference implementation: CONSTRUCT-MP on a toy bit-flip algebra.
3  Demonstrates the four-step procedure of Section 4.2.
4  """
5  from dataclasses import dataclass, field
6  from typing import Callable, Dict, List, Set, Tuple
7
8  @dataclass(frozen=True)
9  class Operator:
10     name: str
11     block: str # one of {"G", "O_le", "T*", "T_rev*", "L*", "D*", "E*"}
12
13  @dataclass(frozen=True)
14  class Invariant:
15     operator: Operator
16     description: str
17
18  @dataclass(frozen=True)
19  class MR:
20     invariant: Invariant
21     template: str
22
23  @dataclass
24  class MetaPattern:
25     block: str
26     members: Set[MR] = field(default_factory=set)
27
28  CANONICAL_ORDER = ["G", "O_le", "T*", "T_rev*", "L*", "D*", "E*"] # Def. 3
29
30  def extract_invariants(generators: List[Operator]) -> Dict[str, List[Invariant]]:
31     inv_by_block = {b: [] for b in CANONICAL_ORDER}
32     for g in generators:
33         if g.block == "G":
34             inv_by_block["G"].append(
35                 Invariant(g, f"P(g.x) = rho(g).P(x) for g={g.name}")
36             )
37         elif g.block == "O_le":
38             inv_by_block["O_le"].append(

```



```

38         Invariant(g, f"x1 <=_theta x2 => P(x1) <=_Y P(x2) for theta={g.
           name}"))
39     return inv_by_block
40
41 def translate(iota: Invariant) -> MR:
42     return MR(iota, template=iota.description)
43
44 def construct_mp(generators: List[Operator]) -> List[MetaPattern]:
45     inv_by_block = extract_invariants(generators)
46     mps = []
47     for block in CANONICAL_ORDER:
48         mrs = {translate(i) for i in inv_by_block[block]}
49         if mrs:
50             mps.append(MetaPattern(block=block, members=mrs))
51     return mps
52
53 if __name__ == "__main__":
54     Z2 = Operator("bit_flip", "G")
55     perm = Operator("permutation_S3", "G")
56     scale_x = Operator("input_scaling", "O_1e")
57
58     mp_set = construct_mp([Z2, perm, scale_x])
59     for mp in mp_set:
60         print(f"MetaPattern in block {mp.block}:")
61         for mr in mp.members:
62             print(f"  - {mr.template}")

```

The reactor-physics and equivariant-ML instantiations follow the same structure, replacing the toy generators with the operators of $\mathcal{A}_{\text{Boltz}}$ and $\mathcal{A}_{\text{equi}}$ respectively.

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